

CAPSTONE PROJECT PROPOSAL

**SecureFlow: An Automated End-to-End Onboarding System with
Real-Time Document**

In partial fulfillment for the requirements in Capstone 1 and
Research Subject

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

The modern corporate environment requires rapid and secure onboarding of new talent. Currently, many HR departments, including those in the local community, rely on manual processes: using physical paperwork tracking PDF's via email, using different spreadsheets for candidate status, and manually verifying credentials. That limit is caused by the decline in employee productivity, admin cost height and higher risk of human or human error.

Globally, the rapid shift toward remote, hybrid, and distributed workforces has transformed employee onboarding into a critical digital platform for modern companies. Organizations worldwide are replacing traditional, paper reliant hiring workflows with automated, cloud-based systems to accelerate candidate integration and reduce time to productivity. According to global human resource industry reports, manual preboarding methods lead to higher candidate drop off rates and increased operational expenses due to administrative overhead. Furthermore, international data protection standards mandate that sensitive candidate credentials such as government IDs and financial details, must be transmitted and stored under strict encryption standards. Consequently, global corporate technology trends heavily emphasize centralized platforms that combine automated workflow tracking with robust database security to safeguard pre-employment data across international borders.

Management has been difficult using traditional onboarding techniques in the local industry due to increasing hybrid and remote job models. Organizations in the Philippines face growing pressure to digitize their operations to reach the standards needed to remain competitive and attract tech-savvy talent in a globalized market. Without change, local businesses will remain struggling to handle the high volume of sensitive documentation required for legal compliance and recruitment.

In the Philippines, most local businesses and HR departments still struggle to shift away from fragmented, paper-heavy

onboarding practices. Organizations frequently rely on a combination of physical document submissions, unencrypted email attachments, and manual spreadsheet tracking to manage candidate progress. This reliance on disconnected channels creates severe visibility gaps, leaving HR personnel overwhelmed by manual data entry while candidates remain uninformed about their approval status. Additionally, handling physical records and unsecured PDF attachments exposes Philippine companies to significant data privacy compliance risks under the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173). As local industries face increasing pressure to modernize their operations and compete for tech-savvy talent, establishing a secure, centralized digital onboarding platform has become an urgent necessity.

Enabling an automatic end-to-end onboarding system with real time document handling offers robust solutions, harnessing modern web technologies. The system removes the delays and security deficiencies found in the traditional manual handling of documents by using automation in the entire workflow from initial recruitment stage to final approval. The document verification is performed by HR personnel, while the platform supports real-time updates, allowing submitted documents and status changes to be instantly visible to all authorized users.

By centralizing the entire onboarding lifecycle into a Single Page Application (SPA), the system eliminates the friction caused by scattered communication channels and physical paper handling. Modern cloud native database architectures enforce strict Row Level Security (RLS) policies, guaranteeing that sensitive candidate files remain isolated and accessible only to verified evaluators (HR Personnel/Admin). Furthermore, the integration of serverless background triggers automates routine tasks such as updating document status (pending, approval, rejected) and sending instant email notifications to candidates without requiring manual administrative intervention. This seamless combination of human oversight for document validation and automated system logic ensures a highly efficient, secure, and auditable onboarding pipeline for growing organizations.

This capstone project proposes the development of SecureFlow, an Automated End-to-End Onboarding System designed for secure and efficient recruitment. The system includes a React frontend with

a Supabase backend to provide real-time document updates and intense encryption or data security. The project applies the principles of software development and database management for faster processing and storage of documents and serves as a practical application of knowledge obtained by BSIT students in developing secure systems for real industry problems.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

Traditional paper-based onboarding and informal digital methods such as sending files back and forth over basic email are slow, inefficient, and create real security risks for organizations. Managing pre-employment paperwork manually leads to misplaced documents, delayed evaluations, and exposed personal candidate data.

To address these challenges, this study specifically aims to solve the following problems:

- Traditional onboarding relies heavily on manual work, creating process inefficiencies and delaying how fast new hires can complete their preboarding requirements.
- Submitted files are vulnerable to unauthorized changes or untracked resubmissions during the review phase.
- Applicants often send sensitive credentials through non-encrypted platforms and standard email, exposing personal data to potential privacy breaches.
- Manual processes cause slow communication, leaving both applicants and HR personnel without real-time updates on document status and approval progress.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

1.3.1 General Objective

The general objective of this study is to design and develop an end to end onboarding system that automates the recruitment and workflow of employee onboarding while enhancing data security

and real time document handling.

1.3.2 Specific Objectives

Specifically, the study aims to:

1. Analyze user requirements to identify system needs.
2. Design a role-based Single Page application architecture.
3. Implement server-side logic via Supabase Edge Functions and secure sensitive authentication and administrative operations.
4. Develop an automated document tracking and real-time status updates.
5. Ensure data auditability by adding a dedicated email tracking column in user profiles.
6. Store and manage data through a secured database
7. Test and evaluate the system's accuracy, usability and performance.

1.4 Scope and Delimitation

This study focuses on building **SecureFlow**, a web based onboarding system designed to replace manual hiring paperwork with a secure, digital process. The app was built as a Single Page Application (SPA) using React and Supabase, giving applicants, HR personnel, and admins their own dedicated portals based on their account roles. Applicants can register, track their onboarding progress, and upload their pre-employment documents. On the other hand, HR and Admins can view uploaded files directly in their dashboard, leave specific feedback on documents, update applicant status from Pending to Approved or Rejected, and manage user accounts. The system also uses automated background functions to send real-time email updates whenever an applicant's status changes.

To keep the project manageable and focused on core document management, clear constraints are implemented on what the system does not do. First, all document checks are done manually by HR or Admins. The system did not use AI or machine learning to automatically verify if a document is authentic. Second, SecureFlow strictly handles onboarding document collection, so

it does not cover payroll, salary computations, tax processing, or bank integrations. Third, the system relied on standard email and password logins rather than biometric systems like fingerprint or face scanners. Lastly, all uploaded files were required to be in PDF format to keep document previews consistent and secure across the platform.

1.5 Significance of the Study

The development of the system provides practical and technical value to various stakeholders involved in the recruitment and onboarding ecosystem. Specifically, this study will benefit the following:

- Applicants - Provided a centralized, secure platform where candidates can easily upload their pre-employment PDF documents, track their approval status in real time, and receive instant feedback without the risk of data loss or privacy exposure associated with unsecured email channels.
- Administrators/HR Personnel - It simplified and sped up the candidate evaluation process by providing an organized dashboard to manage user profiles, review submitted documents, record per-document feedback, and update onboarding statuses without relying on manual spreadsheet tracking.
- Organizations - It enhanced operational efficiency and data security during employee onboarding by implementing role-based access control (RBAC), Row Level Security (RLS), and secure authentication protocols to protect sensitive candidate information and maintain regulatory compliance.
- BSIT students - It served as a practical learning reference and demonstration of integrating modern frontend frameworks with secure serverless backend

foundations, database access policies, and automated workflow pipelines.

- Future researchers - It provided a valuable technical benchmark and literature reference for future studies focusing on automated onboarding workflows, secure document handling, real-time data management practices, and cloud-native software architecture.

1.6 Definition of Terms

- **Onboarding System:** A structured, web-based platform designed to help organizations digitize, streamline, and integrate new employees into the company by managing credential files and approval workflows.
- **Automation:** The use of software technologies such as database triggers and serverless Edge Functions to execute administrative tasks, trigger notifications, and process status changes with human intervention.
- **Real-time Document Handling:** The capability of the system to automatically update, track, and manage submitted candidate's files, allowing HR evaluators and applicants to see status updates and feedback immediately without manual page reloads or delays.
- **End-to-End Process:** A complete, self-contained workflow that covers all stages of preboarding , from initial candidate account registration and PDF upload to administrative evaluation, status updating (pending,approved,rejected), and automated email notification delivery.
- **Administrator:** A system user with elevated privileges responsible for managing user accounts,assigning role permissions,configuring security policies, providing feedback,updating applicant approval status and overseeing overall platform functionality.
- **Supabase:** An open source, cloud-based Backend-as-a-Service (BaaS) platform that provides SecureFlow with PostgreSQL database management,Supabase Auth session handling, secure object file storage, and real-time data synchronization.
- **Applicant:** A newly hired candidate who uses the system to submit required pre-employment documents, track onboarding

status, and view administrative feedback.

- **HR Personnel:** Authorized organizational staff responsible for reviewing submitted candidate documents.
- **Single Page Application (SPA):** A modern web application architecture built with React that dynamically rewrites the current page rather than loading entire new pages from a server, providing a fast and fluid user experience.
- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):** A security mechanism that restricts system access and feature availability based on the assigned user role (Applicant, HR Personnel, and Administrator).
- **Row Level Security (RLS):** A database security feature in PostgreSQL that restricts which rows of data a user can read, insert, update, or delete based on their authenticated identity and permissions.
- **Edge Functions:** Serverless TypeScript functions hosted on Supabase that execute server-side backend logic—such as sending automated SMTP email notifications—in response to system events.
- **Dropzone:** An interactive user interface component that allows applicants to drag and drop or select PDF files for uploading to the system.
- **Upsert:** A database operation that either inserts a new record or updates an existing record if it already exists, preventing duplicate document entries in storage.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE AND STUDIES

2.1 Foreign Studies

Petrilli et al.(2022) investigated the impact of digital onboarding processes on new hire experiences in the study Digital Onboarding: Facilitators and Barriers.The primary objective of the study was to evaluate how digital systems help employees integrate into a workplace while maintaining consistent communication and engagement with human resource personnel. Using a qualitative exploratory research design, data were collected through participants' logs where they stated their experiences with communication and accessibility. The findings revealed that while digital platforms improve consistency, a lack of interpersonal interaction and slow feedback loops from HR can create significant barriers to successful integration. The researcher concluded that digital systems are more effective when they prioritize continuous, active communication to bridge the gap between automation and human engagement.

Similar findings were reported by Sani et al.(2022), who examined the relationship between digital onboarding practices and employee experiences in the UK. The study found that digital onboarding can improve employee adjustment and workplace experiences however, lack of social interaction of the employees and reduced opportunities for relationship building may negatively affect newcomer integration. The researchers emphasized that organizations should combine digital tools with meaningful communication to strengthen employee connections.

Supporting this perspective, Yarbrough (2023) explored virtual onboarding and employee socialization experiences and found that communication, collaboration, and opportunities for social interaction significantly influence the success of virtual onboarding programs. The study revealed that employees experienced difficulties establishing organizational relationships when digital onboarding lacked personal engagement and social support. Similarly, Myburgh (2024) investigated the effects of digital onboarding on newcomer proactivity and socialization outcomes, revealing that digital systems alone may not be sufficient to encourage information seeking, feedback seeking, and workplace adjustment without additional organizational support.

Furthermore, Frögéli et al. (2023) conducted a systematic review on the effectiveness of formal onboarding practices in facilitating organizational socialization. The findings stated that structured onboarding programs, continuous guidance, and organizational support improves newcomer adjustment and engagement. Likewise, Perez and Poot (2023) found that effective onboarding requires clear communication, employee support, and interaction between newly hired employees and the organization to strengthen engagement, familiarity and commitment.

The findings from this research are directly applicable to the proposed system, which is relevant to address the core challenge of feedback delays in digital workflows. While the study identified slow feedback as a barrier, this project solves the issue through its real-time capability, ensuring that any changes or action taken by an applicant, employee or HR reflects immediately for all selected parties. This instant update fosters the active communication recommended by the researcher, allowing HR to provide immediate feedback on submitted contracts or documents. Therefore, the proposed system transforms a potential barrier into a facilitator by streamlining real-time document handling, allowing users to maintain high levels of engagement throughout the onboarding lifecycle.

Hartley (2024) examined the relationship between psychological safety, employee engagement, and retention during the onboarding process. The study emphasized that newly hired employees are

more likely to participate actively and remain committed to an organization when they feel safe expressing concerns, asking questions, and contributing ideas without fear of negative consequences. The findings suggested that organizations should foster supportive onboarding environments that encourage open communication and trust to improve employee engagement and long-term retention.

Supporting this perspective, **Krugielka et al. (2024)** investigated onboarding practices in Polish enterprises from the perspective of human resource specialists. The researchers found that effective onboarding extends beyond administrative orientation and includes structured training, continuous communication, and organizational support to help new employees adapt to their roles. The study concluded that well-planned onboarding programs contribute to faster employee integration, improved work performance, and stronger organizational commitment.

Similarly, **Rani et al. (2024)** explored the benefits of onboarding as a strategy for sustaining human resources within organizations. The study revealed that structured onboarding programs improve employee confidence, increase job satisfaction, and reduce early employee turnover by helping new hires understand organizational policies, responsibilities, and workplace culture. The researchers emphasized that organizations should implement comprehensive onboarding practices to strengthen workforce stability and employee retention.

Furthermore, Jeske and Olson (2022) investigated onboarding practices in virtual work environments and emphasized the importance of communication, accessibility of resources, and social interaction in supporting employee integration. The study found that poorly organized onboarding processes may negatively affect employee confidence and sense of belonging, whereas structured onboarding systems help maintain connection, guidance, and support among employees.

Pratiwi (2023) analyzed the onboarding process for newly hired employees in startup organizations. The study found that startups often encounter onboarding challenges due to limited resources, rapidly changing work environments, and informal

organizational structures. However, the findings indicated that structured onboarding, clear communication, and continuous guidance significantly improve employee adjustment, role understanding, and overall productivity. The researcher concluded that systematic onboarding practices are essential for helping new employees adapt successfully within startup environments.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by demonstrating the importance of a structured and centralized approach to onboarding management. The proposed system provides a digital framework that facilitates the implementation of structured onboarding practices by organizing document submissions, approvals, and employee requirements into a clear and automated workflow. Through real-time status updates and synchronized information sharing, the system provides applicants, employees, and HR personnel with immediate visibility into onboarding progress. This capability addresses the need for timely feedback, role clarity, and continuous communication identified in previous studies, ensuring that onboarding activities are completed efficiently while maintaining employee engagement throughout the transition process.

Bessen (2019) examined the relationship between automation technologies and employment, focusing on how technological innovations influence workforce productivity and job opportunities. The study found that automation primarily improves operational efficiency by reducing repetitive manual tasks, allowing employees to focus on more complex and value-added responsibilities. Rather than completely replacing human workers, the research concluded that automation can complement human capabilities by increasing productivity and creating opportunities for higher-skilled work when organizations effectively manage technological adoption.

Supporting these findings, Syed et al. (2020) examined the adoption of Robotic Process Automation across different organizational processes and found that automation improves efficiency by reducing repetitive manual activities, increasing

process consistency, and minimizing errors. However, the researchers emphasized that successful automation requires proper process design and continued human involvement to ensure that automated activities align with organizational requirements.

Similarly, Hofmann et al. (2020) analyzed the role of RPA in improving organizational processes and found that automation contributes to faster processing, improved accuracy, and reduced administrative workload. The study highlighted that organizations should carefully identify which activities are suitable for automation while maintaining human expertise for tasks involving judgment and complex decision-making.

Furthermore, van der Aalst et al. (2018) discussed the capabilities and limitations of Robotic Process Automation and emphasized that automation is most beneficial for structured, repetitive, and rule-based processes. The study explained that while automation can improve workflow efficiency, processes requiring interpretation, evaluation, and decision-making should remain under human control.

Folgado et al. (2022) reviewed the development of Industry 4.0 from the perspective of automation and supervisory systems. The researchers analyzed modern automation architectures, communication technologies, and intelligent monitoring systems used across various industries. The findings indicated that automation technologies improve operational efficiency, increase process accuracy, and enable real-time monitoring and decision-making through interconnected digital systems. The study emphasized that integrating automation with intelligent supervisory systems enhances organizational productivity while supporting faster and more reliable workflow management.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the importance of automated workflows in improving onboarding efficiency while preserving human oversight. Although the proposed system does not utilize Artificial Intelligence or Robotic Process Automation, it applies similar workflow automation principles by organizing document submissions, approval processes, and status tracking into a centralized platform. By automating document transmission and providing

real-time updates, the system reduces delays caused by manual coordination while allowing HR administrators to maintain control over document verification and approval decisions. Therefore, the proposed system improves responsiveness, workflow transparency, and administrative efficiency while ensuring that critical onboarding decisions remain guided by human judgment.

Groenewald (2004) conducted a case study entitled *Electronic Document Management: A Human Resource Management Case Study* to examine the implementation of digital document management systems within an HR environment. The study followed a multi-phase assessment and evaluation approach to observe user interaction with digital document handling procedures and examine how the system supported information accessibility and knowledge sharing. The findings revealed that electronic document management systems improve document organization and accessibility; however, their long-term success depends greatly on user acceptance, system usability, and effective implementation. The study identified organizational challenges and complex user interfaces as major factors that may contribute to the discontinuation of digital systems.

Supporting these findings, Davis (1989) introduced the Technology Acceptance Model, which emphasized that perceived usefulness and ease of use are major factors influencing users' willingness to adopt information systems. The study demonstrated that even technically capable systems may fail when users perceive them as difficult to understand or inconvenient to operate. Similarly, Venkatesh et al. (2003) found that technology adoption is influenced by performance expectations, effort expectations, and user perceptions regarding the value of a system.

Furthermore, Alavi and Leidner (2001) emphasized that digital information systems improve knowledge sharing and organizational efficiency when they are aligned with user needs and supported by proper implementation strategies. Likewise, vom Brocke et al. (2014) highlighted that electronic content management systems improve document accessibility and workflow efficiency when integrated with existing organizational processes.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by emphasizing the importance of usability, accessibility, and workflow alignment in digital document management. The proposed system addresses these requirements by providing a centralized and user-friendly onboarding portal designed for HR personnel, applicants, and employees. Through real-time document tracking, automated status updates, and organized approval workflows, the system reduces complexity in document handling while improving transparency and accessibility. By prioritizing simplicity and ease of use, the proposed system addresses the implementation challenges identified in previous research and promotes sustainable adoption throughout the onboarding document lifecycle.

Nyame and Qin (2020) investigated the design and implementation of Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) and its influence on information security within the study *Precursors of Role-Based Access Control Design in Knowledge Management Systems*. Through conceptual analysis and an illustrative case study, the researchers examined how defining organizational roles affects the protection of sensitive information and prevents unauthorized access. The findings confirmed that RBAC is an effective approach for managing information security because clearly defined roles simplify permission management and improve access control. The researchers emphasized that successful implementation requires careful analysis of user responsibilities to ensure that permissions align with organizational functions.

Supporting these findings, Sandhu et al. (1996) introduced the RBAC framework and demonstrated that assigning permissions according to organizational roles provides a flexible and efficient method for controlling access to information systems. The study emphasized that role definitions allow organizations to manage permissions more effectively compared with assigning access individually to each user. Similarly, Ferraiolo et al. (2003) explained that RBAC improves security administration by connecting user access rights with job responsibilities, reducing complexity in authorization management.

Furthermore, Zhang et al. (2003) highlighted the importance of flexible permission management in RBAC systems, demonstrating that properly designed roles allow organizations to maintain security while adapting to changing responsibilities. Hu et al. (2015) also emphasized that effective access control requires authorization policies based on user characteristics, responsibilities, and organizational requirements. These findings demonstrate that secure information systems depend on well-designed access mechanisms that ensure users only access resources necessary for their roles.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the importance of implementing role-based access control for secure onboarding document management. The proposed system applies these principles by assigning distinct roles for HR personnel, applicants, and employees, ensuring that sensitive documents such as contracts and personal information are accessible only to authorized users. Through structured authorization and permission management, the system protects data integrity while maintaining efficient document workflows. Therefore, the proposed system demonstrates that secure, real-time document handling can be achieved through properly designed access control mechanisms without requiring complex AI-based security solutions.

Pimentel and Nickerson (2012) investigated the effectiveness of the WebSocket protocol for communicating and displaying real-time data by comparing it with traditional communication methods such as HTTP polling. The researchers developed a real-time application that transmitted sensor measurements under different network conditions and evaluated performance based on latency and network overhead. The findings showed that WebSocket provides lower latency and improved efficiency by maintaining a persistent bidirectional connection, allowing data to be delivered immediately without repeated client requests. The study concluded that WebSocket is suitable for applications requiring continuous synchronization and real-time communication among multiple users.

Supporting these findings, Fette and Melnikov (2011) introduced the WebSocket protocol specification and highlighted its ability to establish persistent, full-duplex communication between clients and servers. The study emphasized that WebSocket reduces unnecessary network requests and improves the efficiency of real-time web applications compared with traditional request-response communication methods. Similarly, Wang et al. (2013) examined WebSocket-based communication and found that maintaining continuous connections improves data transmission efficiency and reduces delays in interactive applications.

Furthermore, Loreto et al. (2011) explored real-time communication technologies and emphasized that WebSocket provides a more efficient approach for web-based applications requiring immediate information exchange. The researchers identified that persistent connections improve responsiveness by allowing servers to directly push updates to connected users. Likewise, Friendly et al. (2023) designed and implemented an Internet of Things (IoT) communication system using WebSocket and PHP to enable real-time interaction between devices and web applications. The study found that WebSocket provides efficient bidirectional communication, allowing IoT devices to exchange data with minimal delay. The researchers also observed that increasing data size and the number of simultaneous connections affected transmission time, although WebSocket maintained reliable real-time communication suitable for IoT-based applications.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the use of real-time communication mechanisms for improving document workflow synchronization. By applying WebSocket-based communication principles, the proposed system enables immediate reflection of onboarding activities across user interfaces. When applicants submit documents or HR personnel approve requirements, updates can be delivered instantly to authorized users without requiring manual page refreshes. This real-time synchronization reduces communication delays, improves workflow transparency, and enhances the efficiency of the onboarding document management process.

Škvorc, Horvat, and Srbljić (2014) evaluated the performance of the WebSocket protocol as a full-duplex communication mechanism through analytical and experimental testing presented at the 37th International Convention on MIPRO. The researchers measured session establishment time and compared network traffic generated by WebSocket against plain TCP communication. The findings revealed that although WebSocket introduces minor overhead during the initial handshake process, it provides efficient bidirectional communication afterward, with the overhead becoming negligible during larger data exchanges. The study concluded that WebSocket enables asynchronous full-duplex communication while maintaining compatibility with existing web technologies, making it suitable for real-time monitoring and interactive applications.

Lombardi (2015) discussed the architecture and implementation of WebSocket technology in web development. The author explained that WebSocket establishes a persistent connection between clients and servers, allowing continuous two-way communication without repeatedly opening new HTTP connections. The study emphasized that this communication model improves application responsiveness, minimizes network traffic, and supports real-time features required by modern web systems.

Deshpande et al. (2024) developed a real-time chatting system using WebSocket technology to improve communication efficiency between users. The researchers implemented WebSocket to establish persistent bidirectional communication between the client and server, enabling messages to be transmitted instantly without repeatedly sending HTTP requests. The findings demonstrated that the system achieved low-latency message delivery, continuous connectivity, and efficient real-time communication, making WebSocket a suitable technology for applications that require immediate data synchronization and responsive user interaction.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the use of WebSocket-based communication for real-time onboarding document management. By implementing a full-duplex communication approach, the proposed system can provide immediate updates between applicants, employees, and HR administrators whenever documents are submitted, reviewed,

approved, or modified. This eliminates the need for repeated page refreshes and ensures that all authorized users receive synchronized information instantly. Therefore, WebSocket technology enhances the system's responsiveness, improves workflow transparency, and supports efficient communication throughout the onboarding process.

Muller (2014) examined the HTML5 WebSocket protocol and its application in distributed computing environments to evaluate its effectiveness in supporting real-time communication. The study analyzed different WebSocket server implementations and conducted performance benchmarking using scalable frameworks capable of supporting multiple simultaneous client connections. The findings demonstrated that WebSocket enables efficient low-latency communication by maintaining persistent bidirectional connections between web browsers and servers. The study concluded that WebSocket reduces communication delays compared with traditional HTTP-based methods, making it suitable for applications requiring continuous synchronization among distributed users.

Ogundeyi and Yinka-Banjo (2018) investigated the implementation of WebSocket technology in real-time applications. The researchers evaluated the protocol's ability to maintain continuous communication between clients and servers and found that WebSocket significantly reduces response delays compared to conventional HTTP communication. Their findings demonstrated that the technology effectively supports applications requiring immediate updates, continuous synchronization, and efficient data transmission.

Erkkilä (2018) examined the security aspects of WebSocket communication by identifying common vulnerabilities and potential threats associated with persistent network connections. The study highlighted the importance of implementing secure authentication, encrypted communication, and proper server validation to protect WebSocket-based applications from unauthorized access and malicious attacks. The findings emphasized that security mechanisms should be incorporated

during system development to ensure safe real-time communication.

Fernando et al. (2024) conducted a comparative performance benchmarking study of WebSocket libraries implemented in Node.js and Golang to evaluate their efficiency in supporting real-time communication. The researchers measured key performance indicators, including response time, throughput, latency, and resource utilization under varying workloads. The findings revealed that both platforms effectively supported persistent bidirectional communication, although differences in performance were observed depending on the WebSocket library and implementation. The study concluded that selecting an appropriate WebSocket framework is essential for developing scalable and responsive real-time applications.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by providing a technical foundation for implementing real-time communication within the onboarding document management portal. By utilizing WebSocket-based communication principles, the proposed system can deliver immediate updates whenever applicants submit documents, HR personnel review requirements, or administrators approve requests. The persistent connection between the server and user interfaces ensures that information remains synchronized without requiring manual page refreshes. Therefore, the implementation of real-time communication improves responsiveness, reduces processing delays, and enhances the efficiency of document handling throughout the onboarding lifecycle.

Chawla et al. (2017) compared different data exchange mechanisms used in real-time web applications, including AJAX polling, Long Polling, Server-Sent Events (SSE), and WebSocket. The researchers conducted architectural analysis and experimental benchmarking to evaluate each technology based on latency, bandwidth usage, and scalability under different workloads. The findings showed that WebSocket provided the strongest performance for bidirectional communication because it maintains a persistent connection between the client and server, while

traditional approaches produced additional overhead due to repeated HTTP requests. The study concluded that communication technologies should be selected based on the specific real-time requirements and update frequency of the application.

Yinka-Banjo and Ogundeyi (2019) developed a financial stock monitoring application utilizing WebSocket technology to deliver real-time market information. The researchers demonstrated that WebSocket enables immediate transmission of stock price updates without requiring continuous client requests. The study concluded that the protocol effectively supports applications requiring instant information delivery while reducing communication overhead and improving overall system responsiveness.

Kularatna et al. (2023) developed an agent-based centralized tool for analyzing and managing Security-Enhanced Linux (SELinux) policies using the WebSocket protocol. The researchers integrated WebSocket technology to provide continuous communication between the centralized management platform and connected agents, enabling real-time monitoring and policy updates. The findings demonstrated that WebSocket improved the responsiveness of security management by allowing administrators to receive immediate system information and policy changes while reducing communication delays. The study concluded that WebSocket is an effective protocol for centralized security management systems requiring continuous monitoring and rapid information exchange.

Furthermore, Muller (2014) investigated the application of HTML5 WebSocket in distributed computing environments and evaluated its ability to support multiple simultaneous client connections. The findings revealed that persistent bidirectional communication improves responsiveness and reduces delays compared with conventional HTTP-based communication methods. The study highlighted that WebSocket is well suited for distributed applications requiring continuous synchronization between users and servers.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the use of WebSocket-based real-time communication for onboarding document management. Since the proposed system

requires immediate synchronization between applicants, employees, and HR administrators during document submission, review, and approval processes, an efficient communication mechanism is essential. By implementing a persistent bidirectional communication approach, the system can provide instant status updates and notifications without requiring repeated page refreshes. This reduces communication overhead, improves workflow responsiveness, and ensures that all authorized users receive accurate and timely information throughout the onboarding process.

Cömert, Hekim, and Adem (2016) conducted a comparative study of the WebSocket protocol against traditional web communication methods, including Polling and Long Polling, to evaluate their effectiveness in modern interactive applications. The researchers analyzed each communication method based on server workload, scalability, and latency. The findings revealed that WebSocket provides superior performance by maintaining an open connection after the initial handshake, reducing the overhead caused by repeated HTTP requests. The study concluded that while traditional communication methods may be sufficient for applications requiring occasional updates, WebSocket is more suitable for highly interactive systems requiring continuous and efficient data exchange.

Safriadi et al. (2024) implemented WebSocket technology in an Internet of Things (IoT)-based smart home door security system using the ESP32-CAM with facial recognition capabilities. The researchers developed a system that transmitted security events instantly between IoT devices and users through persistent WebSocket communication. The findings showed that WebSocket enabled real-time notifications, efficient device synchronization, and immediate access control updates, improving the overall responsiveness and reliability of the smart home security system.

Soewito et al. (2022) designed a WebSocket-based communication framework for smart home applications within an Internet of Things (IoT) environment. The researchers demonstrated that

WebSocket allows IoT devices and web applications to exchange information instantly through persistent bidirectional communication. The findings showed that the protocol reduced communication delays, improved device synchronization, and enhanced overall system responsiveness, making it suitable for real-time IoT applications.

Saudagar et al. (2024) proposed a lightweight threshold-based approach for detecting Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDoS) attacks while utilizing WebSocket alerts for real-time notification. The study evaluated the effectiveness of combining threshold-based detection techniques with WebSocket communication to provide immediate security alerts whenever abnormal network traffic was identified. The findings indicated that WebSocket allowed rapid dissemination of security notifications, enabling administrators to respond promptly to potential cyber threats. The researchers concluded that integrating WebSocket with network monitoring systems enhances real-time threat detection and improves incident response capabilities.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by establishing the technical advantages of WebSocket-based communication for real-time document management workflows. Since the proposed onboarding portal requires continuous interaction between applicants, employees, and HR administrators during document submission, review, and approval stages, an efficient communication mechanism is necessary. By implementing persistent bidirectional communication, the system can provide immediate updates regarding document status changes while reducing unnecessary server requests. This improves system responsiveness, minimizes communication delays, and ensures a more reliable and interactive onboarding experience.

Gavrilă, Băjenaru, and Dobre (2019) examined the architecture of modern Single Page Applications (SPAs) and their influence on system performance and user experience through a case study approach. The researchers analyzed key architectural components, including client-side rendering and API communication, to

determine practices that improve interaction between frontend and backend services. The findings demonstrated that SPA architectures enhance responsiveness, reduce unnecessary page reloads, and provide a more dynamic user experience while maintaining scalability and modularity.

Huda et al. (2024) developed a Single Page Application (SPA) using ReactJS for an online printing business to improve the efficiency of customer transactions and business operations. The researchers found that the SPA architecture reduced page reloads and enabled dynamic content updates, resulting in faster response times and a smoother user experience. The study concluded that ReactJS-based SPAs enhance application performance and usability by providing responsive navigation and efficient client-side rendering.

Similarly, Mikowski and Powell (2013) discussed the development of Single Page Applications and emphasized that SPA architectures improve user experience by moving application logic to the client side and enabling faster interactions. The authors explained that SPAs provide a more application-like experience by reducing navigation delays and allowing users to interact with dynamic interfaces more efficiently.

Furthermore, Fink and Flatow (2014) explored modern web application development approaches and demonstrated that client-side frameworks improve maintainability, responsiveness, and separation between frontend interfaces and backend services. The study highlighted that structured frontend architectures allow developers to create scalable applications capable of handling complex user interactions.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the use of SPA architecture for developing a responsive onboarding document management portal. By applying client-side rendering and asynchronous communication principles, the proposed system allows HR administrators, applicants, and employees to interact with onboarding features without experiencing delays caused by traditional page refreshes. The SPA approach improves interface responsiveness, supports real-time document updates, and provides a smoother user experience throughout the onboarding workflow. Therefore,

adopting SPA architecture strengthens the system's ability to deliver an efficient, scalable, and interactive platform for managing onboarding processes.

Nowacki and Plechawska-Wójcik (2016) conducted a comparative analysis of frontend frameworks, including AngularJS, ReactJS, and Ember.js, to evaluate their effectiveness in developing Single Page Applications. The researchers created test applications to assess rendering performance, maintainability, and development complexity across different frameworks. The findings showed that ReactJS provides strong flexibility and performance advantages due to its virtual DOM architecture, which enables efficient rendering and more responsive user interfaces compared with traditional web development approaches.

Supporting these findings, Gavrilă, Băjenaru, and Dobre (2019) examined modern Single Page Application architectures and analyzed how client-side rendering and API communication contribute to improved web application performance. The study demonstrated that SPA architectures enhance responsiveness by reducing unnecessary page reloads and enabling smoother interaction between users and web systems. The researchers emphasized that proper frontend architecture is essential for developing scalable and efficient applications.

Rossi (2024) proposed a scalable Single Page Application framework designed to support next-generation artificial intelligence ecosystems in pediatric healthcare and intelligent financial operations. The study emphasized that SPA architecture improves scalability, maintainability, and responsiveness by allowing seamless interaction between users and complex backend services. The findings demonstrated that combining SPA technologies with modern web architectures enhances system performance while supporting real-time data processing and intelligent decision-making.

Furthermore, **Hossain (2023)** compared Server-Side Rendering (SSR), Single Page Applications (SPA), and Static Site Generation (SSG) as approaches to modern web development. The study evaluated each architecture based on performance,

scalability, search engine optimization, and user experience. The findings indicated that SPAs provide superior responsiveness and interactive user experiences by updating application content dynamically without requiring full page reloads, making them suitable for web applications requiring continuous user interaction.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by providing technical justification for the use of ReactJS and Single Page Application architecture in developing an onboarding document management portal. By utilizing a component-based frontend structure and efficient rendering approach, the proposed system can handle complex workflows such as applicant registration, document submission, and HR approval processes more effectively. The ReactJS architecture enables faster interface updates and supports real-time document status synchronization, ensuring that users receive immediate feedback during the onboarding process. Therefore, adopting ReactJS and SPA principles improves system responsiveness, maintainability, and overall user experience.

Timanovskyi and Plechawska-Wójcik (2020) evaluated the performance of various Single Page Application (SPA) technologies to determine their effectiveness in delivering high-quality user experiences. The researchers used benchmarking indicators, including resource utilization, browser efficiency, and response times under different workloads, to assess the performance of modern frontend frameworks. The findings revealed that optimized SPA frameworks improve application responsiveness, reduce loading times, and support efficient handling of dynamic data. The study concluded that selecting an appropriate frontend technology stack is essential for maintaining performance and scalability in modern web applications.

Supporting these findings, **Phan and Khoi (2023)** conducted a comprehensive study on Single Page Applications, examining their advantages, limitations, and practical implementation guidelines. The researchers found that SPAs improve application

responsiveness, reduce unnecessary server requests, and enhance user satisfaction through seamless navigation. However, the study also noted challenges related to search engine optimization, initial loading performance, and browser memory consumption. The authors recommended adopting appropriate optimization techniques to maximize the benefits of SPA development.

Similarly, **Jadhav et al. (2018)** implemented a Single Page Application using AngularJS to simplify web application development and improve user interaction. The researchers demonstrated that SPA architecture enables efficient client-side rendering, allowing users to navigate the application without frequent page refreshes. The findings indicated that AngularJS-based SPAs improve responsiveness, reduce communication delays, and provide a more interactive browsing experience.

Furthermore, **Nygard and Klaus (2016)** explored single-page architecture as the foundation for modern web applications. The study discussed how SPA design separates the user interface from backend services, enabling asynchronous communication and dynamic content updates. The researchers concluded that SPA architecture improves application flexibility, responsiveness, and maintainability, making it an effective solution for interactive web-based information systems. .

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the need for an optimized frontend architecture capable of handling large amounts of onboarding data and document transactions. By utilizing a modern SPA framework, the proposed system can provide a responsive interface for applicants, employees, and HR administrators while efficiently managing document submissions, reviews, and status updates. The use of optimized frontend technologies ensures that system performance remains stable as the number of users and stored documents increases. Therefore, implementing a high-performance SPA architecture contributes to a reliable, scalable, and efficient onboarding platform.

Bushong et al. (2021) examined the evolution of microservice architectures and their impact on software scalability and maintainability through a systematic mapping study. The researchers reviewed existing literature to identify common patterns in service decomposition, orchestration, and communication within cloud-native systems. The findings revealed that dividing applications into independent services improves deployment flexibility, scalability, and maintainability. However, the study also emphasized that effective communication between services is essential to manage architectural complexity and preserve system reliability.

Supporting these findings, Newman (2021) discussed the principles of microservice architecture and highlighted how independent services allow organizations to develop, deploy, and scale system components more efficiently. The study emphasized that service boundaries, reliable communication, and proper system design are critical factors in ensuring the long-term maintainability of distributed applications.

Similarly, Dragoni et al. (2017) analyzed the characteristics and challenges of microservice-based systems and found that decomposing applications into smaller, independent services improves flexibility and enables faster development cycles. The researchers emphasized that successful microservice implementation requires careful consideration of service communication, data management, and architectural complexity.

Furthermore, Jamshidi et al. (2018) conducted a systematic review of microservice migration and identified scalability, maintainability, and independent deployment as major advantages of microservice architectures. The study highlighted that modular system structures allow applications to adapt more easily to changing requirements while reducing the impact of modifications on other system components.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the use of modular and scalable architecture for the HR document management portal. By separating major system functions, such as authentication, document management, and database services, the proposed system can improve maintainability and support future expansion. The use of

independent services allows additional features or user groups to be integrated without significantly affecting existing workflows. Therefore, applying microservice principles helps ensure that the onboarding platform remains reliable, flexible, and capable of supporting increasing numbers of applicants, employees, and document transactions.

Taibi, Lenarduzzi, and Pahl (2019) investigated how microservices and DevOps practices support the development and maintenance of cloud-based applications through a systematic mapping study. The researchers analyzed existing approaches related to continuous delivery, deployment strategies, and software maintenance practices to identify methods that improve reliability in cloud environments. The findings revealed that combining modular architectures with automated development and deployment processes enables faster update cycles, improved scalability, and increased system stability. The study concluded that cloud-based infrastructure and DevOps practices are important foundations for maintaining reliable and adaptable modern web applications.

Supporting these findings, **Raj et al.** discussed cloud-native computing with emphasis on designing, developing, deploying, and securing microservices-based applications. The authors explained that cloud-native architectures allow applications to be divided into smaller, independently deployable services, improving scalability, flexibility, and maintainability. The study also emphasized the importance of incorporating security throughout the development and deployment lifecycle to protect distributed services and data. These principles are relevant to systems that require scalable web services and secure communication between different application components.

Similarly, **Bellundagi** examined the design and implementation of a scalable microservices architecture for digital payment systems. The study demonstrated how separating application functionality into independent services can improve scalability, reliability, and maintainability in systems that handle multiple transactions and services. The findings support the use of

microservices for applications that require flexible service management and the ability to scale individual components according to workload.

Furthermore, **Pinheiro et al.** examined performance modeling for microservices-based cloud infrastructures, focusing on how the behavior and resource requirements of distributed services can be evaluated under different workloads. The study emphasized the importance of performance modeling in predicting system behavior and identifying potential bottlenecks in cloud environments. The findings demonstrate that performance analysis can help developers make informed decisions about resource allocation, scalability, and service configuration, which are important considerations when developing cloud-based applications.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the use of cloud-based and modular architectures for developing a scalable HR document management portal. By utilizing cloud technologies and service-oriented design principles, the proposed system can maintain availability, support future expansion, and handle increasing numbers of applicants, employees, and document transactions. The integration of modular services with reliable deployment practices ensures that real-time document handling features remain accessible and stable while allowing system improvements to be implemented efficiently. Therefore, adopting cloud-based microservice principles provides a strong foundation for a secure, maintainable, and scalable onboarding platform.

Alshammari et al. (2021) investigated the enhancement of traditional Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) by incorporating trust evaluation mechanisms into cloud service environments. The researchers proposed a Task Role-Based Access Control (T-RBAC) model that evaluates users based on assigned roles, task requirements, and trust levels before granting access to cloud resources. The findings demonstrated that integrating trust-based evaluation with RBAC improves cloud security by reducing unauthorized access while maintaining efficient system performance. The study concluded that adaptive access control

models are effective for organizations handling sensitive information in cloud environments.

Supporting these findings, **Abusini (2024)** investigated the application of Risk-Based Access Control (RBAC) in securing smart home environments against evolving cyber threats. The study proposed an adaptive access control model that incorporates contextual risk assessment to determine authorization decisions dynamically rather than relying solely on predefined user roles. The findings demonstrated that integrating risk evaluation with RBAC improves the protection of interconnected devices by limiting unauthorized access while maintaining system usability. The researcher concluded that adaptive access control mechanisms strengthen security in distributed systems by considering both user roles and contextual risk factors during access decisions.

Similarly, **Santos-Pereira et al. (2013)** proposed a secure Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) model for healthcare institutions using mobile agents to facilitate secure information exchange across heterogeneous healthcare systems. The researchers integrated RBAC with a public key infrastructure (PKI) to strengthen authentication and authorization while enabling mobile agents to access distributed medical information securely. The study found that assigning permissions based on predefined organizational roles improved access control, protected sensitive data, and supported secure interoperability between healthcare institutions. The authors concluded that RBAC provides an effective framework for managing user permissions in environments where confidentiality, integrity, and controlled access are critical.

Furthermore, **Islam et al. (2026)** proposed an identity-centric security model for enterprise web systems that integrates identity authentication, identity profiling, behavioral monitoring, risk evaluation, and policy-based access control within a unified framework. Unlike traditional Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), which primarily relies on predefined user roles and static authentication, the proposed model continuously evaluates user behavior throughout an active session to identify suspicious activities and adjust access decisions accordingly. The findings demonstrated that continuous identity monitoring

and adaptive policy enforcement improved anomaly detection, increased the accuracy of access control decisions, and strengthened enterprise security against unauthorized access. The researchers concluded that identity-centric security provides a more adaptive and context-aware approach for protecting modern enterprise web systems.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the implementation of role-based security controls within a cloud-based onboarding document management platform. Similar to the T-RBAC model proposed by Alshammari et al. (2021), the proposed system assigns specific permissions to HR administrators, applicants, and employees according to their responsibilities. This ensures that confidential documents, employment contracts, and personal information are accessible only to authorized users. By applying structured access control principles, the system improves data protection, maintains document integrity, and provides secure management of sensitive onboarding information.

Mell and Grance (2011), representing the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST), established a standardized definition and framework for cloud computing by identifying five essential characteristics: on-demand self-service, broad network access, resource pooling, rapid elasticity, and measured service. The publication also defined three primary cloud service models: Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS), Platform as a Service (PaaS), and Software as a Service (SaaS). The framework emphasized that cloud computing provides significant benefits, including scalability, accessibility, and cost efficiency; however, it also requires strong security mechanisms to maintain data confidentiality, integrity, and availability.

Supporting this framework, Armbrust et al. (2010) examined the opportunities and challenges of cloud computing and identified scalability, accessibility, and reduced infrastructure costs as major advantages of cloud-based systems. The researchers also highlighted security, privacy, and reliability as important

concerns that must be addressed when storing and processing organizational data in cloud environments.

Similarly, Buyya et al. (2009) explored cloud computing as an emerging model for delivering computing resources as services. The study emphasized that cloud platforms enable flexible resource allocation and allow applications to scale according to user demand. However, the researchers noted that effective management and security controls are necessary to ensure reliable cloud service delivery.

Furthermore, Zhang, Cheng, and Boutaba (2010) analyzed cloud computing architecture and management approaches, emphasizing the importance of virtualization, resource management, and security mechanisms in maintaining reliable cloud-based applications. The study highlighted that cloud systems must balance accessibility and scalability with proper protection of sensitive information.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the use of cloud-based infrastructure for developing a scalable onboarding document management platform. By utilizing cloud storage and services, the proposed system allows applicants, employees, and HR administrators to access onboarding documents from different locations while maintaining centralized data management. Following the security considerations emphasized by Mell and Grance (2011), the system incorporates authentication mechanisms, controlled access permissions, and secure document storage to protect sensitive employment information. Therefore, cloud computing provides the necessary foundation for achieving accessibility, scalability, and reliability throughout the onboarding process.

Rose et al. (2020), through the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST), developed the Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) framework to address security challenges in modern information systems. The publication introduced the principle of "never trust, always verify," which requires continuous authentication and authorization of users and devices before

granting access to protected resources. The findings emphasized that eliminating implicit trust, applying least-privilege access, and continuously validating requests can reduce unauthorized access and limit potential security threats within cloud environments.

Supporting these findings, Mell and Grance (2011) established the NIST cloud computing framework and highlighted that while cloud technologies provide scalability, accessibility, and cost efficiency, organizations must implement strong security controls to protect data confidentiality, integrity, and availability. The framework emphasized that secure authentication and access management are essential components when deploying applications on cloud infrastructure.

Similarly, **Asundi (2025)** examined the enhancement of Role-Based Access Control in Microsoft Dataverse for enterprise applications, focusing on advanced security models and governance within Power Apps and Dynamics 365 CRM environments. The study emphasized the importance of properly defining user roles, permissions, and governance policies to prevent unauthorized access to enterprise data. The findings demonstrate how RBAC can provide structured access management while supporting security and governance requirements in complex business applications.

Furthermore, **Shin et al. (2024)** proposed an architecture for enhancing communication security in Internet of Things (IoT)-based microgrids using Role-Based Access Control (RBAC). The researchers integrated RBAC with Data Distribution Service (DDS) communication to regulate user and device permissions through predefined roles and authorization policies. The findings demonstrated that the proposed architecture effectively reduced unauthorized access and strengthened communication security while maintaining efficient real-time data exchange among interconnected devices. The study concluded that implementing RBAC improves access control, enhances cyber resilience, and supports secure communication in distributed systems.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the implementation of strong authentication and

controlled access mechanisms within a cloud-based onboarding document management platform. Following the Zero Trust principles established by Rose et al. (2020), the proposed system ensures that users are verified before accessing sensitive onboarding documents and system functions. By combining role-based permissions with secure authentication practices, HR administrators, applicants, and employees can access only the information required for their specific responsibilities. This approach strengthens document confidentiality, prevents unauthorized access, and ensures secure management of sensitive employment records throughout the onboarding process.

Gambo and Almulhem (2026) conducted a systematic literature review on Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) by analyzing research published between 2016 and 2025. The study found that Zero Trust is built on the principle of **"never trust, always verify,"** requiring continuous authentication, dynamic trust evaluation, conditional access, and enforcement of the least-privilege principle to protect modern information systems. The review further highlighted that Zero Trust has been successfully applied in cloud computing, Internet of Things (IoT), healthcare, enterprise systems, and industrial environments. However, the researchers also identified implementation challenges, including integration complexity, scalability, and organizational readiness. They concluded that Zero Trust Architecture provides a comprehensive security framework that strengthens access control, minimizes unauthorized access, and improves cybersecurity resilience in distributed digital environments.

The NIST (2018) Cybersecurity Framework provides a structured, risk-based approach for organizations to manage and reduce cybersecurity risks. The framework is organized into five core functions: Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, and Recover, which guide organizations in establishing effective security practices. The publication emphasizes that implementing security controls, such as asset management, access management,

protective technologies, and recovery planning, is essential for safeguarding sensitive digital information.

Supporting this framework, Tounsi and Rais (2018) examined cybersecurity risk assessment approaches and emphasized that identifying vulnerabilities and evaluating threats are critical steps in developing effective security strategies. The researchers highlighted that organizations must adopt systematic risk management processes to protect information assets and improve cybersecurity readiness.

Similarly, Craigen, Diakun, and Purse (2014) explored cybersecurity frameworks and their role in improving organizational security practices. Their findings showed that structured frameworks help organizations establish consistent security policies, manage risks, and improve coordination when responding to cybersecurity incidents.

Furthermore, Von Solms and Van Niekerk (2013) analyzed the importance of cybersecurity awareness and governance in protecting digital information systems. The study emphasized that effective cybersecurity requires not only technical controls but also proper policies, procedures, and organizational practices.

The findings from these studies support the proposed system by validating the implementation of structured security practices for protecting onboarding documents and user information. By following the risk management approach recommended by the NIST Cybersecurity Framework, the proposed system can identify potential security risks, apply preventive controls, and maintain reliable document protection. These principles support the use of secure authentication, controlled access, monitoring mechanisms, and recovery strategies to ensure that sensitive HR records remain protected throughout the onboarding process.

The proposed system aligns with the NIST (2018) framework by incorporating proactive protection measures for applicant data. By implementing role-based authorization and secure document handling, the project addresses the "Protect" and "Identify"

functions of the framework. These measures reduce the cybersecurity risks associated with handling digital contracts and personal identification, ensuring a secure environment for all system users.

Kamara and Lauter (2010) presented a secure cloud storage architecture designed to protect sensitive information using cryptographic techniques. Their research proposed combining encryption, key management, and proofs of data possession to ensure that cloud service providers could store data without accessing its content. The study found that applying these cryptographic measures significantly improves data confidentiality and integrity, allowing organizations to securely outsource data management to the cloud.

The research by Kamara and Lauter (2010) underscores the importance of the security mechanisms used in the proposed system. Since the project handles sensitive employment documents in a cloud environment, the emphasis on confidentiality and integrity is critical. The study supports the implementation of secure access controls and encrypted authentication within the project to prevent unauthorized viewing or tampering with applicant records.

2.2 Local Studies

Oñate, Omorog, and Babol (2018) developed a web-based system entitled "Development of Electronic Business Permit and Licensing System (eBPLS)" to streamline the application and renewal of permits in the Philippines. Using the Modified Princeton Project Management Methodology, the researchers created a platform where users could upload requirements and track their application status electronically to reduce processing delays. The findings showed that the eBPLS significantly improved efficiency, reducing turnaround times to a single day and receiving high acceptability ratings from both government personnel and IT experts. The system was noted for its reliability in managing electronic requirements and enhancing document monitoring.

This local study is directly relevant to the proposed system as it demonstrates the success of using centralized web portals to replace manual, paper-based processes in a Philippine context. Similar to eBPLS, this project provides a secure portal for applicants to submit documents and for administrators to review them efficiently. By ensuring that these interactions reflect in real-time, the system replicates the high efficiency found in the eBPLS study, proving that a workflow-driven approach is an effective way to handle critical document submissions. This validates the project's goal of improving efficiency through a centralized, real-time platform for document management.

Jaca (2022) developed the *Electronic Document Management and Tracking System (EDMTS)* to improve document processing and monitoring within the PhilHealth Regional Office of the National Capital Region. The study addressed problems related to missing documents, ineffective dissemination, poor tracking, and difficulties in document retrieval by developing a web-based platform for storing, routing, sharing, and monitoring electronic documents. The system included modules for user management, document classification, action management, and document tracking, allowing users to efficiently manage document transactions through a centralized platform. The findings showed

that the implementation improved document management performance and increased organizational productivity.

This study supports the proposed onboarding system because both projects focus on improving document-based processes through centralized web applications. Similar to EDMTS, the proposed system provides a digital environment where applicants can submit documents and HR administrators can monitor document progress. By adding real-time synchronization, the proposed system further improves document visibility by ensuring that updates, approvals, and status changes are immediately reflected among authorized users.

Amo and Labuguen (2023) developed an automated HR system to improve recruitment, personnel record management, and onboarding for Transportation Network Vehicle Service (TNVS) operations. Using Agile methodology, the researchers integrated various HR modules into a digital platform to reduce paperwork and improve the organization of employee records. The findings demonstrated that automation significantly enhanced onboarding efficiency and monitoring capabilities by providing a centralized repository for data. However, the study also noted that final validation and approval activities still required the direct intervention of HR personnel to ensure accuracy and professional judgment during the onboarding process.

This study supports the design of the proposed system, which balances digital automation with necessary human oversight. The project's focus on providing HR with a real-time environment to review and approve applicant documents mirrors the necessity for human intervention identified in the TNVS study. By creating a real-time reflection of all document updates, the proposed system ensures that HR administrators, applicants, and employees can collaborate more effectively on a single platform. This eliminates the manual paperwork and communication gaps identified in traditional systems, ensuring that the system remains responsive while preserving human decision-making.

Caparas et al. (2023) examined the effectiveness of implementing a Human Resource Information System (HRIS) at Yngen Datacom

Corporation. The study evaluated how HRIS supports employee information management and improves HR-related processes by integrating human resource practices with information technology. The researchers assessed factors such as system effectiveness, usability, and user satisfaction, emphasizing that HR information systems improve accessibility and organization of employee records. The study demonstrated that HRIS solutions can enhance HR operations by reducing dependence on manual processes and improving information management.

This study supports the proposed onboarding system because both systems aim to improve HR operations through digital platforms. Similar to the HRIS implemented by Caparas et al., the proposed system centralizes employee and applicant information while reducing manual paperwork. The proposed platform extends this concept by focusing specifically on onboarding workflows, allowing HR personnel to review documents, track completion status, and provide immediate updates throughout the employee integration process.

Magtoto and Garcia (2019) conducted a study to develop a workflow management system that streamlines permit processing through automated routing and status monitoring. The researchers implemented features such as role-based access and approval tracking to improve transparency and reduce delays within local government units. The findings revealed that the system improved operational efficiency and provided administrators with better control over document processing, allowing users to track their application progress more effectively. The study concluded that automated workflow routing is essential for increasing visibility throughout the entire approval cycle.

The workflow-centric approach of this study is a core feature of the proposed system, which utilizes a similar routing mechanism where documents submitted by applicants are reflected in real-time for HR review. This ensures the same level of transparency and visibility found in the local government study, allowing applicants and employees to track their onboarding progress in a live environment. By focusing on automated status monitoring and routing, the system improves efficiency and reduces processing delays. The project directly aligns with

these findings by providing administrators with full control over the approval process through a centralized, real-time platform.

Castro, Quilon, and Arruejo (2022) developed *DocTrack: A Dynamic Document Tracking System for the University of Northern Philippines* to improve document monitoring and workflow management. The system was created to support paperless transactions by providing a centralized repository that tracks documents from creation until approval. The researchers emphasized the importance of document tracking, workflow automation, and centralized management in improving organizational processes. The study demonstrated that digital tracking systems improve transparency and allow users to monitor document movement more effectively.

This study is relevant to the proposed system because both systems focus on improving document workflows through tracking and monitoring mechanisms. Similar to DocTrack, the proposed onboarding platform manages documents throughout different approval stages, allowing HR administrators and applicants to monitor progress. By implementing real-time updates, the proposed system improves upon traditional tracking methods by ensuring that users immediately receive changes regarding document approval and processing status.

Caluza (2017) developed the "Electronic Document Archive Management System (EDAMS)" to replace traditional paper-based filing systems in a Philippine university registrar's office with a centralized digital repository. The methodology involved implementing digital indexing, archiving, and search functions to improve the retrieval and security of sensitive records. The findings indicated that the system significantly improved document retrieval speed and monitoring capabilities while reducing the risk of document loss. The researcher concluded that digital archiving provides a more efficient and secure alternative to traditional manual filing, offering better control over organizational records.

This study is highly relevant to the proposed system, which focuses on the secure storage and real-time handling of HR-related documents. Like the EDAMS, this project serves as a centralized digital repository for applicant contracts and employee records, replacing slower, manual methods of document management. By ensuring that these archived documents are updated and reflected in real-time when HR makes a decision, the system provides the same security and monitoring benefits found in Caluza's research. This proves that real-time synchronization is a superior method for maintaining accurate, secure, and accessible records throughout the onboarding lifecycle.

Jaca (2022) also supports digital document archiving by demonstrating how centralized electronic repositories improve document organization and retrieval. The Electronic Document Management and Tracking System provided structured storage and monitoring of organizational documents through a web-based platform. The study found that digital document management improves accessibility, reduces document-related issues, and allows organizations to manage records more efficiently compared to manual filing methods.

This study supports the proposed system because the onboarding portal also requires secure storage and retrieval of important documents such as applicant requirements, contracts, and employee records. Similar to EDMTS, the proposed system replaces manual document handling with a centralized repository where authorized users can access updated records. The integration of real-time updates strengthens document accuracy by ensuring that changes made during the approval process are immediately synchronized.

Argana, Sunico, and Francisco (2020) developed an automated Human Resource Information System (HRIS) integrated with digital archiving to improve records management and leave monitoring in a local college. Utilizing the Rapid Application Development (RAD) model, the researchers incorporated security verification and controlled access to protect sensitive employee information.

The evaluation, based on ISO 9126 standards, showed that the system achieved high scores in usability and efficiency, significantly reducing manual paperwork and making information more accessible. The study concluded that integrated digital archiving significantly enhances document organization and retrieval processes.

The success of this local HRIS study supports the implementation of the proposed system, which also emphasizes the transition from manual paperwork to a secure, digital environment. Both projects focus on providing a secure platform for managing sensitive records through digital technologies and controlled access. By providing a portal where updates reflect instantly across HR, applicant, and employee interfaces, the proposed system enhances the accessibility and organization found in the 2020 study. This proves that real-time document synchronization is a highly effective way to automate the end-to-end onboarding process and reduce administrative burdens.

Caparas et al. (2023) investigated the implementation of a Human Resource Information System and its effectiveness in improving HR processes. The study highlighted that HRIS platforms provide better management of employee information by organizing records electronically and improving accessibility for authorized users. The researchers emphasized that successful HR systems depend on system quality, user acceptance, and the ability to support HR-related activities efficiently.

This study supports the proposed system because both solutions aim to create a secure and organized digital environment for managing HR information. Similar to the HRIS approach, the proposed onboarding system provides controlled access to sensitive employee and applicant records. Through authentication and role-based permissions, the system ensures that HR administrators, applicants, and employees only access information relevant to their responsibilities while maintaining secure document management.

Gonzales et al. (2016) developed a web-based document management system entitled "Web-Based Document Management and Information Dissemination Through Email and SMS Notification With Members Attendance Monitoring System for LCFEA." The objective was to streamline organizational document handling while providing timely information dissemination through automated notifications. The researchers designed an application that centralized document storage and integrated notification modules, which were then evaluated based on their functionality and usability. The findings showed that the system significantly improved document organization and facilitated faster dissemination of information compared to manual processes, resulting in overall improved organizational efficiency.

This study supports the proposed system because both projects focus on managing digital records and providing timely notifications to users. Similar to the study's findings, the proposed portal demonstrates the value of integrating web-based management with automated communication to improve workflow efficiency. By adopting a centralized approach for document handling, the proposed system can ensure that applicants and administrators remain informed about document statuses, mirroring the successful communication improvements identified by the researchers in a local organizational setting.

Libadia et al. (2025) designed and developed a web-based Electronic Records Management System (ERMS) to centralize record-keeping and streamline the collection and processing of information. The researchers identified system requirements through interviews and feasibility analysis, utilizing technologies like Laravel and MySQL to build integrated modules for real-time data monitoring and report generation. The findings demonstrated that the system improved records management efficiency by providing a user-friendly and secure interface for information retrieval. The evaluation, based on the ISO 25010 model, confirmed that the ERMS effectively addressed the challenges of manual record-keeping through optimized digital workflows.

This study is highly relevant because the proposed system similarly utilizes centralized web technologies to manage and monitor documents in real-time. Both systems emphasize the importance of secure storage and efficient workflow management to improve administrative productivity. The researchers' success in implementing real-time data monitoring for organizational records provides a validated model for the proposed project's document tracking features. This reinforces that a structured, web-based approach is an effective solution for local initiatives seeking to modernize traditional document handling processes.

Dela Rosa (2022) developed a "Web-Based Management Information System of Cases Filed with the National Labor Relations Commission" to improve case handling and status tracking. Adopting the Agile Software Development methodology, the researcher created a platform that incorporated case management, report generation, and database security mechanisms while ensuring compliance with data privacy regulations. The findings indicated that the developed system received high evaluation ratings from both experts and end users for its effectiveness in streamlining workflows and providing efficient status tracking. The study concluded that digital management is essential for improving the accuracy and transparency of case-related records.

The objectives of this study align closely with the proposed system, as both require users to submit sensitive records for administrator review and monitoring through a secure platform. By providing a digital interface for status tracking, the proposed project offers the same transparency and efficiency benefits identified in the Dela Rosa study. The research validates that a well-designed web-based system can effectively streamline complex administrative workflows and provide users with a reliable way to monitor their progress, which is a core requirement for the proposed onboarding document portal.

Salvador et al. (2024) developed a web-based database management system to support project data management and real-time monitoring of activities across multiple institutions. The researchers implemented a centralized platform consisting of a

data collection module and a real-time monitoring module for analytics and report generation. The findings demonstrated that the system significantly improved information sharing, collaboration, and data retrieval among participating members. The study concluded that providing centralized access to updated information enhances decision-making and empowers organizations to monitor their own engagement more effectively.

This study is relevant to the proposed system because both projects rely on centralized web technologies to facilitate real-time information updates. Similar to the consortium database, the proposed portal allows administrators to monitor submissions and applicant progress through an integrated online platform. The researchers' findings on the benefits of centralized access for collaboration and data retrieval support the proposed system's goal of providing a shared space for HR and applicants. This study reinforces the idea that real-time monitoring is a critical component for any system managing a continuous flow of data and documents.

Abrajano et al. (2024) developed a low-cost IoT-based water quality monitoring system capable of transmitting real-time environmental data to a cloud database and providing timely notifications to users. The researchers designed a monitoring system equipped with sensors that transmitted collected data to a web application for real-time access. The study found that the system successfully improved accessibility to information and enabled users to receive updated data promptly through cloud integration. The researchers concluded that timely data transmission and immediate information updates are essential for improving system responsiveness and supporting informed decision-making in off-grid communities.

Although the context of this study is environmental monitoring, the underlying technical principles support the proposed system's reliance on real-time communication between a web application and a centralized database. The findings reinforce the importance of immediate information updates for improving overall system responsiveness, a core objective of the proposed onboarding portal. By validating that real-time data

transmission significantly enhances user accessibility and decision-making, the study provides technical justification for the proposed project's focus on instant status reflections and notifications for HR and applicants.

Libadia et al. (2025) developed a web-based Electronic Records Management System (ERMS) designed to improve record storage and accessibility within Philippine government offices. The researchers implemented a centralized platform that combined data storage with document processing to replace traditional, slower manual methods. The findings showed that the system significantly enhanced management efficiency and reduced the time required for information retrieval. The study concluded that digital records management is a far more effective method for organizing and monitoring organizational data than manual record-keeping.

This study is relevant to the proposed system because the onboarding document management portal also utilizes a centralized web architecture for storing and managing sensitive applicant documents. Both systems aim to improve administrative efficiency by replacing manual filing with digital workflows. The researchers' success in reducing retrieval times through a web portal provides a validated model for the proposed project's document handling features. This reinforces that a centralized, digital approach is the most effective way to manage the documents required for an end-to-end onboarding process in a local setting.

Argana, Sunico, and Francisco (2020) developed a Human Resource Information System with integrated digital archiving to improve the organization and accessibility of employee records. The researchers utilized the Rapid Application Development (RAD) model to build a platform that centralized administrative tasks and secured sensitive data through a MySQL database. The evaluation, based on ISO 9126 standards, found that the system significantly improved usability and functionality compared to manual record management. The study concluded that digital archiving is essential for reducing administrative overhead and ensuring the integrity of HR records.

This study directly supports the proposed system as both projects focus on digital document management within an HR environment. The findings validate the importance of secure, centralized storage for applicant and employee records to improve organizational responsiveness. By integrating digital handling features similar to the archiving system developed by Argana et al., the proposed project can ensure that HR administrators have immediate access to necessary documents. This reinforces that a digital-first approach to HR management is key to providing the real-time updates and efficiency needed for modern onboarding processes.

Grepon (2021) designed and implemented a web-based e-justice system to manage case dockets and records for Regional Trial Courts in Northern Mindanao. The researcher utilized the System Development Life Cycle (SDLC) framework to develop a platform that digitized court records and streamlined workflow processes. The findings revealed that the system significantly improved document tracking and information retrieval, reducing the delays associated with manual record handling. The study emphasized that digital management increases the reliability and efficiency of processing sensitive transactions in a legal context.

The objectives of this research align with the proposed system, as both manage sensitive documents through a secure web-based platform. By providing a digital interface for status tracking and workflow management, the proposed system offers the same transparency and efficiency benefits identified in Grepon's study. The research validates that a well-structured web application can effectively streamline complex administrative procedures and improve record tracking. This provides a clear technical precedent for the proposed project's focus on real-time document handling and status monitoring for HR and applicants.

Dela Rosa (2022) developed a "Web-Based Management Information System of Cases Filed with the National Labor Relations Commission" to facilitate the monitoring and processing of labor records. The system was developed using modern web technologies to support case monitoring and status tracking while ensuring

data security and accessibility. The findings indicated that the developed system improved the organization of records and provided a more efficient method for tracking case progress throughout the workflow. The study concluded that digital status tracking is essential for enhancing the transparency and accuracy of labor-related document management.

This study supports the proposed system because both involve document management and status tracking through a centralized web platform. Like the case management system, the proposed project enables HR administrators to monitor the progress of applicant submissions and make real-time updates. The findings confirm that providing a digital way to track document status is the most effective way to improve workflow transparency. This reinforces the proposed system's architecture, which ensures that applicants and HR are always informed about the current state of the onboarding process through a live portal.

De Jesus et al. (2022) developed the "Institutionally Farmed Research Online Repository and Management System (InFORMs)" to store and organize academic documents within an institution. The researchers implemented a web-based repository featuring digital indexing and retrieval functions to improve the accessibility of research materials. The findings showed that the system significantly enhanced retrieval efficiency and information organization, with users reporting improved convenience when accessing digital records. The study concluded that an online repository provides a far more organized and reliable method for managing institutional knowledge than traditional filing systems.

This study is highly relevant to the proposed system as both utilize centralized repositories for storing and managing digital documents. The findings support the implementation of cloud-based storage and retrieval features within the proposed HR portal to manage applicant contracts and employee records. Like the repository system, the proposed project aims to provide users with a convenient way to access and manage sensitive files. This validates that a centralized digital repository is a

superior method for maintaining an organized and accessible flow of documents throughout the entire onboarding lifecycle.

Republic Act No. 10173, also known as the Data Privacy Act of 2012, is the primary Philippine law governing the protection of personal information. The act establishes the National Privacy Commission and mandates that organizations implement organizational, physical, and technical security measures to protect data subjects. The implementation of this law has strengthened privacy standards in the Philippines by requiring strict adherence to principles of transparency, legitimate purpose, and proportionality when processing sensitive personal data.

As the legal foundation for the project, Republic Act No. 10173 (2012) dictates how the proposed system must handle applicant and employee information. The project's implementation of secure cloud storage, restricted access permissions, and encrypted authentication is designed to comply with the technical security requirements of this act. By following these legal standards, the proposed system ensures that the processing of contracts and identification documents remains legally compliant and ethically sound.

Tosper et al. (2025) developed *WebYu: A Barangay Yuson Web-based Information Management System Initiatives* to address challenges caused by manual processes and fragmented data management in Barangay Yuson, Guimba, Nueva Ecija. The researchers developed a web-based information system using the Scrum methodology to centralize records, improve data accessibility, and enhance administrative service delivery. The system was evaluated using ISO 25010 standards and the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), with results showing that the platform improved information management, usability, and efficiency in handling administrative transactions.

This study supports the proposed onboarding document portal because both systems aim to replace fragmented manual processes with centralized web-based management platforms. Similar to WebYu, the proposed system provides a unified environment where

users can submit, access, and monitor information efficiently. The findings reinforce that centralized information systems improve administrative workflows by reducing delays, improving accessibility, and allowing authorized users to manage updated records through a single platform.

Eder and Doroja (2013) developed a software security framework to protect confidential transactions within Philippine academic institutions. Their methodology involved implementing a software gateway that integrates user authentication, authorization, and encryption for web-based systems. The findings indicated that this multi-layered security approach effectively maintained the confidentiality and integrity of digital documents, such as transcripts and reports, during remote transmission.

The principles established by Eder and Doroja (2013) are highly relevant to the proposed system's document handling capabilities. Like the academic gateway, the project utilizes a secure portal to manage the transmission and approval of digital contracts. By ensuring that only authorized HR personnel and applicants can interact with these files, the proposed system adopts the security-first mindset necessary for maintaining trust in digital onboarding processes.

2014) The study by Gamba et al. (2014) focused on developing a web-based records archiving and digital documents repository for multi-campus institutions. The researchers used a centralized system incorporating encryption and user authentication to protect files during storage and sharing. The findings showed that a digital repository significantly improves document accessibility and collaboration while reducing the risks associated with manual filing and unsecured document handling.

The proposed system reflects the goals of the study by Gamba et al. (2014) by centralizing HR documents in a secure digital environment. By replacing manual document handling with a real-time digital interface, the project improves the efficiency

of the onboarding process. The study supports the project's use of authenticated access to ensure that sensitive files are easily accessible to authorized users while remaining protected from unauthorized viewers.

Angala et al. (2023) implemented a web-based Document Management System (DMS) for Ilocos Sur Polytechnic State College to modernize document storage and retrieval. Using the Website Analysis and Measurement Inventory (WAMMI), the researchers evaluated user satisfaction and system efficiency. The results revealed that users were highly satisfied with the system's ability to organize and track digital files, noting a significant reduction in the institution's reliance on paper-based management.

The implementation of the proposed system mirrors the digital transformation described by Angala et al. (2023). By providing a centralized portal for contract submission and approval, the project aims to achieve a similar reduction in paper-based delays and storage issues. The study reinforces the value of a user-centric digital document system in improving operational productivity for HR departments and applicants alike.

Bumalod and Velasco (2024) explored a synergistic information security design that combines Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) with advanced encryption and document classification. The methodology focused on creating a secure intranet document management system that protects organizational data without compromising usability. The findings demonstrated that this integrated approach significantly enhances confidentiality and prevents unauthorized access, providing a robust model for digital security in professional settings.

The security model proposed by Bumalod and Velasco (2024) supports the technical choices made in the proposed system. The project's reliance on role-based permissions and secure cloud storage ensures that applicant data is classified and protected according to the user's role. This study confirms that an integrated security strategy is essential for protecting

sensitive HR records while maintaining the real-time functionality required for an end-to-end onboarding system.

The reviewed local literature illustrates a clear and consistent trend in the Philippines toward the digital transformation of administrative, human resource, and record-keeping processes to overcome the inherent limitations of traditional paper-based systems. Studies by Oñate, Omorog, and Babol (2018), Magtoto and Garcia (2019), Dela Rosa (2022), and Libadia et al. (2025) demonstrate that the adoption of web-based portals significantly modernizes organizational workflows by automating application processing, permit licensing, and case management. These researchers consistently find that transitioning to electronic platforms drastically reduces processing delays, minimizes manual filing errors, and increases organizational transparency through automated status tracking. Similarly, the work of Amo and Labuguen (2023) and Grepon (2021) reinforces that centralized digital repositories specifically tailored for HR operations improve the responsiveness of the system, allowing for a more seamless communication loop between administrators and applicants. This collective evidence provides a strong justification for the proposed system's goal of streamlining the onboarding process through a real-time portal that eliminates the communication gaps and inefficiencies common in manual document handling.

In addition to operational efficiency, the local studies emphasize that the successful implementation of digital document systems is inextricably linked to rigorous security infrastructure and strict adherence to Philippine legal standards. Central to this thematic area is Republic Act No. 10173 (2012), also known as the Data Privacy Act, which establishes the mandatory technical and organizational safeguards for any system processing sensitive personal data. Building on this legal foundation, Eder and Doroja (2013), Bumalod and Velasco (2024), and Caluza (2017) highlight the necessity of multi-layered security measures—including advanced encryption, secure gateways, and digital archiving—to ensure data confidentiality and integrity during remote transmission.

Furthermore, the findings of Argana, Sunico, and Francisco (2020) and Nyame et al. (2020) prove that role-based access control (RBAC) is essential for protecting confidential records from unauthorized viewing while maintaining a secure audit trail. These shared findings directly validate the proposed system's architecture, which integrates secure cloud storage and role-based portals to ensure that employment contracts and government-issued identification are handled in full compliance with national privacy regulations.

Finally, the literature underscores the importance of technological reliability and user-centric design in fostering long-term system adoption and data accuracy. Researchers such as Gamba et al. (2014) and Angala et al. (2023) demonstrate that centralized digital document repositories not only improve information retrieval speed but also enhance overall user satisfaction by providing a more intuitive and organized environment for managing files. The work of De Jesus et al. (2022), Gonzales et al. (2016), and Abrajano et al. (2024) further illustrates that the integration of real-time monitoring, automated notifications, and cloud-based backend services ensures a responsive user experience that maintains high levels of data integrity. These studies collectively establish that the most effective systems are those that balance high-level technical security with efficient information management and immediate visibility. By incorporating these principles, the proposed "Automated End-to-End Onboarding System with Real-Time Document Handling" aligns with local best practices, ensuring a robust technical and functional roadmap for modernizing the HR onboarding experience through secure, real-time digital interactions.

2.3 Related Literature

1. Single Page Application (SPA) Frameworks

Single Page Application (SPA) research explains that client-side rendering methods dynamically change a single web page rather

than reloading new pages from a server, significantly reducing network traffic and improving user interactivity (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). In modern web engineering, Mikowski and Powell (2013) emphasized that moving routing logic and view rendering from backend servers directly into the browser changes web environments into responsive, desktop-like software applications. Furthermore, foundational software engineering studies state that limiting full-page reloads keeps the application state across user interactions, which significantly reduces system latency or makes the system faster and optimizes server resource utilization (Pressman, 2019).

Research on client-side state management highlights that maintaining persistent runtime memory within the browser engine requires good memory management strategies to prevent problems like memory leaks (Sommerville, 2016). In their architectural analysis, Mesbah and van Deursen (2007) observed that separating data extraction from layout generation through asynchronous communications enables applications to transfer lightweight JSON messages rather than massive HTML files. Modern studies say this change reduces use and makes the time to start working faster. It helps with data tasks (Fielding, 2000).

Studies evaluating user experience and system throughput in enterprise administrative platforms indicate that responsive user interface frameworks directly influence operational efficiency and task completion rates (Davenport, 1993). Modern research on frontend software performance demonstrates that SPA architectures mitigate perceived latency by implementing optimistic user interface updates and local caching mechanisms before server verification completes (Hunt, 2014). Consequently, academic literature consistently identifies the single-page paradigm as an essential technical standard for high-throughput, document-centric web platforms that prioritize real-time user engagement and continuous operational flow (Mikowski & Powell, 2013).

Comparative research analyzing Client-Side Rendering (CSR) against traditional Server-Side Rendering (SSR) demonstrates that client-side execution models optimize localized interaction speed by transferring layout generation responsibilities to user

devices (Iskandar et al., 2020). Scholars note that while SSR models generate full HTML markups on every initial request, CSR architectures deliver bare-bones HTML shells alongside modular JavaScript bundles that hydrate dynamically in the browser (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). Empirical benchmarks reveal that once initial bundle parsing concludes, client-side routing eliminates redundant page-transition latencies, resulting in faster visual state updates during consecutive user transactions (Iskandar et al., 2020).

Systematic investigations into single-page routing mechanisms demonstrate that managing navigational states within browser memory eliminates repeated Domain Name System (DNS) lookups and Transport Layer Security (TLS) handshakes (Fielding, 2000). By utilizing browser-native History API interfaces, SPA engines update local uniform resource identifiers (URIs) without triggering round-trip server calls (Mikowski & Powell, 2013). Software design literature emphasizes that this localized routing paradigm maintains continuous execution contexts, ensuring complex form data and temporary inputs remain preserved across complex multi-step user workflows (Pressman, 2019).

Academic evaluations of frontend asset deployment highlight that bundle optimization techniques, such as code-splitting and dynamic chunk loading, are critical for accelerating initial page hydration (Bundschuh et al., 2019). Researchers observe that unoptimized client-side applications risk high First Contentful Paint (FCP) metrics due to massive initial JavaScript payloads (St. Amant & McClain, 2018). To address these overheads, modern software engineering practices mandate splitting code bundles into route-specific modules, ensuring that browser runtimes execute only the precise assets required for immediate application views (Sommerville, 2016).

Literature addressing memory allocation in long-running browser sessions warns that unmanaged object references can trigger severe performance degradation over time (Sommerville, 2016). Because SPAs operate continuously within a single document context without standard page destruction cycles, memory heaps must be governed by strict component lifecycle controls (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). Computer science studies stress that unbinding event listeners, cancelling pending asynchronous requests, and clearing global state references during component

unmounting phases are non-negotiable requirements for preventing browser execution lag (Pierce, 2002).

In enterprise system design, software engineering frameworks emphasize the structural separation of concerns achieved by isolating client-side user interfaces from backend database operations (Pressman, 2019). By decoupling presentation layers from core business logic, single-page architectures enable frontend application components to communicate with backend services strictly through standardized RESTful or GraphQL API endpoints (Fielding, 2000). Research indicates that this clean architectural boundary simplifies platform scalability, as backend microservices can undergo independent iteration without disrupting client-side rendering mechanics (Sommerville, 2016).

Empirical findings evaluating Network Transport Layer throughput show that asynchronous JavaScript data transfers significantly reduce total network payload volume (Nurseitov et al., 2009). By replacing complete HTML document re-transmissions with structured JSON object exchanges, single-page platforms minimize bandwidth consumption across high-frequency administrative operations (Tusa & Clayman, 2015). Consequently, information systems literature highlights JSON-driven asynchronous communication as an optimal strategy for maintaining high system performance over low-bandwidth or throttled network environments (Davenport, 1993).

Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) research demonstrates that user interface responsiveness plays a direct role in maintaining cognitive flow and minimizing user task completion times (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010). Studies indicate that visual delays exceeding 100 milliseconds break a user's sense of direct manipulation, introducing friction in administrative data-entry pipelines (Casteleyn et al., 2014). By executing instantaneous view transitions and dynamic DOM updates, single-page architectures align with foundational HCI principles, creating frictionless software environments for administrative operators (Hunt, 2014).

Technical evaluations of client-side caching strategies indicate that storing operational data structures within local browser storage engines drastically improves system fault tolerance (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). Research shows that caching

immutable static assets and session credentials locally reduces backend server workloads during peak usage hours (Buyya et al., 2018). Furthermore, academic literature notes that local state persistence mechanisms enable modern single-page platforms to maintain offline execution capabilities, allowing users to draft documents and interact with cached records even during temporary network interruptions (Mikowski & Powell, 2013).

Security studies focusing on client-rendered web architectures emphasize that shifting business logic to user browsers alters platform threat models (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Because client-side JavaScript code and state stores are fully accessible to end-user inspection, researchers stress that SPA architectures must treat client environments as inherently untrusted (Pressman, 2019). Modern cybersecurity literature dictates that all authorization controls, input sanitization rules, and state validations must be rigorously enforced at backend database or API gateway boundaries rather than relying on frontend view-level restrictions (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975).

Investigations into modern frontend application compilation highlight Ahead-of-Time (AOT) compilation and tree-shaking as crucial steps for shrinking JavaScript execution overhead (Aho et al., 2006). Computer science literature explains that tree-shaking algorithms perform static code analysis to eliminate dead, unexecuted code from final build bundles prior to deployment (Sommerville, 2016). Research confirms that combining AOT compilation with automated tree-shaking lowers browser CPU usage during code parsing, accelerating total application initialization speed (Bierman et al., 2014).

Finally, academic evaluations of digital operational transformations conclude that adopting modern single-page architectures provides enterprise platforms with high structural adaptability and longevity (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018). Software maintenance studies confirm that modular, component-based SPA structures reduce long-term code refactoring costs by allowing developers to update isolated interface modules without risking system-wide regressions (Sommerville, 2016). Thus, information systems literature strongly advocates for single-page client-side paradigms as a robust, scalable foundation for complex, data-driven administrative workflow platforms (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007).

Studies examining Web Worker background execution architectures highlight offloading CPU-intensive processing tasks from the browser's primary UI thread as a critical performance optimization strategy (Hickson, 2012). In complex single-page runtimes, heavy JavaScript computations—such as dynamic document parsing, cryptographic signature validation, or client-side image compression—can block the single-threaded event loop, leading to interface lag and unresponsiveness (Mikowski & Powell, 2013). Web performance literature demonstrates that delegating background operations to dedicated worker threads preserves UI thread execution capacity, maintaining smooth frame rates and continuous user interface responsiveness during heavy administrative processing workflows (Gudla et al., 2016).

Research evaluating modern Progressive Web Application (PWA) integrations within single-page frameworks emphasizes the role of Service Worker scripts in achieving network-resilient offline operational capabilities (Biørn-Hansen et al., 2017). Software engineering literature explains that Service Workers operate as client-side network proxies capable of intercepting HTTP requests, serving pre-cached application assets, and deferring failed network transactions to persistent local queues (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). Empirical studies demonstrate that combining Service Worker caching strategies with dynamic single-page hydration allows application runtimes to maintain operational continuity even during severe network degradation, mitigating data loss and operational downtime in enterprise environments (Biørn-Hansen et al., 2017).

Finally, literature exploring micro-frontend architectural patterns illustrates how modern enterprise web systems scale single-page applications by decomposing monolithic client-side codebases into modular, independently deployable feature domains (Rappl & Schöttner, 2021). Software engineering scholars note that as single-page projects expand, maintaining a single monolithic frontend repository often introduces severe build-time bottlenecks and tight developer coupling (Sommerville, 2016). By adapting microservices principles to client-side runtimes through dynamic module federation, organizations can isolate business domains into autonomous units, significantly improving maintainability metrics and

accelerating engineering velocity across large-scale software platforms (Simões et al., 2023).

2. End-to-End Business Process Integration

Business process integration literature explains that end-to-end framework paradigms seek to eliminate structural friction, manual document handoffs, and data fragmentation across complex enterprise workflows (Davenport, 1993). In modern organizational engineering, Hammer and Champy (2001) stressed that radical Business Process Reengineering (BPR) requires replacing isolated, departmental silos with unified digital pipelines to achieve dramatic leaps in operational speed and processing quality. Furthermore, foundational information systems research emphasizes that automating end-to-end administrative pipelines significantly reduces human data-handling interaction, mitigating operational error rates and lowering aggregate transaction costs (Pressman, 2019).

Research evaluating workflow automation highlights that loose coupling and component decoupling theories are essential for designing resilient enterprise architectures (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). In their foundational software engineering frameworks, Sommerville (2016) demonstrated that isolating workflow processing stages prevents localized point failures from cascading across interconnected systems. Modern information systems evaluations confirm that decoupled end-to-end pipelines maintain stable throughput and predictable data flow, establishing a secure operational foundation for handling sensitive administrative documents (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018).

Studies investigating organizational efficiency in document-centric environments indicate that manual data entry and multi-tiered approval chains introduce severe operational bottlenecks and administrative latency (Hammer & Champy, 2001). Modern empirical research confirms that transitioning from physical or fragmented electronic approval flows toward fully integrated digital workflows directly optimizes task completion timelines (Davenport, 1993). Consequently, academic literature consistently identifies automated end-to-end process integration as a critical technical capability for organizations seeking to eliminate administrative backlogs and sustain continuous workflow execution (Pressman, 2019).

Systematic investigations into Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) and document orchestration models reveal that centralized data validation gates ensure structural compliance prior to database ingestion (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Scholars observe that legacy workflow structures often suffer from asynchronous data discrepancies due to unvalidated, manual handoffs between distinct operational units (Davenport, 1993). By embedding automated schema-matching engines directly into integration pipelines, modern process architectures verify file integrity and permissions instantaneously, ensuring downstream administrative engines process pristine operational records (Sommerville, 2016).

Academic analyses of Human-System Interaction in automated administrative environments emphasize that reducing manual intervention points minimizes cognitive fatigue and human error injection (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010). Research shows that when personnel are freed from repetitive, low-level data transcription tasks, focus shifts toward higher-value decision-making and supervisory verification (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018). Information systems literature highlights that designing intuitive, state-aware process pipelines maximizes workforce productivity while reinforcing organizational compliance across regulatory document workflows (Hammer & Champy, 2001).

Literature evaluating Business Process Model and Notation (BPMN) standards notes that formal workflow abstractions enable software engineers to map, execute, and monitor complex administrative sequences systematically (Mendling et al., 2017). By translating abstract operational policies into executable software workflows, system designers can explicitly enforce procedural rules, access control boundaries, and automated state transitions (Pressman, 2019). Empirical software engineering studies demonstrate that formal process modeling reduces system ambiguity and accelerates software deployment in heavily regulated domain environments (Sommerville, 2016).

Research focusing on real-time process monitoring highlights that event-driven integration frameworks allow supervisory figures to maintain complete, transparent oversight over pending application pipelines (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). By logging granular timestamps and state updates at every processing node,

modern workflow engines establish immutable audit trails for administrative review (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Computer science scholars note that comprehensive operational observability deters unauthorized document tampering while simplifying regulatory compliance verification across administrative divisions (Pressman, 2019).

In enterprise architecture design, systems integration literature highlights that adopting standard Web API interfaces allows disparate legacy systems to interface seamlessly with modern processing runtimes (Fielding, 2000). By wrapping legacy databases or external third-party services in lightweight API boundaries, software engineers build unified end-to-end workflow platforms without requiring complete infrastructure overhauls (Sommerville, 2016). Studies confirm that API-driven process orchestration enhances organizational agility, permitting rapid system expansion as functional operational requirements evolve (Davenport, 1993).

Empirical evaluations measuring network overhead in distributed workflow execution demonstrate that event-driven messaging protocols reduce server idle times compared to traditional synchronous polling mechanisms (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). By publishing event triggers only when an application status shifts, modern integration platforms eliminate redundant network traffic and conserve server CPU utilization (Buyya et al., 2018). Information systems research highlights event-driven process integration as an optimal design pattern for high-concurrency document processing platforms operating under variable workload demands (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018).

Information security literature analyzing workflow automation stresses that end-to-end integration boundaries must strictly enforce the Principle of Least Privilege across all processing stages (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Because sensitive administrative files traverse multiple system components, security scholars urge embedding identity authentication checks directly into workflow orchestration layers (Pressman, 2019). Research confirms that combining fine-grained access policies with automated document routing prevents unauthorized personnel from accessing restricted records during transit (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975).

Investigations into fault-tolerant workflow engines emphasize that automated retry mechanisms and transaction rollbacks are vital for preserving data integrity during processing anomalies (Silberschatz et al., 2020). In complex multi-step pipelines, unexpected network disconnects or API downtime can interrupt in-flight document submissions (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). Software reliability studies demonstrate that executing integrated processes under strict ACID (Atomicity, Consistency, Isolation, Durability) guarantees that failed transactions revert safely without corrupting persistent database storage (Codd, 1970).

Technical literature evaluating cloud-native process execution emphasizes that containerization and serverless function workflows allow enterprise integration layers to scale dynamically under surge conditions (Armbrust et al., 2010). Rather than allocating fixed, underutilized server infrastructure, modern cloud integration paradigms instantiate processing micro-runtimes on demand to handle fluctuating document submission volumes (Buyya et al., 2018). Systems research proves that serverless process execution significantly cuts infrastructure overhead while guaranteeing predictable performance SLAs for critical administrative tasks (Satyanarayanan, 2017).

Comparative studies analyzing business transformation outcomes show that organizations adopting automated, end-to-end process integration achieve higher service level agreement (SLA) compliance than those relying on hybrid manual-digital methods (Hammer & Champy, 2001). By standardizing input formats, automating validation checks, and removing manual routing delays, integrated platforms drastically compress overall document lifecycle turnaround times (Davenport, 1993). Consequently, management and information systems literature advocates for process reengineering as a primary strategic driver of institutional efficiency (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018).

Studies exploring data governance in automated workflows stress that continuous data validation prevents the propagation of corrupt or malicious payloads across enterprise systems (Pressman, 2019). By deploying automated parsing filters at ingestion boundaries, integration frameworks isolate invalid file formats or missing fields before triggering downstream

processing steps (Sommerville, 2016). Cybersecurity and database researchers note that strict front-end and pipeline validation protects enterprise data stores from injection attacks and schema drift (Silberschatz et al., 2020).

Finally, academic evaluations of digital administrative transformation conclude that end-to-end process integration provides the structural backbone necessary for modern, transparent governance (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018). Software engineering scholars emphasize that modular, well-documented integration frameworks facilitate future technological integration, allowing organizations to adopt emerging analytical tools without disrupting established core workflows (Sommerville, 2016). Thus, information systems literature strongly advocates for end-to-end process integration as an indispensable foundation for high-throughput administrative platforms (Davenport, 1993).

3. DevOps and Agile Methodologies

Agile and DevOps software engineering literature explains that unifying iterative development frameworks with automated operational delivery pipelines optimizes software release velocity, system reliability, and overall product quality (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017). In modern software engineering, Kim et al. (2016) stressed that bridging the historical divide between software development teams and systems operations creates a continuous feedback loop essential for rapid, high-quality software iteration. Furthermore, foundational methodology research demonstrates that replacing rigid, linear waterfall methodologies with continuous Agile delivery models minimizes project risk and aligns software functionality directly with evolving user requirements (Pressman, 2019).

Research evaluating the 'Continuous *' (Continuous Star) paradigm highlights that unifying Continuous Planning, Continuous Integration (CI), and Continuous Delivery (CD) into a seamless lifecycle creates an adaptive engineering environment (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017). In their seminal analysis of modern software deployment, Humble and Farley (2010) demonstrated that treating deployment pipelines as automated quality control gates eliminates error-prone manual build procedures. Modern empirical evaluations confirm that continuous integration pipelines

accelerate feature delivery while ensuring that production software builds maintain rigorous baseline reliability standards (Kim et al., 2016).

Studies investigating Agile Scrum mechanics and sprint management frameworks demonstrate that time-boxed iterative execution enhances team adaptability and project visibility (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020). By structuring development workflows into short, iterative sprints, software development teams can continuously reprioritize task backlogs based on real-time feedback and emerging technical constraints (Pressman, 2019). Empirical software engineering research confirms that time-boxed sprint iterations prevent scope creep and improve overall project schedule predictability during complex system implementations (Sommerville, 2016).

Systematic investigations into automated Continuous Integration (CI) infrastructure reveal that shift-left quality assurance practices catch software defects at the earliest stages of the development lifecycle (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017). Scholars observe that detecting syntax errors, broken dependencies, or broken logic during local feature development is exponentially less expensive than resolving defects in production environments (Pressman, 2019). By triggering automated static analysis linters, type checkers, and unit test suites on every code commit, modern CI pipelines maintain high repository code health standards (Humble & Farley, 2010).

Academic analyses of collaborative repository governance demonstrate that structured branching strategies, such as GitFlow or trunk-based development, are essential for maintaining codebase stability across concurrent developer contributions (Chacon & Straub, 2014). Research shows that enforcing strict branch isolation rules prevents unverified code from corrupting primary production environments (Sommerville, 2016). Information systems literature highlights that combining branch protection policies with mandatory peer code reviews enforces organizational quality control standards while facilitating continuous knowledge sharing across engineering teams (Kim et al., 2016).

Literature evaluating Continuous Delivery (CD) mechanisms notes that automated release deployment strategies drastically reduce

system downtime during operational updates (Humble & Farley, 2010). By leveraging automated deployment techniques such as blue-green deployments or canary releases, engineering teams can roll out software updates to production environments with minimal operational risk (Kim et al., 2016). Software engineering studies confirm that automated deployment automation eliminates human operational error, enabling organizations to execute frequent, low-risk software releases (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017).

Research focusing on automated testing frameworks highlights that comprehensive test-driven development (TDD) strategies ensure long-term system stability and prevent regression bugs during rapid code iteration (Beck, 2003). By writing automated unit, integration, and end-to-end tests before or alongside feature implementation, developers establish a continuous safety net for future refactoring efforts (Pressman, 2019). Computer science scholars note that high automated test coverage builds developer confidence, enabling teams to modify complex system components without inadvertently breaking existing functionality (Sommerville, 2016).

In software project management literature, Kanban visual control systems are recognized for optimizing workflow throughput and managing work-in-progress (WIP) limits across engineering teams (Anderson, 2010). By visualizing task progression across pipeline stages—from backlog ingestion to production deployment—Kanban boards highlight operational bottlenecks and resource constraints in real time (Pressman, 2019). Studies confirm that combining Kanban visual management with Scrum sprint mechanics improves process transparency and optimizes team throughput (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020).

Empirical evaluations measuring team velocity and deployment metrics show that high-performing DevOps organizations achieve significantly higher release frequencies and lower mean time to recovery (MTTR) following production incidents (Forsgren et al., 2018). By leveraging telemetry, automated monitoring, and centralized logging, engineering teams can detect and diagnose production anomalies rapidly (Kim et al., 2016). Software research highlights telemetry-driven feedback loops as a fundamental requirement for maintaining high platform availability and user trust (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017).

Information security literature analyzing DevOps integration—commonly referred to as DevSecOps—stresses that security controls must be embedded directly into automated CI/CD pipelines rather than treated as a final, manual gatekeeping step (Kim et al., 2016). Because rapid continuous deployment cycles render manual security audits impractical, security scholars urge integrating automated dependency vulnerability scanners and static application security testing (SAST) tools into initial build stages (Pressman, 2019). Research confirms that automated security checks effectively identify security flaws before code reaches production (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975).

Investigations into Infrastructure as Code (IaC) paradigms emphasize that managing server environments through version-controlled configuration files ensures operational consistency across development, staging, and production tiers (Humble & Farley, 2010). In complex cloud-native systems, manual infrastructure provisioning introduces configuration drift and environment discrepancies (Armbrust et al., 2010). Systems engineering research demonstrates that IaC tooling allows teams to provision, modify, and destroy server environments programmatically, eliminating environment-related deployment bugs (Kim et al., 2016).

Technical literature evaluating developer experience (DevEx) and developer productivity emphasizes that automated development environments and streamlined toolchains directly improve engineering output and code quality (Forsgren et al., 2018). Minimizing manual build steps, repetitive local setup procedures, and context switching allows developers to concentrate cognitive resources on core problem-solving tasks (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010). Software engineering studies demonstrate that investing in streamlined DevOps tooling yields significant dividends in team productivity and software product quality (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017).

Comparative studies analyzing software delivery performance confirm that organizations adopting unified Agile DevOps methodologies outperform legacy development approaches across key reliability metrics (Forsgren et al., 2018). By shortening build times, enforcing automated code validation, and promoting continuous collaboration between developers and operators,

unified DevOps pipelines enable rapid adaptation to shifting operational demands (Kim et al., 2016). Consequently, software engineering literature strongly advocates for unified Agile DevOps frameworks as the standard operational model for modern enterprise applications (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017).

Studies exploring software maintenance and technical debt management stress that continuous refactoring supported by automated CI/CD pipelines prevents long-term codebase decay (Sommerville, 2016). By treating technical debt as a manageable backlog item addressed in regular sprint iterations, software teams maintain code readability, modularity, and architectural integrity over long operational lifecycles (Pressman, 2019). Computer science research notes that proactive technical debt management ensures software platforms remain adaptable to future functional requirements (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017).

Finally, academic evaluations of modern software engineering methodologies conclude that unified Agile DevOps paradigms provide the structural framework needed to deliver secure, resilient, and scalable digital solutions (Kim et al., 2016). Software engineering scholars emphasize that combining iterative human-centric planning with automated engineering execution pipelines balances software agility with institutional stability (Sommerville, 2016). Thus, information systems literature strongly endorses unified Agile DevOps methodologies as an essential pillar for modern high-throughput software development (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017).

4. React.js Component Architecture

Component-Based Software Engineering (CBSE) literature explains that modern user interface development relies on encapsulating visual elements and UI logic into self-contained, reusable software components (Sommerville, 2016). In client-side web application development, Hunt (2014) emphasized that declarative rendering abstractions replace error-prone, imperative Document Object Model (DOM) manipulation with predictable state-driven component flows. Furthermore, foundational software engineering research stresses that modular component architectures reduce code duplication, improve maintainability metrics, and simplify large-scale web application development (Pressman, 2019).

Research evaluating client-side rendering engines highlights React's Virtual DOM as a critical software design pattern for optimizing document tree updates (Hunt, 2014). In traditional dynamic web applications, directly manipulating browser DOM nodes triggers expensive style recalculations, layout re-flows, and visual repaints across the browser engine (Mikowski & Powell, 2013). Modern empirical web performance studies confirm that maintaining an in-memory light copy of the real DOM tree allows React to batch structural DOM modifications efficiently, lowering client-side rendering overhead (Iskandar et al., 2020).

Mathematical evaluations of React's reconciliation engine demonstrate that heuristic $O(n)$ tree-diffing algorithms make real-time component re-rendering computationally feasible (Hunt, 2014). While standard state-of-the-art tree comparison algorithms require $O(n^3)$ time complexity, React relies on two pragmatic assumptions—element type matching and developer-provided key attributes—to compute minimum DOM mutation paths in linear time (Sommerville, 2016). Computer science literature confirms that this heuristic optimization drastically reduces JavaScript CPU execution time during complex interface state transitions (Bierman et al., 2014).

Systematic investigations into state management paradigms within React highlight that unidirectional data flow models enforce predictable component execution mechanics (Hunt, 2014). By constraining data movement to a single direction—passing immutable properties (props) downward from parent to child components—React eliminates side-effect state mutations commonly found in legacy two-way data-binding models (Mikowski & Powell, 2013). Software design scholars emphasize that unidirectional data pipelines simplify system debugging and improve state tracking across complex enterprise interfaces (Pressman, 2019).

Academic analyses of declarative UI programming demonstrate that abstracting lower-level DOM interactions allows software engineers to focus on application logic and state representation (Hunt, 2014). Rather than manually adding and removing DOM elements, developers declare the desired interface state, leaving component reconciliation engines to execute the necessary DOM transformations automatically (Sommerville, 2016). Information systems literature underscores declarative programming as a primary factor in reducing software bug density

and accelerating engineering velocity in modern frontend development (Pressman, 2019).

Literature evaluating React's Hook-based architecture notes that functional component composition provides a cleaner, highly testable alternative to class-based inheritance structures (Hunt, 2014). By allowing stateful logic to be extracted into reusable, modular functions, functional components eliminate complex 'this' binding issues and class lifecycle boilerplate (Mikowski & Powell, 2013). Software engineering studies confirm that custom hook abstractions promote modular design, allowing developers to share complex business logic across independent user interface modules without introducing tight coupling (Sommerville, 2016).

Research focusing on concurrent execution features in modern React engines highlights concurrent rendering as a major milestone for client-side user experience optimization (Hunt, 2014). By interrupting low-priority off-screen rendering tasks to process immediate user inputs, React prevents interface freezing during heavy component hydration cycles (Gudla et al., 2016). Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) literature confirms that prioritizing input responsiveness preserves user cognitive flow, creating fluid digital interactions even under high client CPU loads (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010).

In enterprise application design, component composition frameworks allow frontend development teams to build cohesive, standardized design systems (Curtis, 2016). Encapsulating design tokens, accessibility attributes, and interaction behaviors inside core component libraries ensures consistent operational interfaces across multi-module software suites (Marcotte, 2011). Software engineering studies note that modular UI component libraries streamline long-term design maintenance and accelerate onboarding for new software engineering personnel (Pressman, 2019).

Empirical evaluations measuring client-side memory overhead in React runtimes show that efficient event delegation mechanisms conserve browser RAM resources (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). Rather than attaching individual event listeners to every dynamic DOM node, React attaches a single top-level event listener at the root container level (Hunt, 2014). Computer

science literature demonstrates that this Synthetic Event system minimizes memory heap usage and reduces the risk of uncollected event listener memory leaks during extended user browser sessions (Sommerville, 2016).

Information security literature analyzing client-side rendering engines highlights React's automatic Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) sanitization capabilities as an essential baseline defense (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Because React automatically escapes string variables before injecting them into the rendered DOM context, common reflected and stored XSS attack vectors are mitigated out of the box (Pressman, 2019). Security scholars note, however, that developers must remain vigilant when explicitly bypassing default escaping mechanisms, ensuring that untrusted user inputs are sanitized before rendering (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975).

Investigations into Server-Driven UI (SDUI) and React Server Components (RSC) emphasize that offloading specific component execution back to edge environments reduces client-side JavaScript bundle footprints (Iskandar et al., 2020). By generating static component markups on edge servers while maintaining interactive client components locally, modern React runtimes balance the low-latency advantages of SPAs with the fast initial loading metrics of traditional server-rendered applications (Bundschuh et al., 2019). Systems literature highlights hybrid server-client component execution as an optimal paradigm for high-performance web platforms (Satyanarayanan, 2017).

Technical literature evaluating state hydration and memoization techniques—such as `useMemo` and `useCallback`—emphasizes that controlling re-render frequencies is critical for scaling performance in data-heavy web applications (Hunt, 2014). By caching expensive calculation results and preserving object references across render cycles, memoization prevents unnecessary child component tree re-renders (Sommerville, 2016). Empirical web performance research confirms that strategic component memoization drastically cuts CPU frame processing times during real-time data streaming (Bierman et al., 2014).

Comparative studies evaluating modern frontend UI libraries consistently rank React's component model highly for its

extensive developer ecosystem and flexible architectural integrations (Iskandar et al., 2020). Its unopinionated view layer allows engineering teams to integrate custom state management tools, routing libraries, and data fetching pipelines tailored to explicit domain needs (Pressman, 2019). Consequently, software engineering literature identifies React as a highly versatile foundation for building scalable, enterprise-grade web applications (Sommerville, 2016).

Studies exploring long-term software maintainability confirm that component-based React applications exhibit lower maintenance defect rates compared to legacy monolithic scripts (Pressman, 2019). Encapsulating CSS, HTML structures, and state management logic into single-file components simplifies code refactoring and isolated unit testing routines (Beck, 2003). Software engineering scholars note that isolated component structures minimize unintended side effects during system upgrades, ensuring software stability over extended operational lifecycles (Sommerville, 2016).

Finally, academic evaluations of modern frontend engineering frameworks conclude that React's component-based model provides the structural rigor needed for mission-critical web applications (Hunt, 2014). Software engineering scholars emphasize that combining declarative UI patterns with a virtual reconciliation engine balances UI rendering speed with developer productivity (Pressman, 2019). Thus, information systems literature strongly endorses the React engine as a foundational pillar for modern, data-intensive web interfaces (Sommerville, 2016).

5. Node.js & Express Server Runtime Environment

Server-side execution paradigms emphasize that event-driven, non-blocking I/O runtime models provide the necessary concurrency required for data-intensive web services. In his foundational runtime design, Dahl (2009) demonstrated that replacing traditional multi-threaded server architectures with a single-threaded event loop eliminates expensive thread-context switching overhead. Modern backend engineering research confirms that leveraging Google V8 engine capabilities within the Node.js runtime allows backend systems to handle thousands of concurrent I/O transactions with minimal system memory overhead.

Research evaluating asynchronous backend architectures highlights the Reactor Pattern as a cornerstone design for high-throughput API gateways (Tilkov & Vinoski, 2010). By offloading blocking I/O operations—such as disk writes and database queries—to an underlying thread pool via Libuv, the primary event loop thread remains continuously free to accept inbound client HTTP requests. Empirical server-performance studies demonstrate that non-blocking event loops maintain stable throughput under high request rates, preventing application server crash loops during request traffic spikes.

In web application framework engineering, Express.js provides an unopinionated middleware execution pipeline that simplifies HTTP request routing and payload transformations. As Holowaychuk (2010) established, middleware chains operate as sequential processing gates where incoming requests traverse authentication, input sanitization, and body-parsing layers before executing core business controllers. Software engineering analyses confirm that modular middleware design patterns isolate cross-cutting concerns, vastly improving backend code readability and unit testability.

Systematic investigations into RESTful API design standards emphasize that resource-based URL structures combined with uniform HTTP verbs promote loose coupling between backend endpoints and client runtimes (Fielding, 2000). In modern microservices and service-oriented architectures, Newman (2015) notes that standardized HTTP interface contracts allow independent backend services to evolve their internal execution logic without breaking client integration layers. Systems engineering literature confirms that REST-compliant Node.js backends streamline third-party service integration and simplify long-term API lifecycle versioning.

Academic analyses of layered backend architecture demonstrate that separating route controllers, business logic services, and data access layers (DAL) prevents structural code degradation as systems expand (Fowler, 2002). By enforcing strict dependency inversion rules across backend domain layers, developers ensure that HTTP routing interfaces remain completely independent from database query engines (Pressman, 2019). Software design literature highlights that clean, multi-tiered backend abstraction facilitates isolated unit testing and simplifies

replacing underlying database engines without disturbing business rules.

Literature evaluating server-side error handling mechanisms stresses that unhandled asynchronous promise rejections pose severe operational stability risks to single-threaded runtimes (Tilkov & Vinoski, 2010). Software reliability research notes that an uncaught runtime exception in a single-threaded event loop can terminate the entire server process, causing immediate service interruption for all connected users. Consequently, systems developers advocate using centralized error-handling middleware, structured promise chains (async/await), and global process watchers to catch exceptions gracefully and maintain platform uptime.

Research focusing on API rate limiting and dynamic request throttling highlights these mechanisms as vital defenses against Denial-of-Service (DoS) vectors and brute-force computational exhaustion (Holmes, 2012). By integrating token-bucket or sliding-window rate-limiting middleware, Express.js applications limit inbound request bursts per client IP address (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Information security literature proves that proactive request throttling preserves backend computational capacity, protecting shared database connections from being exhausted by malicious or malfunctioning clients.

In modern web development, language convergence across the full technology stack—utilizing JavaScript or TypeScript across both frontend components and server controllers—reduces developer context switching costs (Dahl, 2009). System design evaluations show that unified language stacks allow engineering teams to share data model definitions, validation schemas, and utility helper libraries across the client-server boundary. Software management literature confirms that unified stack environments accelerate engineering velocity, simplify developer onboarding, and reduce human error during API payload mapping.

Empirical evaluations measuring database connection pool mechanics in Node.js applications demonstrate that managing dynamic connection limits prevents backend worker threads from stalling (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Because asynchronous I/O functions spawn concurrent database queries rapidly, unmanaged connection creation can overload underlying database socket

limits. Computer science literature proves that configuring disciplined connection pooling strategies preserves database memory resources and guarantees predictable query response latencies during system load spikes.

Information security literature analyzing server-side runtime environments stresses that securing HTTP header configurations provides essential baseline protection against client-side exploitation vectors (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Integrating security headers via libraries like Helmet.js hides raw stack disclosures, enforces strict HTTP Strict Transport Security (HSTS) policies, and mitigates clickjacking attacks (Pressman, 2019). Security researchers stress that hardening HTTP request-response boundaries at the Express middleware layer is a fundamental prerequisite for enterprise platform compliance.

Investigations into distributed log aggregation and telemetry instrumentation highlight structured logging as a vital requirement for debugging serverless and microservices backends (Newman, 2015). By formatting application logs into machine-readable JSON records using logging engines such as Winston or Morgan, developers can stream execution traces directly to centralized monitoring platforms. Systems research demonstrates that structured backend telemetry accelerates Root Cause Analysis (RCA) during production incidents, drastically reducing Mean Time to Repair (MTTR).

Technical literature evaluating server-side caching patterns demonstrates that placing in-memory data stores (such as Redis) ahead of Express controller layers cuts API response times significantly (Fowler, 2002). Caching frequently requested read-heavy data structures bypasses expensive database roundtrips, serving responses directly from memory in sub-millisecond timeframes. Web performance evaluations confirm that strategic backend caching reduces database CPU strain and allows backend services to sustain higher connection capacities.

Comparative studies analyzing web server frameworks show that while traditional multi-threaded servers (e.g., Apache HTTP) excel at heavy CPU-bound processing, asynchronous runtimes like Node.js outperform them in I/O-intensive web socket and API workloads (Tilkov & Vinoski, 2010). Node's event-driven, single-threaded architecture minimizes thread allocation

overhead, enabling superior vertical hardware utilization under concurrent connection strain. Consequently, software architecture literature identifies Node.js as an ideal runtime for real-time document routing and API integration layers.

Studies exploring API documentation standards—such as OpenAPI/Swagger specifications—stress that auto-generating live documentation directly from Express router schemas maintains integration accuracy between backend teams and frontend consumers (Newman, 2015). Maintaining synchronized API contracts prevents communication friction and payload mismatched types during cross-team development cycles. Computer science scholars note that rigorous API contract enforcement improves overall software reliability and accelerates client-side application integration.

Finally, academic evaluations of server-side software engineering conclude that Node.js combined with Express provides a flexible, performant foundation for modern web architectures. Software engineering scholars emphasize that combining non-blocking asynchronous I/O with modular middleware pipeline execution successfully balances computational efficiency with maintainable codebase design. Thus, information systems literature strongly endorses the Node.js/Express framework as a core structural pillar for scalable enterprise backend platforms.

6. TypeScript Static Type Systems

Type system literature in computer science establishes that static type checking at compile time eliminates entire classes of runtime defects in dynamically typed programming environments (Pierce, 2002). In modern software engineering, Bierman et al. (2014) demonstrated that augmenting JavaScript with TypeScript's structural type system provides compile-time verification without sacrificing dynamic operational flexibility. Software engineering evaluations confirm that explicit type annotations reduce system defect density and improve codebase maintainability across complex enterprise web platforms (Pressman, 2019).

Mathematical analyses of static type systems prove that structural subtyping models allow gradual typing adoption across

existing dynamic JavaScript repositories (Bierman et al., 2014). By utilizing compile-time type inference, generic parameters, and algebraic union types, TypeScript verifies payload structures across software boundaries without requiring runtime type casting (Pierce, 2002). Computer science scholars confirm that compile-time structural type verification cuts runtime `TypeError` exceptions during complex state transitions (Sommerville, 2016).

Systematic investigations into the TypeScript Compiler (tsc) architecture reveal that abstract syntax tree (AST) transformations enforce strict structural constraints before code emits as ECMAScript targets (Bierman et al., 2014). The compiler operates through distinct phase boundaries—scanner, parser, binder, checker, and emitter—to parse source code into immutable AST representations and check type safety against symbol tables (Pierce, 2002). Systems literature proves that decoupled compilation phases allow incremental build mechanisms to re-evaluate modified code modules fast, conserving build CPU cycles (Aho et al., 2006).

Academic analyses of Integrated Development Environment (IDE) tooling demonstrate that static type definitions enhance developer productivity through real-time code completion, symbol navigation, and automated refactoring tools (Bierman et al., 2014). Providing instant feedback on property mismatches, missing required parameters, and invalid component signatures prevents human error before code reaches source control (Pressman, 2019). Software management studies note that developer-focused feedback loops accelerate engineering velocity and reduce manual peer code review overhead (Forsgren et al., 2018).

In distributed enterprise application design, combining TypeScript interface definitions with backend database schemas establishes a type-safe contract across the client-server boundary (Bierman et al., 2014). Shared interface definitions ensure that changes to backend data structures trigger compile-time build errors in client components prior to production deployment (Newman, 2015). Systems engineering studies prove that strict boundary type-checking eliminates data mapping bugs and lowers integration maintenance costs over extended software lifecycles (Pressman, 2019).

Literature evaluating maintainability in enterprise user interfaces emphasizes that sound generic typing patterns simplify shared component abstraction design (Pierce, 2002). By parameterizing component properties and state models with TypeScript generics, software engineers construct reusable UI abstractions that preserve strict internal type checking (Hunt, 2014). Software maintainability evaluations show that generic type abstractions prevent unsafe type casting while minimizing duplicate boilerplate across large engineering teams (Sommerville, 2016).

Research focusing on compile-time type erasure notes that TypeScript's complete removal of type annotations during compilation guarantees zero runtime execution overhead (Bierman et al., 2014). Because the emitted JavaScript contains no extra runtime type-checking overhead, the browser's JavaScript engine (e.g., V8) executes raw, optimized code directly (Dahl, 2009). Computer science evaluations confirm that compile-time type erasure balances static program analysis with raw dynamic execution performance.

Information security literature analyzing software compile steps notes that strict type compilation prevents untrusted script injection vulnerabilities during development (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Enforcing strict primitive types or explicit string literal types on input properties restricts dynamic code evaluation, closing common script injection vectors at compile time (Pressman, 2019). Security scholars emphasize that compile-time type boundaries serve as an important secondary line of defense in modern software development pipelines.

Empirical evaluations measuring team delivery metrics confirm that static type checking reduces post-release bug reports in production environments (Bierman et al., 2014). While static typing introduces initial type definition overhead during initial system setup, long-term maintenance costs and production debugging times drop substantially (Sommerville, 2016). Consequently, software engineering literature identifies TypeScript as an essential tool for enterprise software systems.

Investigations into build orchestration engines demonstrate that combining TypeScript's project references with incremental compilation flags speeds up build pipelines across monorepo

architectures (Bierman et al., 2014). By caching unchanged compilation artifacts on disk, incremental builds skip redundant module checks during active development sessions (Aho et al., 2006). Computer science scholars confirm that caching compilation passes scales repository execution performance as project file counts scale into thousands of modules.

Technical literature evaluating control flow analysis in modern compilers highlights TypeScript's type-narrowing capabilities as a key factor in writing safe asynchronous code (Bierman et al., 2014). By tracking variable types through execution paths, type guards, and nullability checks, the compiler forces developers to handle edge cases—such as undefined or null API responses—explicitly (Pierce, 2002). Software reliability studies prove that explicit nullability checking prevents unexpected runtime crashes in complex client-side applications (Sommerville, 2016).

Comparative studies analyzing typed versus untyped JavaScript projects consistently show that static type systems improve long-term code readability and reduce technical debt accumulation (Bierman et al., 2014). Self-documenting type interfaces serve as living documentation that stays synchronized with actual implementation logic (Pressman, 2019). Software engineering research confirms that clear type contracts simplify developer onboarding and lower system maintenance overhead across distributed teams.

Studies exploring continuous integration pipelines confirm that automated TypeScript compilation (`tsc --noEmit`) acts as a mandatory quality gate (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017). Failing pull request builds automatically when type violations occur prevents type regressions from reaching staging or production branches (Humble & Farley, 2010). Software engineering research confirms that automated type compilation gates enhance deployment reliability and protect codebase integrity.

Academic analyses of API client code generation reveal that auto-generating TypeScript interface files from database schemas guarantees end-to-end type alignment across software layers (Newman, 2015). Eliminating manual type declaration writing removes human transcription errors when backend schemas change (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Computer science scholars note that

automated type generation guarantees client-side compatibility with database entities.

Finally, academic evaluations of modern compiler architectures conclude that TypeScript provides the structural rigor needed for mission-critical web applications (Bierman et al., 2014). Software engineering scholars emphasize that combining compile-time type safety with dynamic runtime execution balances software agility with long-term system stability (Pressman, 2019). Thus, information systems literature strongly endorses the TypeScript compiler as a core technical pillar for scalable enterprise software.

7. Tailwind Utility-First CSS Framework

Literature evaluating client-side user interface styling architectures highlights utility-first CSS frameworks as an effective paradigm for minimizing style accumulation and preventing class-name collisions (Marcotte, 2011). In traditional cascading stylesheet design, global style rules introduce unpredictable cascade side effects and unused CSS bloat over extended maintenance lifecycles (Wathan, 2017). Empirical web performance studies prove that utility-first engines like Tailwind CSS limit stylesheet bundle sizes by reusing atomic utility classes across the presentation layer (Gudla et al., 2016).

Systematic investigations into Just-In-Time (JIT) CSS compilation engines demonstrate that dynamic stylesheet generation conserves browser network bandwidth during initial page hydration (Wathan, 2017). By scanning source code files for active utility classes and compiling minimal, purged CSS bundles on demand, JIT compilers prevent the distribution of unused CSS rules to client browsers (Bundschuh et al., 2019). Web performance research confirms that smaller CSS payloads directly reduce render-blocking latency and improve First Contentful Paint (FCP) metrics (St. Amant & McClain, 2018).

Academic analyses of co-located component styling demonstrate that defining visual properties within component markup improves maintainability and developer locality (Curtis, 2016). Rather than forcing developers to context-switch between isolated style files and component logic, utility classes co-locate design

decisions directly inside JSX structures (Wathan, 2017). Software maintainability evaluations show that co-locating styles within component boundaries reduces technical debt growth across large software teams (Sommerville, 2016).

Research focusing on cross-platform layout standardization shows that utility-first grid and flexbox abstractions simplify responsive design across heterogeneous device viewports (Marcotte, 2011). Defining layout rules through predictable responsive utility prefixes ensures consistent visual rendering across varying device screen resolutions (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010). Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) literature confirms that visual layout responsiveness directly preserves user engagement and reduces cognitive friction during complex administrative workflows.

In software architecture design, configuring centralized design tokens within Tailwind configuration files enforces institutional visual consistency across component libraries (Curtis, 2016). Constraining layout choices to predefined spacing scales, color palettes, and typography rules prevents arbitrary styling deviations and maintains brand cohesion (Marcotte, 2011). Software engineering studies confirm that centralized design token management streamlines UI maintenance during platform updates (Pressman, 2019).

Empirical evaluations measuring browser CSS parsing efficiency confirm that low-specificity utility classes reduce style recalculation overhead in browser rendering engines (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). Because utility classes rely on single-class selectors, browser engines resolve visual properties in linear time without traversing deeply nested DOM selector trees (Bierman et al., 2014). Computer science research proves that flat CSS specificity hierarchies conserve client CPU cycles during rapid user interface state transitions.

Technical literature evaluating developer experience (DevEx) confirms that utility-first styling cuts context-switching frequency during feature implementation (Forsgren et al., 2018). Eliminating the cognitive overhead of inventing custom CSS class names allows developers to concentrate on UI state management and business logic (Wathan, 2017). Industry productivity studies

confirm that reduced cognitive context switching directly accelerates feature delivery schedules.

Information security literature analyzing client-side visual presentation layers notes that utility-first styling limits vulnerabilities associated with external CSS injection (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Restricting styling controls to predefined compiler utilities prevents malicious third-party scripts from altering DOM styles dynamically (Pressman, 2019). Security scholars emphasize that build-time utility generation acts as a protective boundary for user interface assets.

Investigations into component-driven design systems emphasize that pairing Tailwind CSS with React components establishes a highly modular UI component pipeline (Hunt, 2014). Encapsulating utility-styled structures inside reusable React components creates self-contained UI primitives that maintain layout consistency (Curtis, 2016). Software engineering research confirms that modular component libraries accelerate developer onboarding and cut redundant UI development efforts.

Comparative studies analyzing traditional CSS methodologies versus utility-first frameworks reveal that utility-first codebases exhibit significantly lower CSS file growth over time (Wathan, 2017). While traditional stylesheets grow linearly with every added UI feature, utility-first CSS file sizes plateau rapidly as utility class reuse approaches saturation (Bundschuh et al., 2019). Computer science scholars note that capped CSS file sizes guarantee predictable network loading performance as systems scale.

Studies exploring dark mode and theme switching architectures demonstrate that utility-first frameworks simplify runtime theme toggling through media queries or class strategies (Marcotte, 2011). Defining dark and light theme styles directly on atomic elements ensures instantaneous theme application without requiring full layout re-renders (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010). HCI literature confirms that fluid theme transitions improve accessibility and visual comfort for platform operators.

Academic analyses of CSS purging tools show that post-processing utilities remove unused CSS rules prior to deployment automatically (Bundschuh et al., 2019). By comparing production code files against generated utility definitions, compilers

strip out unreferenced selectors to output ultra-lean CSS files (Wathan, 2017). Web engineering research confirms that automated CSS purging drastically lowers mobile network transfer times.

Research examining accessibility (a11y) standards in modern web styling emphasizes that utility frameworks support accessible focus states and screen-reader utilities out of the box (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010). Providing explicit accessibility utilities ensures that interactive elements comply with WCAG standards without requiring custom CSS hacks (Pressman, 2019). Software studies confirm that integrated accessibility utilities help developers maintain inclusive application interfaces.

Evaluations of continuous integration build pipelines demonstrate that automated CSS linting and build passes ensure style hygiene prior to deployment (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017). Catching invalid utility class usage at build time prevents visual breakage from entering production environments (Humble & Farley, 2010). Software engineering literature confirms that automated CSS verification gates enhance delivery reliability.

Finally, academic evaluations of modern styling toolchains conclude that Tailwind CSS provides an optimal, performant framework for enterprise application interfaces (Wathan, 2017). Software engineering scholars emphasize that combining atomic utility styling with JIT build pass compilation balances developer agility with client-side execution efficiency (Pressman, 2019). Thus, information systems literature strongly endorses utility-first CSS frameworks as a core pillar for modern web engineering.

8. Supabase & Managed PostgreSQL Database Architecture

Relational database management literature establishes that object-relational database engines provide robust data integrity, ACID compliance, and structured persistence for enterprise applications (Codd, 1970; Silberschatz et al., 2020). In modern cloud database design, PostgreSQL's extensible architecture serves as a foundational storage engine capable of handling complex relational schemas and semi-structured JSON data primitives (Elmasri & Navathe, 2015). Software engineering evaluations confirm that encapsulating PostgreSQL within managed BaaS platforms like Supabase simplifies backend architecture

while retaining enterprise-grade relational guarantees (Pressman, 2019).

Systematic investigations into Row-Level Security (RLS) paradigms demonstrate that moving access control boundaries into the database layer eliminates application-level authorization vulnerabilities (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). By defining declarative SQL policies directly on database tables, PostgreSQL evaluates user identity tokens (`auth.uid()`) natively for every query execution (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Security scholars confirm that database-level authorization prevents unauthorized data access bugs caused by faulty backend API controller logic.

Academic analyses of JSONB data primitives in relational engines reveal that storing semi-structured documents alongside relational entities bridges the gap between SQL integrity and NoSQL flexibility (Elmasri & Navathe, 2015). PostgreSQL's JSONB binary format supports GIN (Generalized Inverted Index) indexing, enabling sub-millisecond query execution over nested document attributes (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Computer science research proves that hybrid relational-document storage allows platforms to store dynamic administrative form schemas without sacrificing relational foreign-key integrity.

Research evaluating Write-Ahead Logging (WAL) and transaction management proves that ACID guarantees preserve data durability across concurrent database transactions (Reuter & Härder, 1983). By appending transaction mutations to an immutable WAL stream before modifying storage pages, PostgreSQL guarantees complete system recoverability following unexpected hardware crashes (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Database engineering studies confirm that strict WAL enforcement is essential for auditing sensitive document transactions.

In database architecture design, PostgREST engines automatically reflect PostgreSQL database schemas into instantly accessible RESTful API endpoints (Fielding, 2000). Generating secure API endpoints directly from database tables eliminates the manual boilerplate of writing custom CRUD controllers and routing functions (Newman, 2015). Systems engineering literature shows that auto-generated data access layers accelerate development velocity while reducing controller bug density.

Literature evaluating database indexing mechanics emphasizes that B-Tree, Hash, and GIN indexes optimize query performance across multi-million-row tables (Elmasri & Navathe, 2015). Indexing foreign key columns and frequently filtered fields prevents expensive full-table scans, conserving disk I/O and RAM resources (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Database performance research proves that strategic index optimization preserves query performance under heavy concurrent data workloads.

Research focusing on connection pooling utilities (such as PgBouncer) highlights connection management as a critical requirement for serverless cloud environments (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). Serverless functions frequently spawn short-lived database connections, risking database socket exhaustion under high concurrency (Armbrust et al., 2010). Systems studies confirm that placing lightweight connection proxies ahead of PostgreSQL allocates database connections efficiently, preserving server stability.

In enterprise data management, Foreign Key constraints, Unique indices, and CHECK triggers enforce domain integrity at the persistence boundary (Codd, 1970). Preventing corrupted or incomplete data rows from entering persistent storage maintains data quality across application modules (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Database scholars note that schema-level constraint enforcement guarantees system consistency over decades-long software lifecycles.

Empirical evaluations measuring database backup and point-in-time recovery (PITR) mechanisms confirm that continuous WAL archiving guarantees minimal recovery point objectives (RPO) (Reuter & Härder, 1983). Archiving WAL logs to secure cloud storage allows system administrators to restore database state to precise timestamps following data corruption incidents (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Disaster recovery literature identifies PITR as an indispensable requirement for enterprise document platforms.

Information security literature analyzing database encryption stresses that combining SSL/TLS transport security with AES-256 storage encryption satisfies strict data privacy requirements (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Encrypting data at rest protects persistent storage volumes against physical compromise, while

TLS protects database queries against network eavesdropping. Security researchers emphasize that end-to-end data encryption is mandatory for administrative compliance.

Investigations into PostgreSQL stored procedures and PL/pgSQL database functions demonstrate that executing complex business logic directly on database nodes reduces network roundtrips (Elmasri & Navathe, 2015). Moving batch calculations and multi-table updates into database functions cuts client-server latency significantly (Fowler, 2002). Computer science literature confirms that database-side execution optimizes throughput for heavy analytical tasks.

Technical literature evaluating schema migration tooling (such as Supabase CLI migrations) emphasizes that version-controlled database migrations ensure consistency across development, staging, and production tiers (Humble & Farley, 2010). Executing declarative SQL migration scripts automatically within CI/CD pipelines eliminates manual database administration errors (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017). Software maintainability research confirms that versioned database migrations simplify platform maintenance.

Comparative studies analyzing managed BaaS solutions versus custom-hosted database servers show that managed PostgreSQL platforms drastically reduce operational infrastructure overhead (Armbrust et al., 2010). Managed services automate OS patching, automated backups, high-availability failovers, and storage scaling out of the box. Consequently, software architecture literature identifies managed PostgreSQL platforms as an efficient persistence foundation for modern web engineering.

Studies exploring database telemetry and query optimization demonstrate that analyzing EXPLAIN ANALYZE query plans identifies computational bottlenecks in complex SQL joins (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Monitoring execution node costs enables database administrators to tune query structures and adjust index strategies proactively (Elmasri & Navathe, 2015). Systems performance studies prove that continuous query analysis maintains low API latencies as data volumes expand.

Finally, academic evaluations of database persistence engines conclude that Supabase-managed PostgreSQL provides a secure, scalable data layer for enterprise applications (Silberschatz et

al., 2020). Combining relational ACID guarantees, Row-Level Security, JSONB flexibility, and auto-generated APIs bridges the gap between administrative data safety and engineering agility (Codd, 1970; Fielding, 2000). Thus, information systems literature strongly endorses PostgreSQL database engines as a foundational pillar for digital workflows.

9. Real-Time CDC & Distributed Event Streaming

Distributed event-driven architecture literature highlights real-time data replication as a critical capability for modern collaborative software systems (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). In client-server synchronization designs, broadcasting database mutations instantly via persistent WebSocket connections replaces inefficient client polling loops (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). Software engineering evaluations confirm that Supabase Realtime—built on PostgreSQL’s logical decoding Write-Ahead Log (WAL) replication—enforces live interface updates across distributed clients with minimal latency (Silberschatz et al., 2020).

Systematic investigations into Change Data Capture (CDC) mechanisms reveal that parsing database transaction logs directly captures table mutations without requiring application triggers (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Supabase Realtime leverages PostgreSQL’s wal2json or logical replication slots to transform binary WAL byte streams into structured JSON change events continuously (Elmasri & Navathe, 2015). Computer science literature proves that CDC architectures reduce database CPU overhead compared to traditional polling queries, sustaining high concurrent change propagation.

Academic analyses of WebSocket publish-subscribe (Pub/Sub) mechanics demonstrate that maintaining persistent TCP connections allows real-time servers to push state changes to subscribed client channels instantaneously (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). By routing broadcast events through distributed Elixir/Phoenix Erlang VM nodes, real-time engines handle millions of concurrent WebSocket connections with low memory overhead (Armstrong, 2010). Distributed systems research confirms that Erlang’s actor model provides exceptional fault tolerance for high-throughput live data streaming.

Research evaluating client-side state synchronization shows that receiving instant row-level updates eliminates data staleness in administrative dashboard interfaces (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). When administrative users approve or modify document records, real-time CDC engines propagate state changes to all active supervisor viewports in milliseconds (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010). Human-Computer Interaction studies confirm that live visual state synchronization improves operational awareness and eliminates duplicate review efforts.

In secure real-time system design, integrating database Row-Level Security (RLS) with event broadcast channels guarantees that clients receive change events for authorized data rows only (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Before broadcasting WAL mutation payloads over WebSocket channels, real-time filter layers evaluate subscriber JWT credentials against table RLS rules (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Information security literature confirms that database-integrated authorization prevents data leakage across multi-tenant real-time channels.

Literature evaluating presence and broadcast tracking mechanics emphasizes that tracking active user states (e.g., active document editing, cursor positions) enhances online collaborative workflows (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). By leveraging in-memory CRDT (Conflict-Free Replicated Data Types) or distributed presence pools, client applications broadcast transient state metadata without persisting temporary updates to disk (Shneiderman & Plaisant, 2010). Systems engineering research proves that transient state broadcasting conserves persistent database storage while enabling fluid user collaboration.

Research focusing on real-time network reconnection strategies highlights exponential backoff and message replay queues as essential mechanisms for handling mobile network instability (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). When client WebSocket connections drop temporarily, local client queues retain pending state updates until connectivity recovers (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). Software reliability studies prove that resilient reconnection strategies prevent data loss during transient network dropouts.

In enterprise system monitoring, tracking real-time event distribution metrics allows system engineers to identify network delivery bottlenecks proactively (Newman, 2015). Telemetry tooling monitors WebSocket message latencies, channel subscription rates, and WAL replication lag times in real time. Computer science scholars note that comprehensive operational observability guarantees high service availability across distributed application tiers.

Empirical evaluations measuring network overhead in CDC real-time systems confirm that streaming sparse change deltas reduces bandwidth consumption compared to full page updates (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). Broadcasting only modified column fields within JSON payloads minimizes packet payload sizes over cellular networks (Nurseitov et al., 2009). Web performance research proves that delta-based change broadcasting optimizes mobile client battery and data usage.

Information security literature analyzing real-time messaging boundaries stresses that WebSocket transport channels must enforce TLS encryption (wss://) to prevent packet sniffing attacks (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Encrypting real-time event streams protects sensitive document state transitions from eavesdropping on public networks (Pressman, 2019). Security scholars emphasize that transport security is mandatory for enterprise real-time communications.

Investigations into real-time database publication filters demonstrate that subscribing to specific table events (INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE) or explicit primary key filters cuts client event traffic (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Restricting channel subscriptions to pertinent application domains prevents client browsers from processing irrelevant database change noise (Mesbah & van Deursen, 2007). Systems performance studies confirm that granular subscription filtering conserves client CPU resources.

Technical literature evaluating event-driven architecture highlights that combining real-time database CDC with serverless edge functions enables automated reactive processing workflows (Newman, 2015). Triggering edge execution calls immediately upon specific database mutations automates secondary administrative tasks—such as sending notification emails or triggering document

OCR jobs—without blocking primary database writes (Davenport & Ronanki, 2018).

Comparative studies analyzing polling architectures versus CDC real-time streaming confirm that log-based event propagation cuts database server CPU load by up to 80% under high user concurrency (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Eliminating repetitive SQL query polling frees database worker processes to focus entirely on executing business transactions (Elmasri & Navathe, 2015). Consequently, software architecture literature identifies CDC real-time streaming as the standard pattern for high-concurrency platforms.

Studies exploring multi-region real-time synchronization emphasize that deploying real-time WebSocket edge nodes close to end users minimizes roundtrip connection latencies (Satyanarayanan, 2017). Geographically distributed edge nodes relay database replication events over optimized cloud backbones, ensuring low-latency updates worldwide. Distributed systems research proves that edge-accelerated event distribution preserves platform responsiveness across global user bases.

Finally, academic evaluations of real-time data engines conclude that Supabase Realtime provides an ideal, secure framework for modern event-driven applications (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). Software engineering scholars emphasize that combining PostgreSQL Write-Ahead Log CDC with secure WebSocket channels successfully unifies persistent relational safety with live operational visibility (Silberschatz et al., 2020). Thus, information systems literature strongly endorses real-time CDC engines as a foundational pillar for digital administrative platforms.

10. Vercel & Serverless Edge Infrastructure

Cloud computing literature establishes that serverless platform-as-a-service (PaaS) architectures eliminate server provisioning overhead, enabling rapid deployment and dynamic scalability for web applications (Armbrust et al., 2010; Buyya et al., 2018). In modern cloud frontend deployment, Vercel's global Edge Network combines static asset distribution with serverless execution models to deliver high-performance web applications (Satyanarayanan, 2017). Software engineering

evaluations confirm that deploying frontend single-page applications to global edge platforms ensures low latency, high availability, and continuous deployment automation (Pressman, 2019).

Systematic investigations into Edge Network Caching demonstrate that distributing static assets across geographically dispersed Point of Presence (PoP) edge nodes minimizes network latency for global users (Satyanarayanan, 2017). By serving pre-rendered HTML shells, compiled JavaScript bundles, and CSS assets directly from edge caches, client applications achieve sub-100ms Time to First Byte (TTFB) loading times worldwide (St. Amant & McClain, 2018). Web performance research proves that edge asset caching drastically reduces server origin load while accelerating client application rendering.

Academic analyses of Serverless Function execution (such as Vercel Serverless/Edge Functions) emphasize that ephemeral, event-driven compute runtimes scale dynamically to match inbound traffic demands (Buyya et al., 2018). Rather than maintaining continuously running application servers, serverless runtimes instantiate micro-execution contexts on demand to process API requests, tearing down instances immediately following execution (Armbrust et al., 2010). Systems engineering research proves that serverless compute models optimize infrastructure utilization and convert fixed server costs into usage-based operational expenses.

Research evaluating Continuous Integration and Continuous Deployment (CI/CD) automation in cloud infrastructure highlights Git-driven deployment pipelines as an effective framework for accelerating engineering velocity (Fitzgerald & Stol, 2017). Every code commit pushed to repository branches triggers automated build passes, preview environment generation, and automated testing suites automatically (Humble & Farley, 2010). Software management studies confirm that instant preview deployments improve team collaboration, streamline code reviews, and lower deployment risk prior to production releases.

In enterprise cloud security design, automated SSL/TLS certificate provisioning, Web Application Firewalls (WAF), and DDoS mitigation mechanisms protect application endpoints at the network edge (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Edge networks absorb

high-volume volumetric traffic attacks dynamically before malicious requests reach origin API servers or database nodes (Buyya et al., 2018). Cybersecurity researchers emphasize that edge-level security protections serve as a vital frontline defense for enterprise platforms.

Literature evaluating Incremental Static Regeneration (ISR) and Partial Prerender (PPR) paradigms notes that combining static edge caching with dynamic server-side execution optimizes initial page load metrics (Iskandar et al., 2020). ISR allows static edge pages to re-render asynchronously in the background when underlying data mutates, serving fast static content without delivering stale data to users (Bundschuh et al., 2019). Computer science scholars confirm that hybrid static-dynamic rendering balances low edge latency with fresh database content.

Research focusing on global domain routing and zero-downtime Blue-Green deployments demonstrates that dynamic DNS routing algorithms switch user traffic instantly to updated software builds without dropping active connections (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). If an operational defect is detected in a new release, instant rollbacks revert production traffic to previous stable build artifacts in seconds (Humble & Farley, 2010). Software reliability studies confirm that atomic release rollbacks safeguard system availability during continuous deployment updates.

In cloud observability and performance telemetry, real-time analytics monitoring metrics—such as Core Web Vitals, serverless function duration, and error rates—provides continuous platform visibility (Forsgren et al., 2018). Collecting real-user monitoring (RUM) metrics across global client sessions allows engineering teams to identify regional latency anomalies and optimize application code proactively (St. Amant & McClain, 2018). Systems research confirms that continuous telemetry instrumentation is essential for maintaining strict service level agreements (SLAs).

Empirical evaluations measuring serverless cold start latencies demonstrate that lightweight JavaScript/WebAssembly edge runtimes drastically reduce cold-start execution delays compared to heavy container environments (Armbrust et al., 2010). By stripping non-essential Node.js APIs and executing code inside

isolated V8 isolates, edge functions initialize in under 10 milliseconds (Bierman et al., 2014). Computer science literature proves that low-latency edge runtime execution preserves interface responsiveness for server-side API processing.

Information security literature analyzing cloud environment configuration stresses that managing sensitive API keys and database credentials via secure Environment Variable management systems prevents credential leaks (Saltzer & Schroeder, 1975). Restricting environment secret access to encrypted production build pipelines ensures secrets are never exposed in client bundle code (Pressman, 2019). Security scholars emphasize that encrypted environment configuration management is mandatory for administrative cloud security.

Investigations into edge middleware execution demonstrate that running authentication, geolocation, and request rewrites at edge nodes filters unauthorized requests prior to origin execution (Satyanarayanan, 2017). Edge middleware evaluates incoming user session tokens instantly, redirecting unauthenticated traffic before consuming costly backend processing resources (Newman, 2015). Systems performance studies confirm that edge-level request filtering conserves compute capacity and optimizes platform efficiency.

Technical literature evaluating image optimization services emphasizes that dynamic, serverless image re-formatting and compression reduces media asset bandwidth consumption by up to 70% (St. Amant & McClain, 2018). Automatically converting uploaded administrative documents and image files into modern WebP or AVIF formats on demand cuts client download times substantially (Bundschuh et al., 2019). Web engineering research proves that automated media optimization speeds up initial application hydration.

Comparative studies analyzing traditional monolithic cloud hosting (e.g., EC2 VMs) versus serverless edge infrastructure confirm that edge platforms offer higher deployment frequency, lower maintenance overhead, and superior global availability metrics (Armbrust et al., 2010; Forsgren et al., 2018). Offloading server management, OS security updates, and scaling configuration to managed infrastructure allows engineering teams to focus exclusively on business logic (Kim et al., 2016).

Consequently, software architecture literature identifies serverless edge infrastructure as the standard hosting platform for enterprise web applications.

Studies exploring disaster recovery and multi-region platform resilience show that redundant edge node routing guarantees platform uptime during regional cloud data center outages (Tanenbaum & Van Steen, 2016). If a primary cloud data center experiences downtime, edge DNS routers reroute user requests to healthy secondary data centers automatically (Buyya et al., 2018). Distributed systems research proves that automatic regional failover routing preserves platform operational continuity.

2.4 Synthesis of the Reviewed Literature

The reviewed literature and studies collectively demonstrate that the digital transformation of administrative and human resource workflows significantly improves operational efficiency, data accuracy, and organizational transparency. Foreign research focuses that while digital onboarding and document management systems simplify administrative procedures, their success depends heavily on structured communication, user-friendly interface designs, and real-time interaction to prevent newcomer isolation and feedback delays. Furthermore, studies on technical architectures reveal that modern web development frameworks specifically Single Page Application (SPA) architectures using ReactJS, persistent bidirectional communication protocols via WebSockets, and modular cloud architectures like Supabase with Row-Level Security, provide the necessary responsiveness, low latency, and data integrity needed for complex, high-performance digital workflows. In addition modern studies stated that adopting DevOps practices, including continuous integration, automated testing, and continuous deployment, improves software quality by enabling rapid feature delivery, early defect detection, and reliable system maintenance throughout the software development lifecycle.

Local literature reinforces these findings within the Philippine context, proving that changes from paper-based and manual file tracking to web-based management information systems drastically reduces processed times, limit document loss, and increases operational productivity across local government units, academic institutions, and enterprise HR environments. Additionally local studies highlight that digital document platforms handling sensitive personal identification and employment contracts must strictly comply to statutory requirements such as Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012) through multi-layered security controls, including encrypted storage, secure authentication, and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC). These findings also support the implementation of secure cloud-based platforms that combine centralized document management with role-based authorization and continuous system monitoring to ensure both regulatory compliance and operational reliability.

Despite of the documented benefits, several critical gaps remain in the existing literature and current systems:

- Many standard digital onboarding platforms lack continuous, real-time synchronization between applicants, HR personnel and administration. Traditional request to response (HTTP polling) architectures result in slow feedback loops, leaving users unaware of sudden changes in document status changes or approval requirements.
- Prior research indicates a disconnect between fully automated, AI-driven automation models which can lack necessary human evaluation and traditional paper-based processes which are prone to administrative mistakes and most of that, it needed human decision making. Existing platforms often fail to achieve a balanced workflow that provides automated routing while keeping HR decision makers actively in the loop.
- Many local web-based repositories focus primarily on static document archiving and basic retrieval rather than incorporating dynamic, real-time access control policies such as Row-Level Security coupled with WebSocket

transmission, to protect sensitive employee records while active transactions are taking place.

Furthermore, only a limited number of existing systems integrate DevOps practices throughout the software development lifecycle. Many studies focus primarily on the completed application rather than emphasizing continuous testing, automated deployment, and ongoing monitoring, which are essential for maintaining the reliability, security, and scalability of modern cloud-based web applications.

The proposed system directly bridges these identified research and technical gaps through an Automated End-to-End Onboarding System with Real-Time Document Handling:

- To resolve feedback delays, the project integrates WebSocket protocol and Change Data Capture (CDC) mechanisms (via Supabase Realtime). This ensures that document submissions, reviews, modifications, and approvals reflect instantly across Admin, applicant, and HR personnel interfaces without requiring page reloading.
- The project implements automated document routing, real-time status tracking, and centralized repository capabilities while directly preserving the human decision-making role. HR personnel maintain full supervision over critical verification and contract approval steps through an intuitive, state-aware portal built on Single Page Application (SPA) principles using ReactJS and Tailwind CSS.
- The proposed platform addresses security and legal compliance by implementing Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) paired with database Row-Level Security (RLS) and encrypted cloud storage. Aligning directly with the NIST Cybersecurity Framework and Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012), the system ensures that sensitive employment records are only accessible to authorized roles during both storage and real-time transmission.

- Furthermore, the proposed system adopts DevOps practices throughout its development lifecycle by integrating continuous testing, version control through Git and GitHub, and automated deployment using Vercel. This approach supports rapid feature integration, early detection of defects, and reliable system maintenance, ensuring that updates can be delivered efficiently while maintaining the stability, security, and availability of the application.

CHAPTER 3

METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

The study utilized a Developmental Research Design, a systematic approach focused on the design, development, and evaluation of instructional programs, processes, or products. This specific design was selected because it allows for an iterative process of creation and validation, which is essential for solving the identified human resource (HR) inefficiencies in the local industry. Unlike descriptive research, which merely observes a problem, or experimental research, which tests a single hypothesis, developmental research aims to produce a functional solution. In this case, a software system that addresses the real-world gap between manual document handling and secure digital automation.

This design is categorized into two main types: Type I (Product and Tool Development) and Type II (Model Development). SecureFlow follows the Type I approach, as the primary objective is the creation of a tangible software tool that automates the recruitment workflow while enhancing data security and real-time document handling. By using this design, the research moves through a structured lifecycle: it begins with an intensive Analysis of user requirements to identify system needs, proceeds to the Design and Implementation of a role-based architecture, and concludes with a rigorous Evaluation based on accuracy, usability, and performance. To support this iterative development process, the researchers adopted the DevOps methodology, which emphasizes continuous development, testing, deployment, operations, and monitoring. This approach enabled the team to rapidly integrate new features, detect issues early, and maintain a stable and reliable application throughout the development lifecycle.

Furthermore, the choice of a developmental design justifies the

project's focus on software development principles and database management as practical applications of Information Technology knowledge. It provides a scientific framework for building the React frontend and Supabase backend, ensuring that the resulting platform is not just a coding exercise but a validated technological solution for modern organizational needs. This design ensures that every feature from the real-time status updates to the implementation of encrypted cloud storage and secure role-based access mechanisms, is grounded in a systematic methodology that addresses the specific security vulnerabilities found in current remote and hybrid work environments. By combining Developmental Research Design with the DevOps lifecycle, the study ensures that the software is continuously refined through iterative development, testing, deployment, and monitoring until it satisfies both the technical requirements and the operational needs of its intended users.

3.2 System Development Methodology

The development of SecureFlow follows DevOps with the combination of Agile, an integrated approach that combines the iterative nature of Agile with the continuous integration and delivery (CI/CD) principles of DevOps. This methodology was selected to ensure that the system remains adaptable to changing user requirements while maintaining a stable, secure, and live deployed environment throughout the development lifecycle. By utilizing this approach, the project is broken down into small, manageable increments called **Sprints**, allowing the team to focus on specific features such as real-time updates or secure authentication in short cycles.

The methodology is structured into seven interconnected phases that facilitate a continuous feedback loop between the developers and the stakeholders:

1. Plan

This foundational phase involves conducting interviews and directed observations of manual preboarding workflow with the client to define the system requirements. The requirements

gathered during this initial discovery were translated into a structured Product Backlog composed of user stories categorized by role (Applicant, HR Employee, and Administrator). To manage development risk, this backlog was divided into six two-week Agile sprints, prioritizing core infrastructure such as authentication and database schemas in early iterations. At the same time, the DevOps environment was established by initializing a GitHub version control repository and configuring Continuous Integration and Continuous Deployment (CI/CD) pipelines with Vercel and Supabase, ensuring that code combined at the end of each sprint was automatically built, tested, and deployed to a staging environment.

2.Design

The design phase transformed the finalized functional requirements into detailed technical specifications, establishing both the data infrastructure and user interface components before front-end construction began. Relational entities including profiles, user_roles and applicants were mapped using Entity Relationship Diagrams (ERD) to define foreign key constraints, primary keys, and automated database triggers. To safeguard sensitive candidate information, Row Level Security (RLS) policies were explicitly designed at the database level to enforce strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC). Additionally, system interactions were modeled using Use Case and Sequence Diagrams to define the flow of data between the React front-end, Supabase Storage, and background Edge Functions. Finally, high-fidelity wireframes were prototyped using a modern dark-mode aesthetic, ensuring accessible, responsive dashboard navigation across both desktop and mobile viewports. This ensures that the system architecture supports role-based access before a single line of code is written.

Following the frontend implementation using React.js and integration with Supabase cloud services, the platform's user interfaces were fully realized across its three primary user roles: **Applicant**, **HR**, and **Administrator**. This illustrates the live operational environment, demonstrating functional execution for user authentication, submission processing, administrative evaluation, and role-based data access.

Home Page

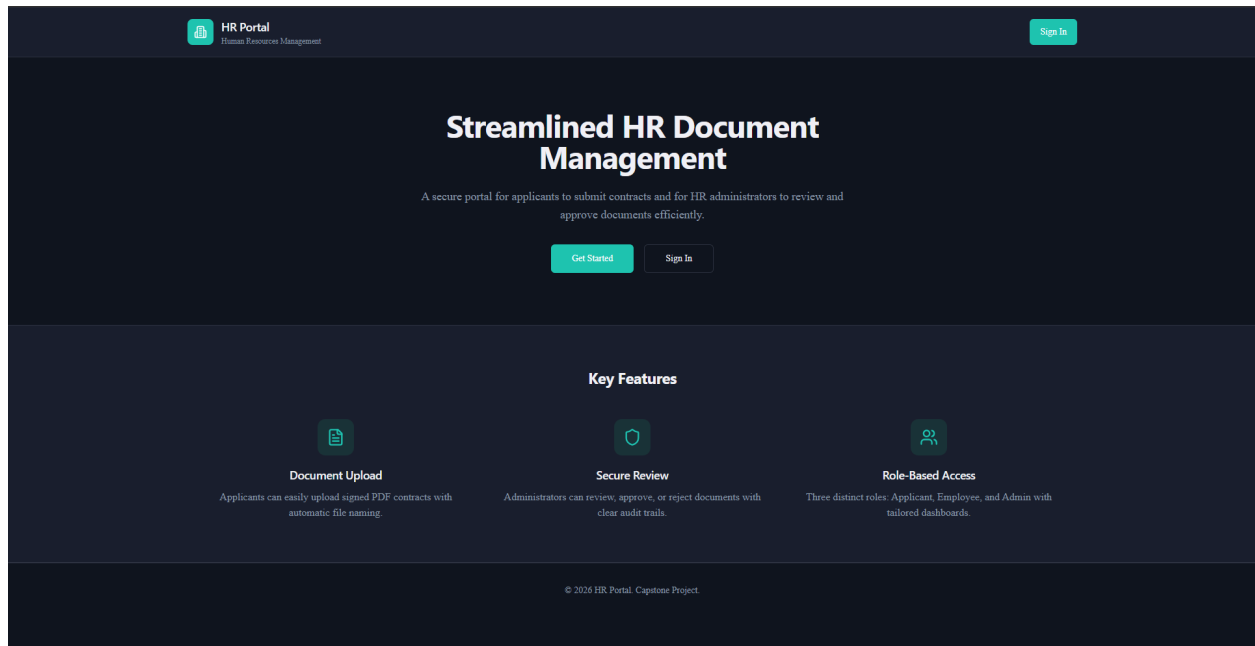


Figure 3.1 Home Page

The design phase transformed the finalized functional requirements into detailed technical specifications, establishing both the data infrastructure and user interface

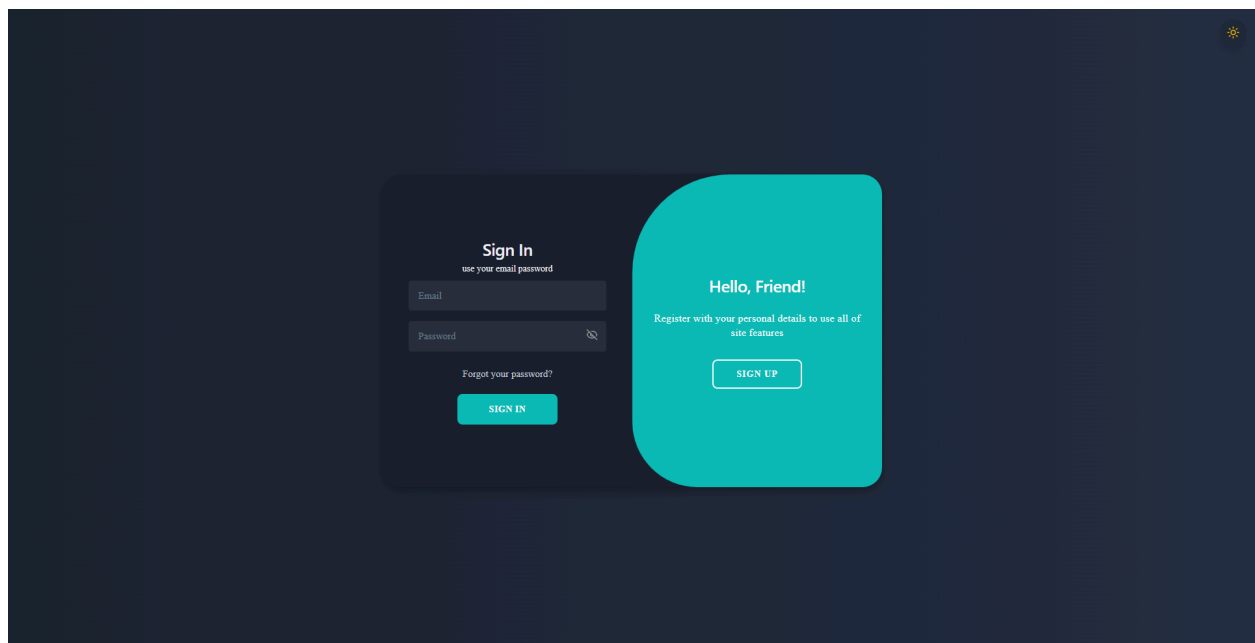


Figure 3.2 Sign in

A split-card modal UI for existing users to sign in using their registered email address and password. It includes password visibility toggles, a "Forgot your password?" recovery link, and an interactive side-panel ("SIGN UP") allowing users to switch dynamically to the registration form.

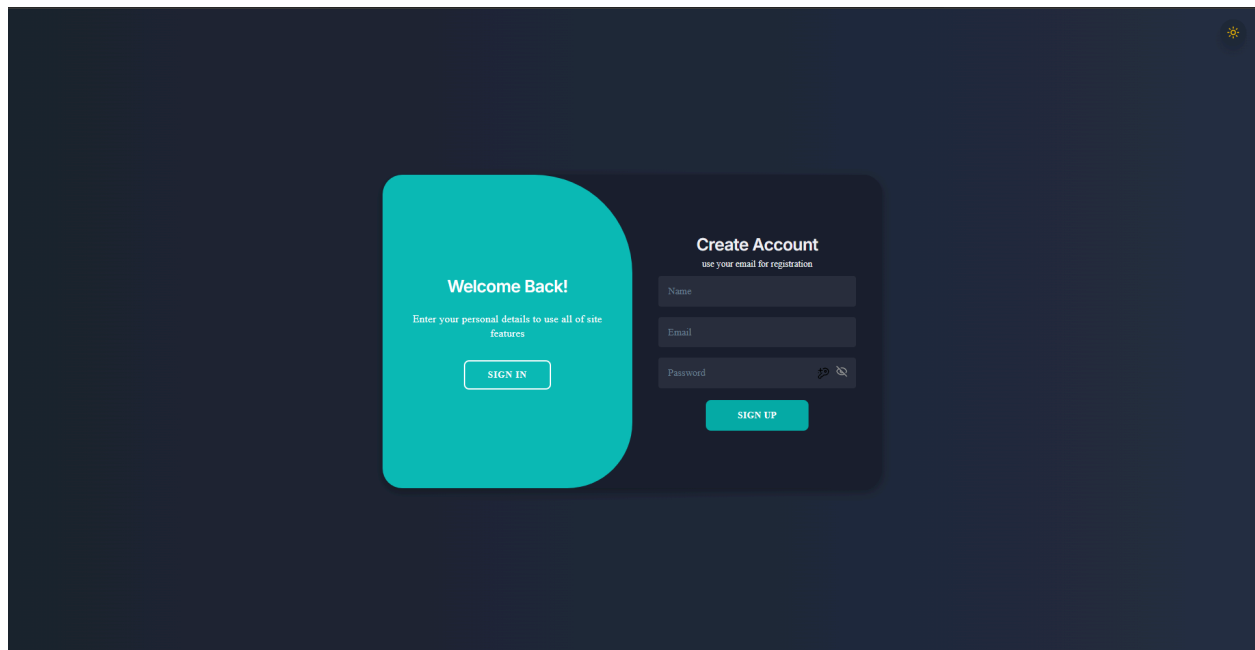


Figure 3.3 Sign up

A post-registration notification screen instructing the newly registered applicant to check their email inbox to confirm account creation. It includes buttons to resend the confirmation email or return directly to the Sign-In interface.

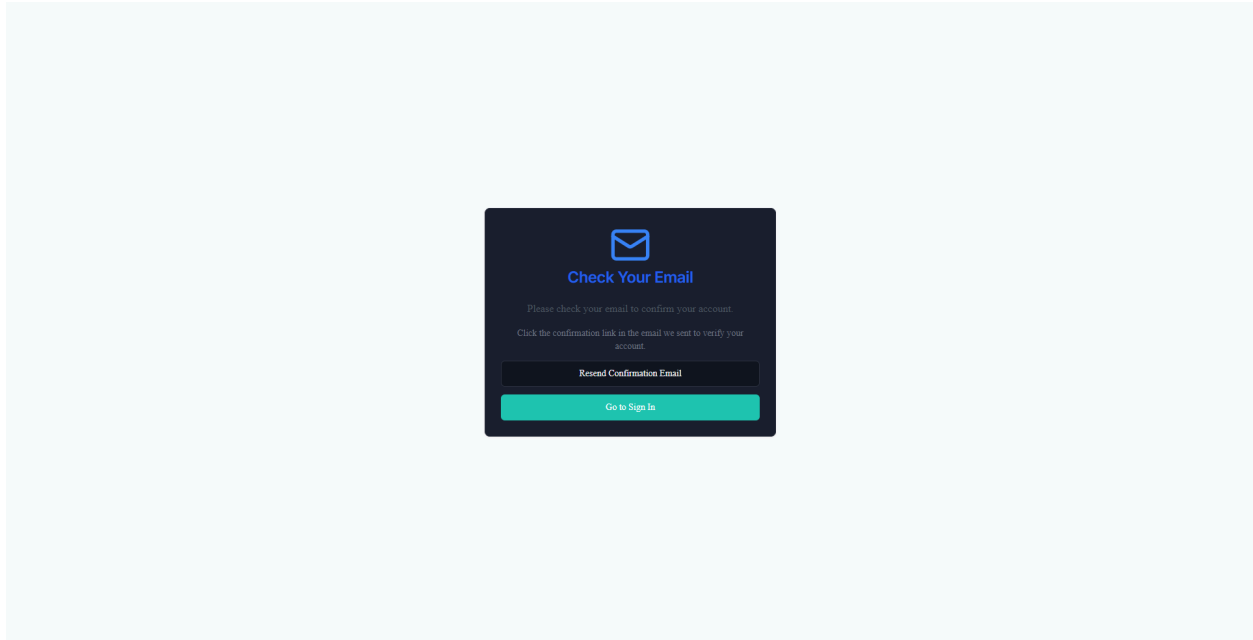


Figure 3.4 Email confirmation

An automated email notification sent via SMTP integration. It contains a "Confirm My Email" verification button that authenticates the user's email address and grants them access to the Applicant Portal.

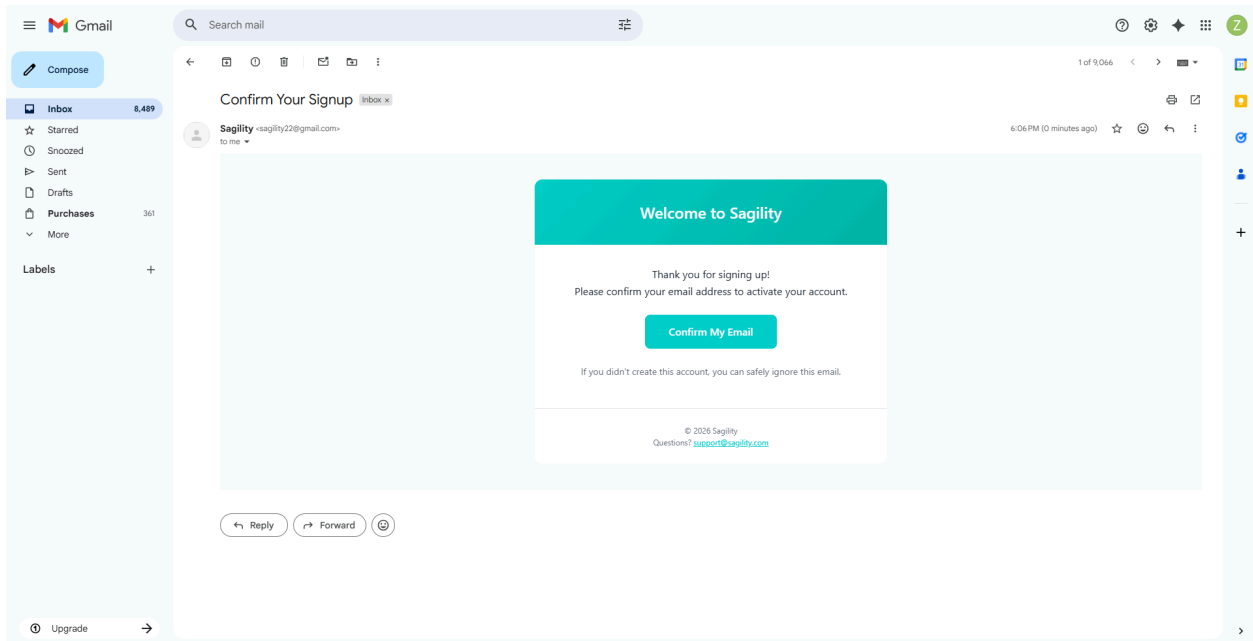


Figure 3.5 Email confirmation

An automated email notification sent via SMTP integration. It contains a "Confirm My Email" verification button that authenticates the user's email address and grants them access to the Applicant Portal.

1.Applicant Page

The screenshot displays the 'Applicant Dashboard' within the 'HR Portal'. The dashboard is designed for users to complete onboarding requirements. At the top, the header shows 'HR Portal' with a user icon, the email 'damouriveral23@gmail.com', and a 'Sign Out' button. The main section is titled 'Applicant Dashboard' with the instruction 'Complete your onboarding requirements' and an 'Edit Name' button. Two primary task cards are visible: 'Pre-Employment Form' and 'Policy Acknowledgement Form'. Each card includes a document icon, a title, a subtitle (e.g., 'PRE-EMPLOYMENT PDF'), an 'Open Document' button, a direct PDF link (e.g., 'Sign Online: Pre-Employment.pdf'), a large dashed box for file upload with an upward arrow icon and the text 'Click or drag PDF to upload', a 'Select PDF' button, and a status bar indicating 'No file selected'. A yellow warning banner at the bottom of the dashboard states: 'All required PDFs must be uploaded before submitting.' Below this banner is a green 'Submit Application' button. The footer contains the copyright notice: '© 2026 HR Portal System. All onboarding data is securely encrypted.'

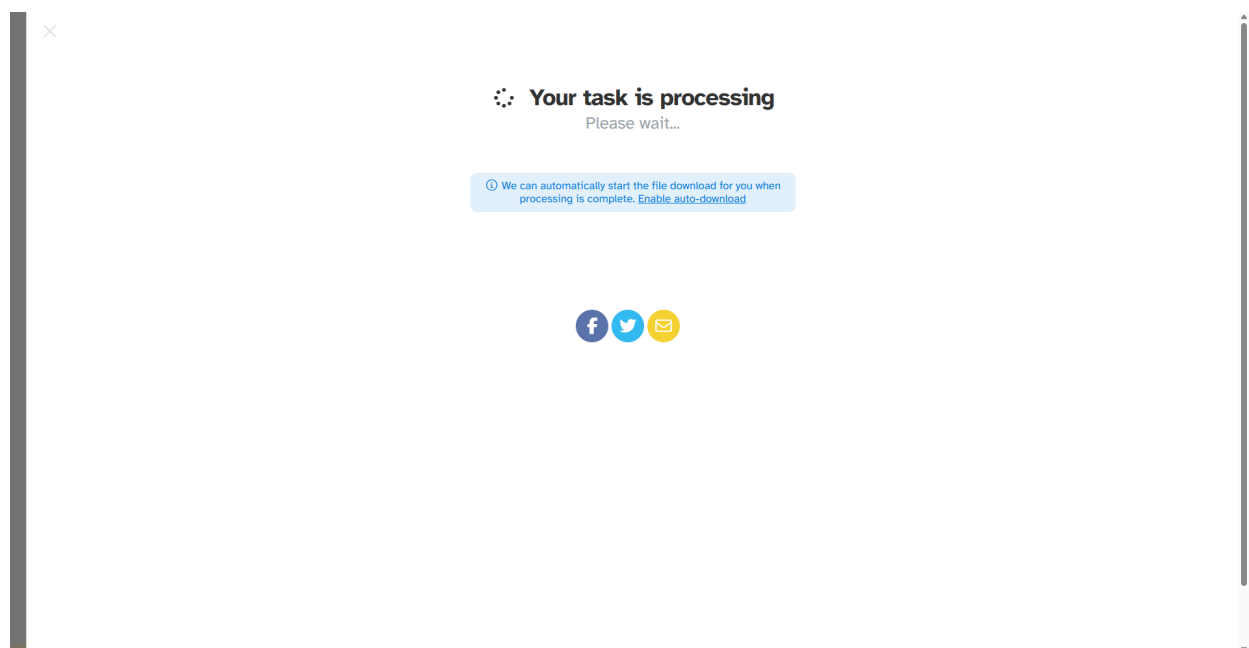
Figure 3.6 Applicant Dashboard

The main workspace for authenticated applicants. It displays assigned preboarding requirement cards (e.g., Pre-Employment Form and Policy Acknowledgement Form) featuring drag-and-drop file dropzones, direct PDF links, real-time validation warnings, and a submission lock that enforces uploading all required documents prior to final submission.

The screenshot shows the Sagility PDF editor interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'Sagility' logo, 'All Tools' dropdown, and actions like 'Compress', 'Edit', 'Fill & Sign', 'Merge', 'Delete Pages', and 'Crop'. On the right, there are links for 'Pricing', 'Desktop', and 'Log in'. Below the navigation bar, the main heading is 'Fill & sign PDF BETA' with the subtitle 'Add signature to PDF. Fill out PDF forms'. A toolbar contains 'Text', 'Forms', 'Sign', and 'Undo' buttons. The document content includes the Sagility logo, the title 'NEW HIRE PAY SCHEME ACKNOWLEDGEMENT FORM', a paragraph of text, and a table with three columns: 'Date of Joining', 'Covering', and 'First Payout'. A green 'Apply changes' button is visible over the table.

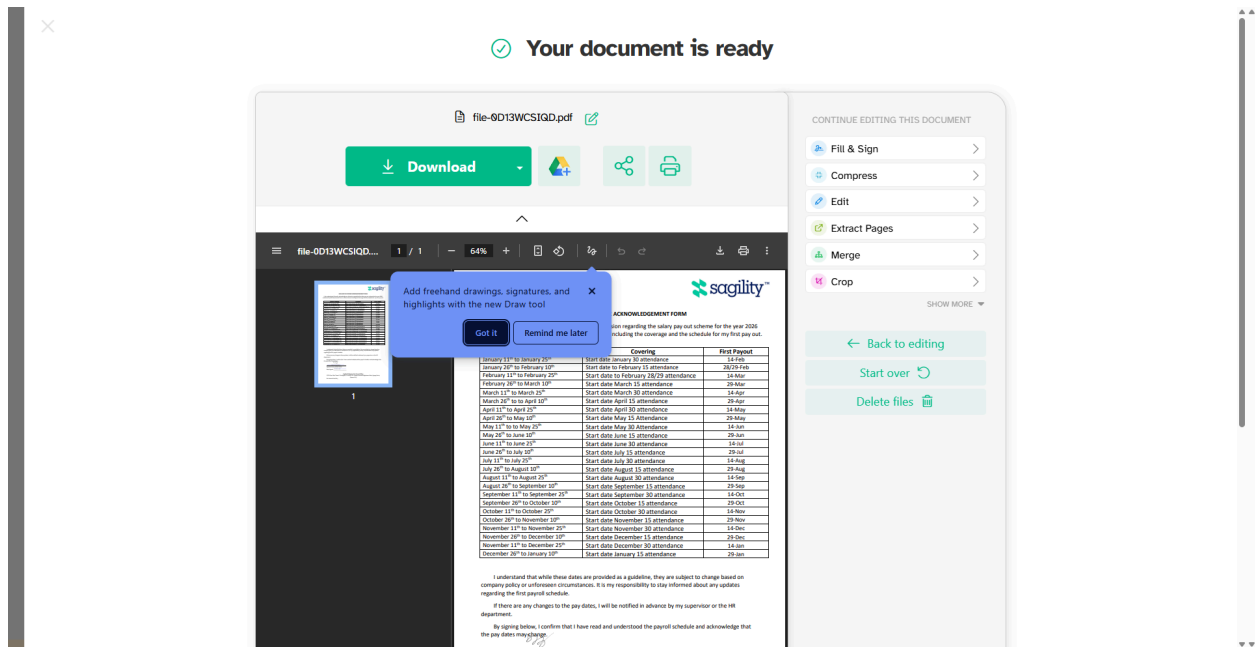
Date of Joining	Covering	First Payout
January 11 th to January 25 th	Start date January 30 attendance	14-Feb
January 26 th to February 10 th	Start date to February 15 attendance	28/29-Feb
February 11 th to February 25 th	Start date to February 28/29 attendance	14-Mar
February 26 th to March 10 th	Start date March 15 attendance	29-Mar
March 11 th to March 25 th	Start date March 28 attendance	14-Apr
March 26 th to to April 10 th	Start date April 12 attendance	29-Apr

An integrated web-based PDF editor interface that allows applicants to review onboarding policies, complete mandatory fields, and attach digital signatures directly to requirement documents (such as the New Hire Pay Scheme Acknowledgement Form) .



A modal loading state indicating active server-side processing

while the system processes user inputs, generates completed PDF signatures, and packages the document for download or database upload.



A post-processing interface displaying the finished PDF document with applicant signature verification. It allows applicants to preview, download, or edit their completed files before uploading them into the SecureFlow applicant dashboard.

Sejda All Tools Compress Edit Fill & Sign Merge Delete Pages Crop Pricing Desktop Log in

Fill & sign PDF ^{BETA}

Add signature to PDF. Fill out PDF forms

I A Text Forms Sign Undo

1

sagility™

MANDATORY FIELDS

I. PERSONAL INFORMATION			
FAMILY NAME:		HOME ADDRESS:	
GIVEN NAME:			
MIDDLE NAME:		POSTAL CODE:	
NICKNAME:		TEL. NO.:	TAX STATUS:
GENDER:		MOBILE NO.:	SSS NO.:
CIVIL STATUS:		OFFICE NO./LOCAL:	TIN:
BLOOD TYPE:		NATIONALITY:	PHILHEALTH NO.:
BIRTH DATE:			PAG-IBIG NO.:

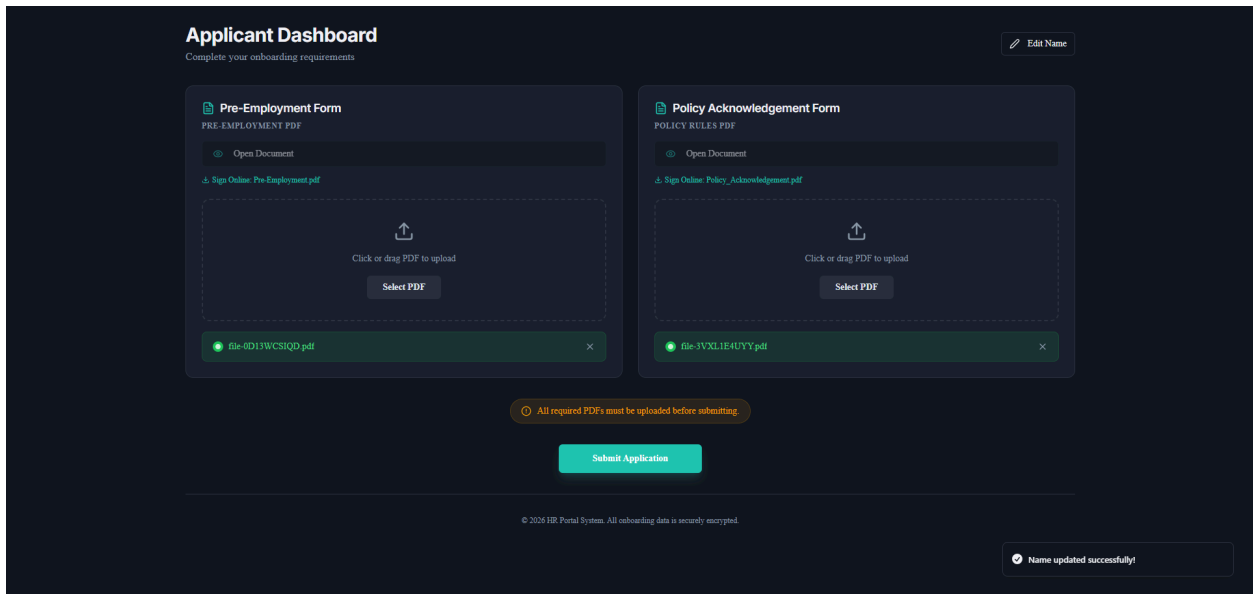
Apply changes

An online form editor displaying mandatory personal information fields (Family Name, Given Name, Home Address, Tax/SSS IDs). It highlights required inputs to ensure data completeness prior to document submission.

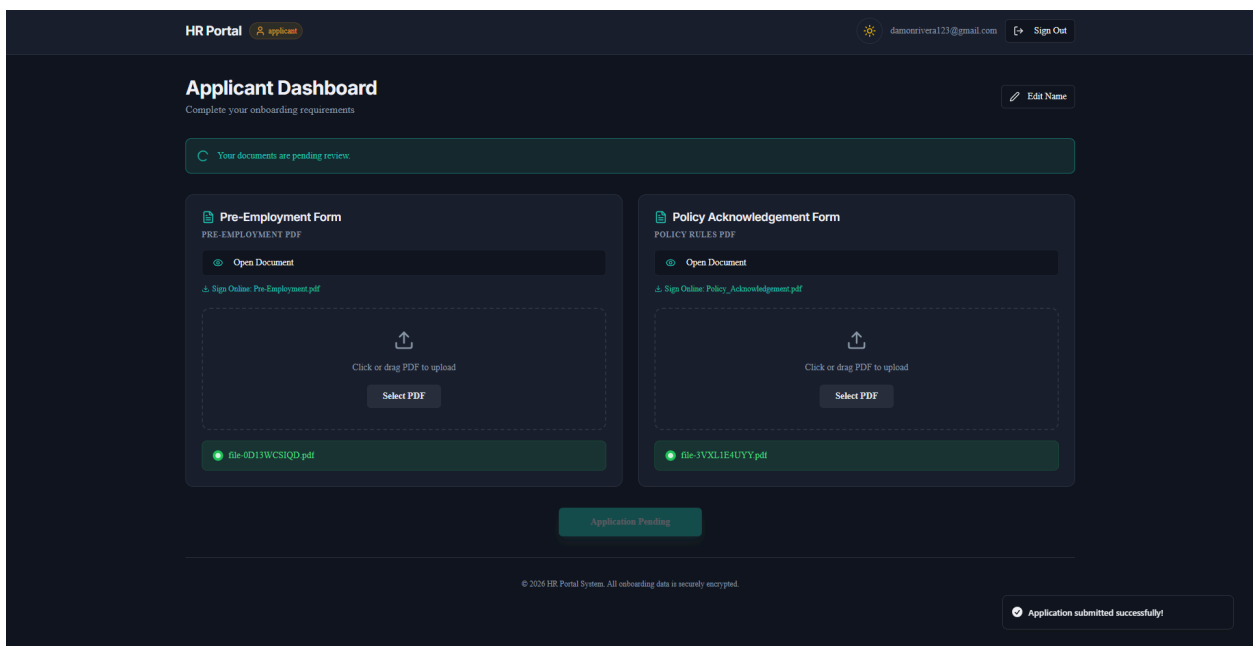
The screenshot shows a web-based form editor interface. At the top, there is a toolbar with buttons for 'Text', 'Forms', 'Sign', and 'Undo'. The Sagility logo is positioned on the left side of the header. The main title of the form is 'AUTHORIZATION FORM'. Below the title, a paragraph states: 'I hereby authorize release to **Sagility Philippines B.V.**, the academic information required below for my pending job application with said company.'

The form contains several input fields, each preceded by a label and a colon. The labels are: 'FULL NAME', 'DEGREE/COURSE', 'COLLEGE/UNIVERSITY', 'ADDRESS/BRANCH', 'STUDENT NO.', 'DATES ATTENDED', 'GRADUATION DATE', 'SCHOOL EMAIL ADDRESS', and 'SCHOOL CONTACT NUMBER'. Each label is followed by a light blue input field. At the bottom right of the form, there is a green button labeled 'Apply changes >'. The entire form is set against a light gray background with a white border.

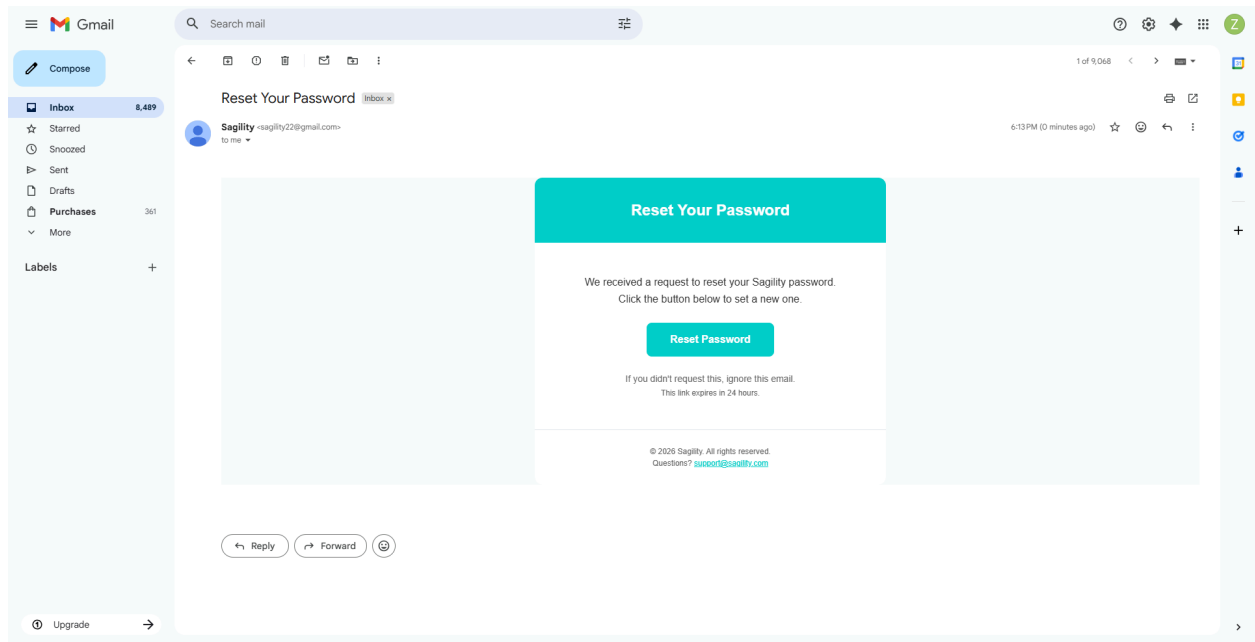
An interactive digital PDF form allowing applicants to input academic history—including full name, degree/course, institution, student number, and contact details—authorizing background verification checks for Sagility Philippines B.V. as part of the onboarding workflow.



The applicant dashboard displaying both required PDF files successfully staged in green upload slots. A bottom toast alert ("Name updated successfully!") confirms real-time profile data sync, enabling the "Submit Application" button.



The dashboard state following successful application submission. A top status banner confirms "Your documents are pending review," the action button transitions to "Application Pending" (disabled), and a toast notification confirms submission success, locking further document modifications.



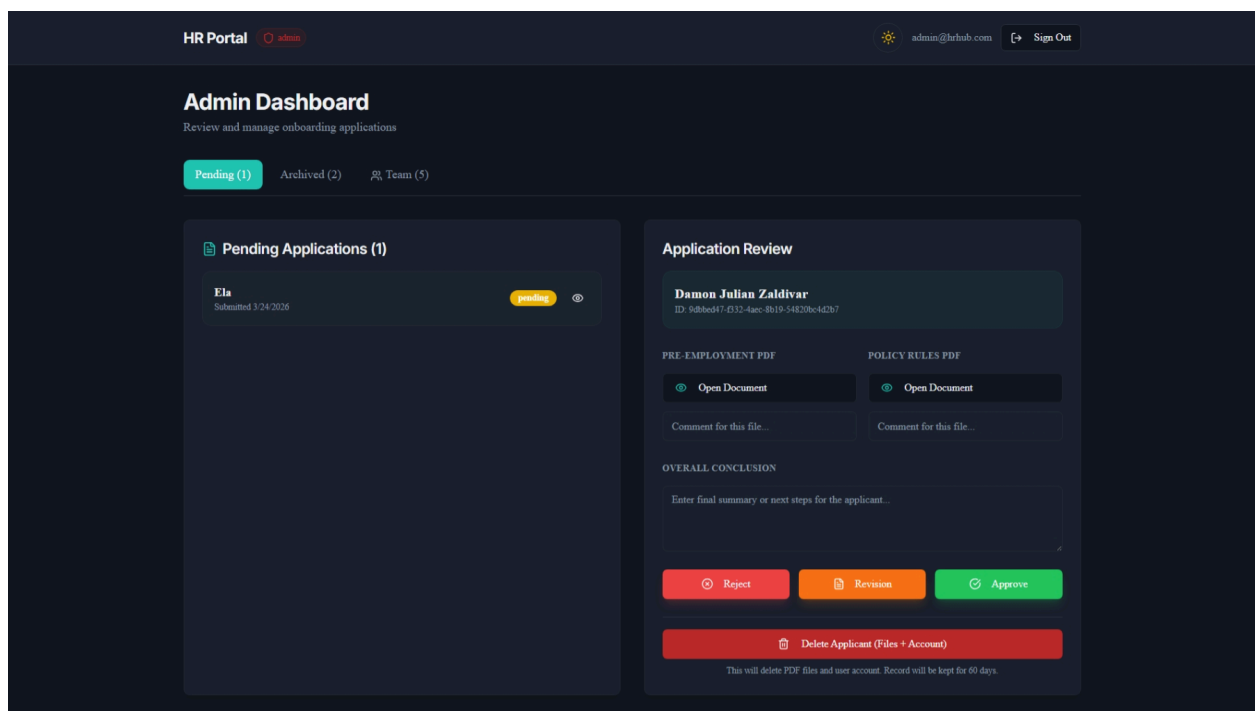
An automated account recovery email triggered via Supabase Auth and SMTP. It provides a secure, time-sensitive "Reset Password" button allowing the user to recover lost account credentials securely.

A screenshot of a "Reset Password" form. The form has a dark background with a light gray border. The title "Reset Password" is at the top, followed by the subtitle "Enter your new password". There are two input fields: "New Password" and "Confirm Password". Both fields have a placeholder text "Enter new password" and a toggle icon on the right. Below the input fields is a teal button labeled "Update Password". At the bottom, there is a section titled "Password must include:" with a list of requirements: "At least 8 characters", "Uppercase letter", "Lowercase letter", "Number", and "Special character (@, #, \$, etc.)". Each requirement is preceded by a checkmark icon.

The password reset entry form prompting users for a "New Password" and "Confirm Password". It features dynamic real-time password security criteria validation (minimum 8 characters,

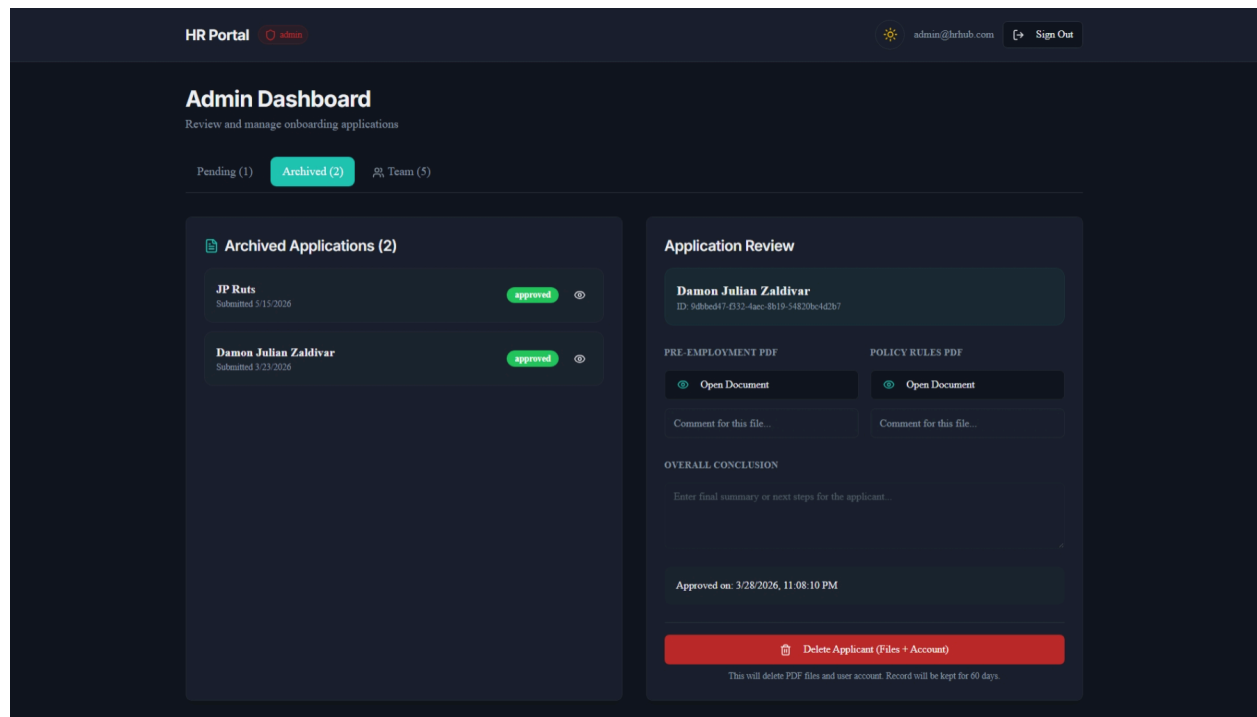
uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters) before enabling account updates.

Admin Page

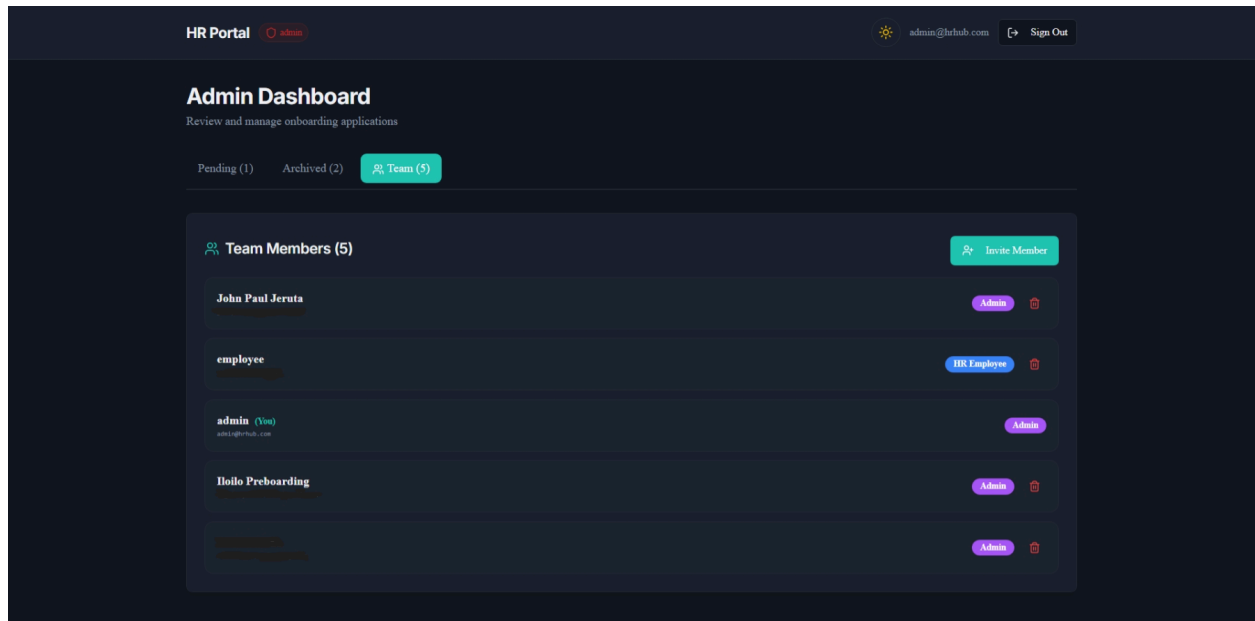


The primary evaluation workspace for administrators. The left panel lists pending applicant submissions (e.g., *Ela*), while the right panel allows evaluators to inspect submitted PDF documents, enter field-level feedback, input an overall evaluation summary, delete application and issue an official

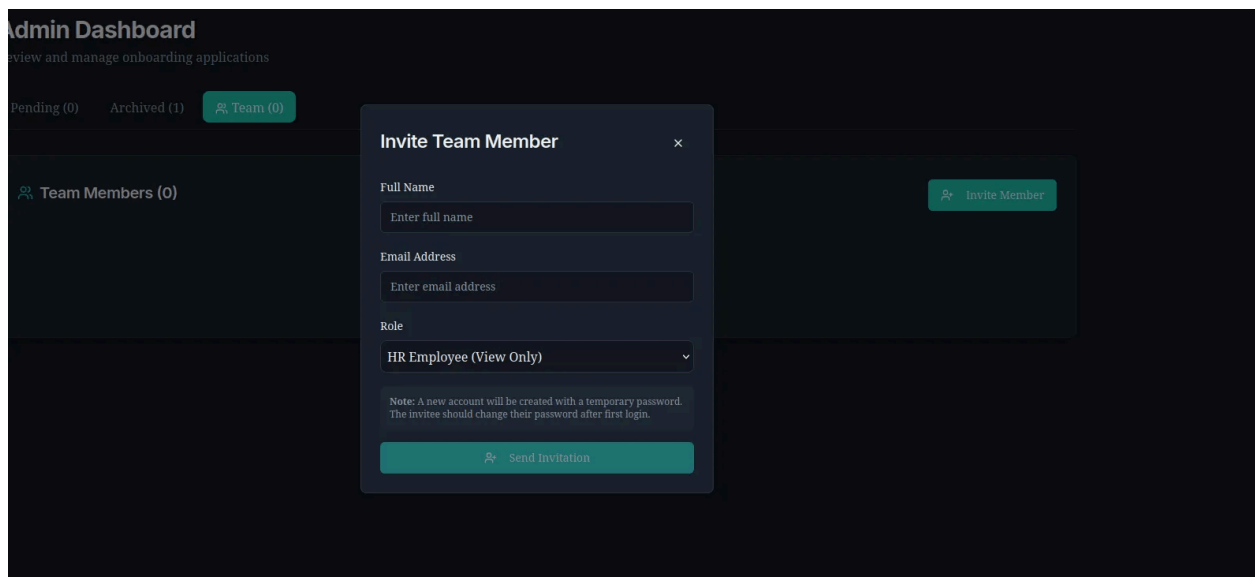
status decision ("Reject", "Revision" "Approve").



the administrator views all archived applicant records. The admin can select an applicant to review submitted documents, read previous comments, view the approval date, and permanently delete the applicant's account and uploaded files when necessary.



The administrative management view showing the "Team" management tab within the Admin Dashboard. It provides administrators with a dedicated interface to oversee HR personnel accounts and launch user invitation workflows via an "Invite Member" action button.



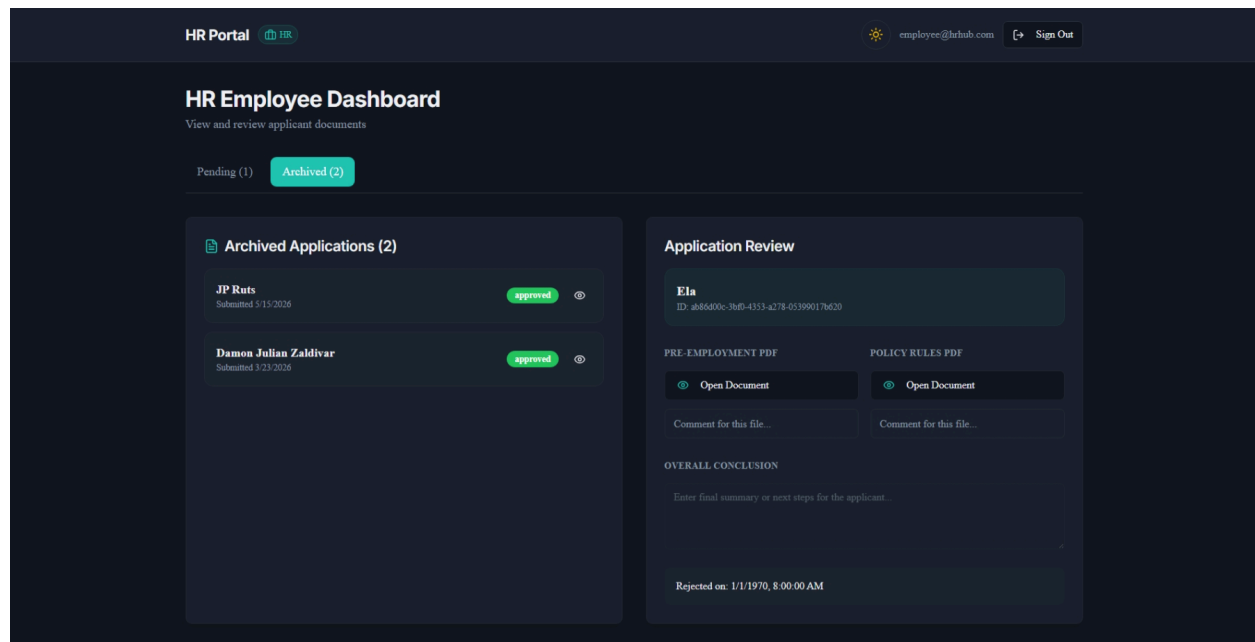
A modal dialog for onboarding internal staff. It collects full name and email credentials while providing granular Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) assignment options (e.g., *HR Employee*

(View Only)), automatically dispatching temporary login credentials upon submission.

HR Employee Page

The screenshot displays the 'HR Employee Dashboard' within an 'HR Portal'. The top navigation bar includes the portal name, a user profile icon, the email 'employee@hrhub.com', and a 'Sign Out' button. The main heading is 'HR Employee Dashboard' with the subtitle 'View and review applicant documents'. Below this, there are two tabs: 'Pending (1)' (active) and 'Archived (2)'. The dashboard is divided into two main sections. The left section, 'Pending Applications (1)', shows a single application for 'Ela', submitted on 3/24/2020, with a 'pending' status indicator. The right section, 'Application Review', provides a detailed view of the application. It includes the applicant's name 'Ela' and ID 'ab86400c-3b45-4353-a278-05399017b620'. There are two document review areas: 'PRE-EMPLOYMENT PDF' and 'POLICY RULES PDF', each with an 'Open Document' button and a 'Comment for this file...' input field. At the bottom, there is an 'OVERALL CONCLUSION' section with a text area for entering a final summary or next steps.

This page allows HR employees to review pending applicant submissions. Users can open uploaded documents, provide comments for each file, and enter an overall assessment before forwarding the application for further review or approval.



This displays archived applications that have already been processed. HR employees can review applicant information, access submitted documents, and view the final application status and decision history for reference purposes.

3.Code (Development)

Once the designs were locked in, this phase moved into writing the actual code by building the platform as a **Single Page Application (SPA)** using React.js, allowing applicants and admins to navigate smoothly between dashboards and forms without full page reloads. The frontend was broken down into reusable components, like dropzone file uploaders, real-time status badges, and interactive admin tables. For the backend, the system integrated Supabase to manage user authentication, PostgreSQL database tables, and secure storage buckets for uploaded PDFs. To handle server-side tasks such as sending approval emails and purging expired files, serverless Edge Functions were implemented using TypeScript. Throughout the coding phase, the team used Git and GitHub for version control, using feature branches to build separate components simultaneously like SPA routing and backend security rules, without conflicting before merging into the main branch.

4.Testing (Integration)

Testing was integrated directly into our development workflow rather than left until the very end. Every time a new feature branch was merged into GitHub, we conducted testing to ensure new changes didn't break existing features. We broke down our QA process into three main categories:

Testing Category	Tests Performed
Authentication Testing	User registration with all required fields
	Password strength validation
	Password visibility toggle
	Form field clearing on tab switch
	Email/password authentication
	Role-based redirection
Database and Security Testing	User role assignment
	Row Level Security (RLS) policy enforcement
	Application creation and retrieval
	Status workflow (Pending → Approved/Rejected)
UI/UX and Responsiveness Testing	Dark mode toggle
	Responsive layout
	Form validation
	Error message display
	Loading state verification

5. Deployment

Once a feature successfully passed all testing checks, the code was merged and automatically pushed to a live production environment using **Vercel**. By linking the GitHub repository directly to Vercel, any approved changes immediately triggered a live build without requiring manual server uploads. This automated deployment pipeline ensured that HR personnel, Admins, and testing users always had real-time access to the most updated, functional version of the application at all times.

6. Operations

In this phase where the system went live, the focus shifted to real-time monitoring and maintaining platform reliability. This phase involved managing backend performance, enforcing ongoing database security through Row Level Security (RLS) policies, and monitoring Supabase Edge Functions to ensure that applicant approval notifications and emails reach HR and Admin personnel without delay. Regular database logs and performance metrics were reviewed to address any runtime errors and kept the live environment secure and stable.

7. Monitoring

The team monitored the system performance and checked logs for any technical issues. Client feedback was gathered during this stage to identify areas for improvement, which then fed back into the Planning phase to begin the next cycle of the project.

3.3 System Architecture

The SecureFlow application is an automated, web-based onboarding system engineered to streamline pre-employment document submission and evaluation while enforcing robust data security, role-based access control (RBAC), and real-time status tracking. The system addresses the operational bottlenecks and security vulnerabilities inherent in traditional paper-heavy and unencrypted digital onboarding workflows. By replacing fragmented communication channels such as physical paper submissions and standard email attachments with a centralized Single Page Application (SPA), SecureFlow provides dedicated, role-tailored interfaces for Applicants, HR Personnel, and System Administrators.

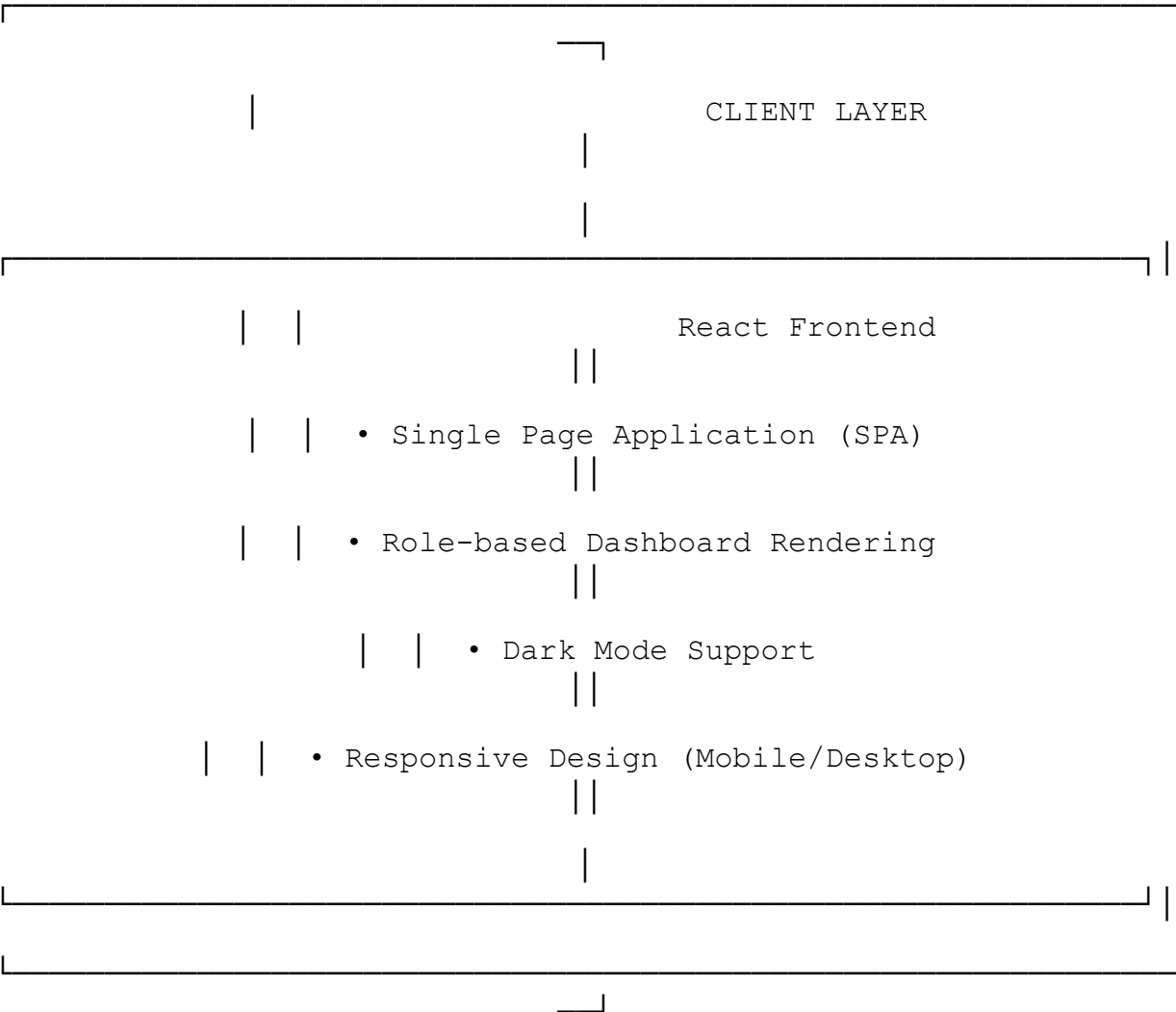
Unlike conventional Human Resource Information Systems (HRIS) that encompass broad, enterprise-wide employee management features, SecureFlow focuses specifically on optimizing the automated preboarding lifecycle. The platform enables job applicants to securely register, upload required pre-employment PDF credentials, and monitor their verification status in real time. For HR Personnel and System Administrators, the application provides an interactive verification dashboard equipped with embedded document previewing, perdocument feedback logging, workflow status updating (*Pending, Approved, Rejected*), and automated email notifications executed via serverless Edge Functions.

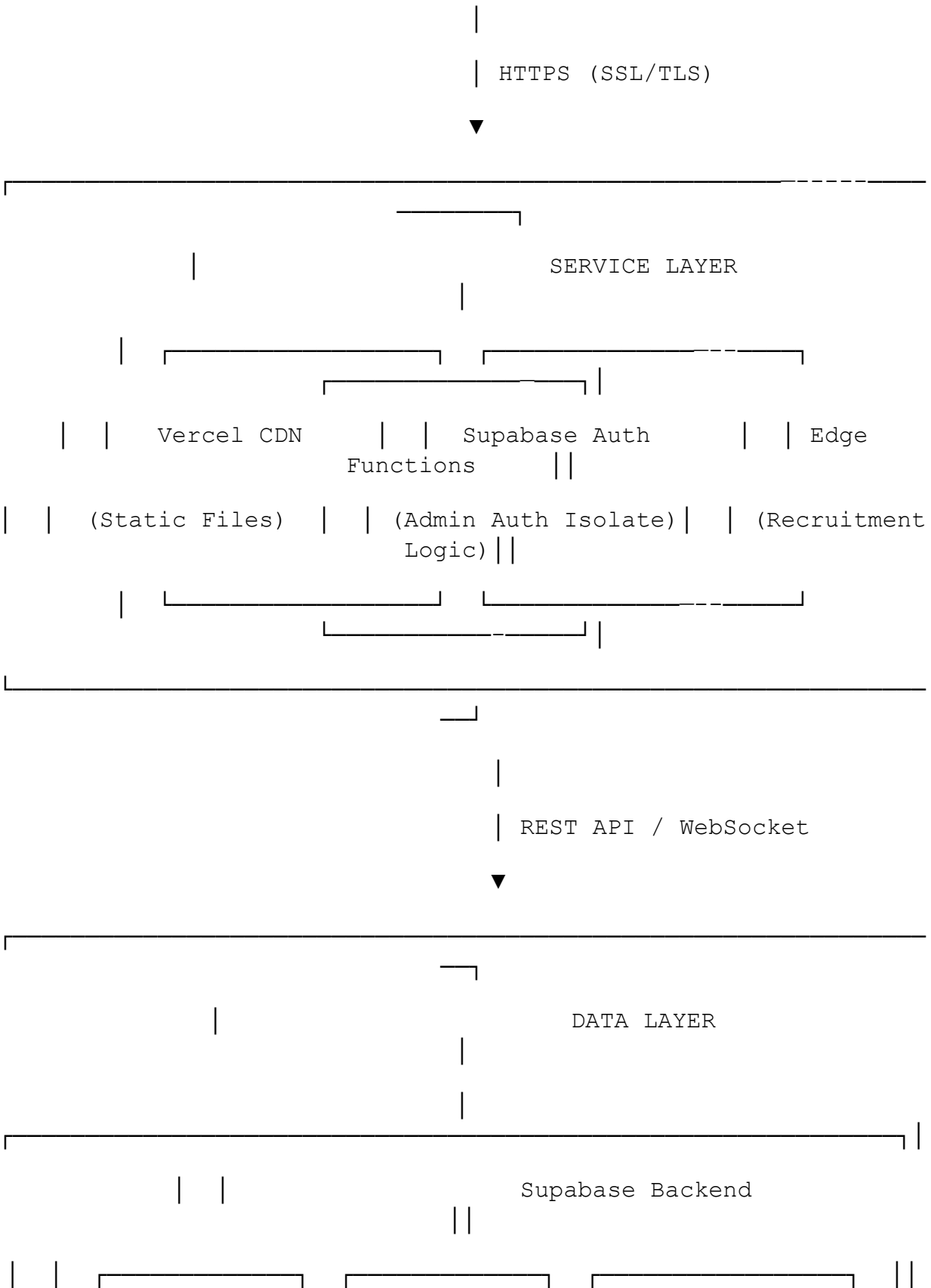
Built upon a modern, cloud-native architecture, the system leverages a React.js frontend deployed on Vercel for high-performance user interaction, paired with Supabase for backend services. Data integrity and fine-grained privacy are sustained at the database level using PostgreSQL Row Level Security (RLS) policies, while unstructured document assets are securely stored and accessed through managed Supabase Storage buckets.

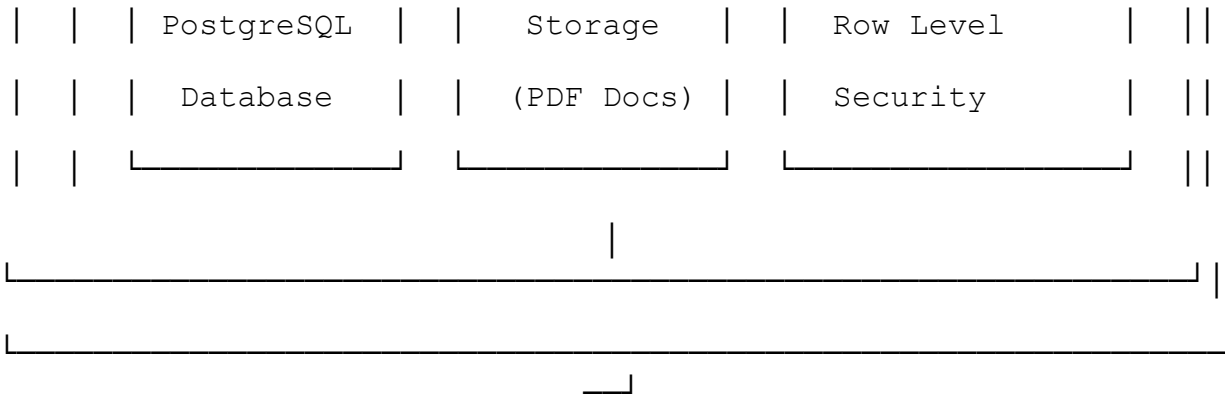
3.3.2 Client-server setup

The **SecureFlow** platform utilized a **three-tier cloud-based architecture** designed to handle real-time status tracking, document management, and strict role-based access control. This setup established a clear separation between the presentation frontend, serverless service layer, and database storage. By leveraging modern cloud infrastructure, the system ensured scalable document processing, low-latency updates, and database-level security across all user interactions.

Three-tier cloud-based Architecture







The architecture is structured into three distinct operational tiers: the **Client Layer**, the **Service Layer**, and the **Data Layer**. Each layer performed specialized roles to guarantee low latency, robust data isolation, and real-time responsiveness throughout the onboarding workflow.

3.3.2.1 Client Layers

The Client Layer serves as the primary interface through which users interact with the SecureFlow system. The frontend operates as a Single Page Application (SPA) and built using React to provide a dynamic user experience without requiring full page reloads during navigation. The interface dynamically adapted its layout and features based on the logged in user's role, whether an Applicant, HR Employee, or Administrator, ensuring that users only see the components relevant based on their authorization level. Additionally, the presentation layer incorporates responsive design principles to ensure seamless functionality across both desktop and mobile web browsers, alongside integrated Dark Mode support for enhanced accessibility.

3.3.2.2 Service Layer

The Service Layer acts as the intermediary execution engine, processing requests from the presentation layer and executing core business logic over encrypted HTTPS (SSL/TLS) connections. Static frontend assets are hosted and distributed globally via

Vercel's Content Delivery Network (CDN), minimizing loading latency for end users. User identity management and access control are handled through Supabase Auth, which manages authentication tokens and isolates administrative credentials to prevent unauthorized privilege escalation. Serverless Edge Functions handle system logic, including recruitment processes, payload validation for incoming files, and triggering real-time email notifications.

3.3.2.3 Data Layer

The Data Layer oversees all persistent storage, file hosting, and data-level access enforcement, communicating with the Service Layer through RESTful APIs and WebSocket protocols for real-time status updates. Structured system data such as user credentials, application histories, review comments, and system logs, is securely stored within a PostgreSQL relational database. Unstructured binary files, specifically pre-employment forms and signed policy agreements in PDF format, are saved in dedicated, encrypted buckets within Supabase Storage. To enforce strict data governance, PostgreSQL Row Level Security (RLS) policies are applied directly at the database engine level, ensuring that users can only query or modify records specifically granted to their access role.

3.3.3 User Interaction Flow

The user interaction flow defines how each user engages with the system according to their assigned roles and system boundaries. The platform categorizes interactions across three distinct user roles: Applicants, Employees, and HR/Administrators.

The Applicant pathway guides candidates through account creation, onboarding document submission, and real-time status monitoring. Applicants interact directly with the front-facing portal to fulfill pre-employment requirements and remain informed about their progress.

- Candidates set up their account credentials and complete their primary personal details.

- Applicants upload required onboarding credentials strictly formatted as PDF files.
- Candidates review and upload their signed policy agreement in PDF file.
- Applicants can update their demographic, contact details or any personal information at any point prior to final processing.
- Candidates can monitor real-time updates regarding their application progress directly onto their portal dashboard.
- Automated email updates are dispatched to the applicant upon approval or key application status changed by the higher up.

The HR Employee pathway provides administrative staff with visibility over incoming candidate files for monitoring purposes. Employees operate under a restricted permission model designed to preserve data integrity across candidate records.

- HR Employees can view all pending application submissions within the pending onboarding queue.
- Staff members have access to historical application records in a strictly read only format.
- HR Employees are restricted from approving, rejecting, modifying, or deleting any candidate records. The only task is to monitor all of the candidates files.

The Administrator pathway controls the governance, evaluation, and user lifecycle operations of the platform. HR/Admin possess elevated access to make official approval decisions, manage system users, and oversee data retention.

- Administrators can access a comprehensive overview of all pending, active, and completed candidate files.
- Administrators evaluate submitted documents from the candidates and execute final decision actions.
- Reviewers attach explanatory notes, comments or feedback directly to individual candidate records.
- Administrators decide to issue platform invitations and provision access roles for new staff members.
- Administrators hold exclusive authority to permanently remove candidate entries when necessary.

- Administrators manage and inspect historical, archived candidate records.

3.4 Tools and Technologies Used

3.4.1 Frontend Technologies

- **React.js:** Chosen for its component-based architecture, React allows the team to build a highly interactive UI that supports the real-time document handling requirements of the project.
- **TypeScript:** By using TypeScript (an extension of JavaScript), the development team ensures type safety, which reduces runtime errors and improves the overall reliability of the system.
- **Tailwind CSS:** This utility-first CSS framework is used to rapidly design a user-friendly and responsive interface for both the admin and applicant portals.

Technology	Version	Purpose
React	18.3.1	UI Framework
TypeScript	5.8.3	Type Safety
Vite	5.4.19	Build Tool
Tailwind CSS	3.4.17	Styling
Shadcn/UI	Latest	Component Library
React Router	6.30.1	Client-side Routing
Lucide React	0.462.0	Icons

3.4.2 Backend and Database Technologies

- **Supabase (PostgreSQL):** Instead of a standard SQL setup, SecureFlow utilizes Supabase to leverage PostgreSQL, a robust relational database known for its stability and advanced security features like Row-Level Security (RLS).
- **Real-time Engine:** Supabase provides built-in real-time data synchronization, which is essential for the system's "instant visibility" feature for document status changes.

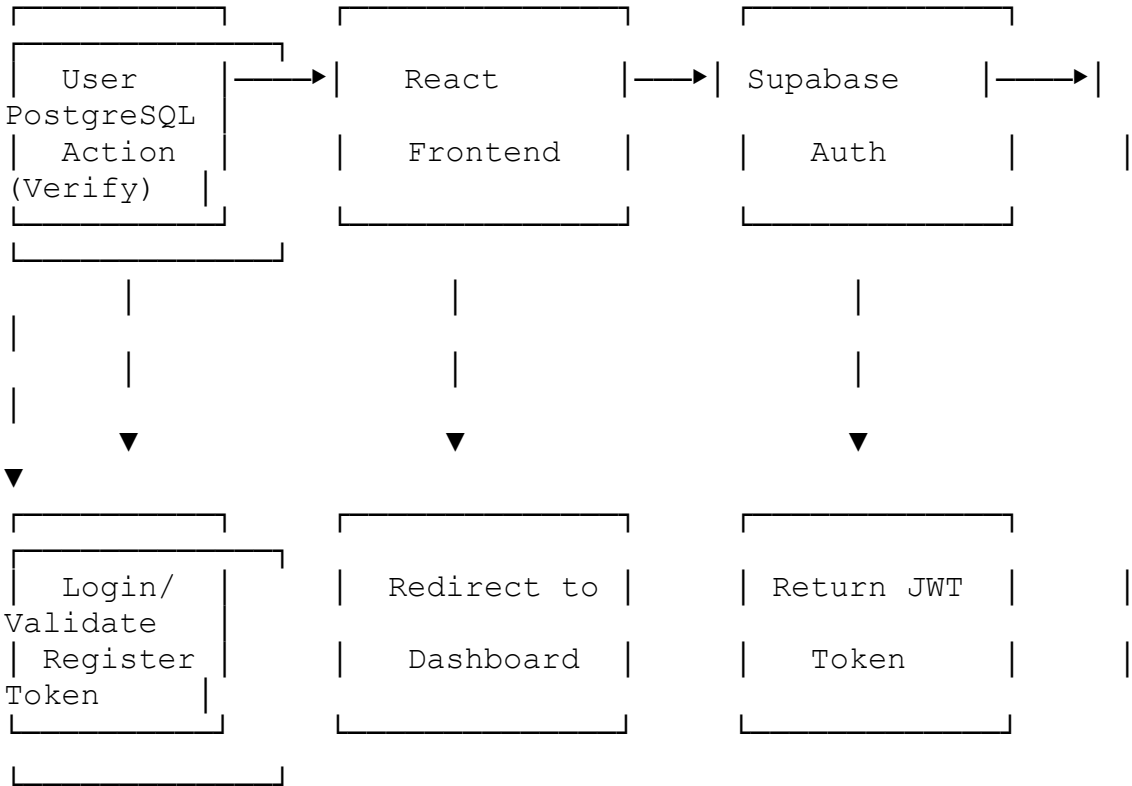
Technology	Version	Purpose
Supabase	Latest	Backend-as-a-Service
PostgreSQL	15+	Relational Database
Edge Functions	Deno	Serverless Functions
Row Level Security	-	Database Security

3.4.3 Deployment and Development Tools

- **Vercel:** This platform was used for deployment, ensuring that the frontend remains highly available and that updates are pushed automatically through the Agile DevOps cycle.
- **Visual Studio Code & Git:** These served as the primary development environment and version control system, facilitating seamless collaboration among the six developers on the team.

Technology	Purpose
Git	Version Control
npm	Package Management
ESLint	Code Linting
Prettier	Code Formatting

3.3.1 Security architecture



The security architecture illustrates how user authentication and authorization are handled within the system. When a user logs in or registers through the React frontend, the request is

processed by Supabase Authentication. Supabase verifies the user's credentials and returns a JWT (JSON Web Token) upon successful authentication. The token is then validated by PostgreSQL to ensure that only authenticated and authorized users can access protected system resources. After successful verification, the user is redirected to the appropriate dashboard.

3.3.2 Security Measures Implemented

The system implements several security measures to protect user accounts, data, and system resources:

1. Password Security

- Minimum 8 characters
- Requires uppercase, lowercase, number, special character
- Secure hashing via Supabase Auth

2. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

- Framework built with UI components (stubs ready)
- Optional for all user roles

3. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

- Three distinct roles: Admin, HR, Applicant
- Server-side role verification
- Database-level RLS policies
-

4. Content Security Policy (CSP)

- Prevents XSS attacks
- Restricts script sources
- Controls external resource loading

5. Security Headers

- X-Frame-Options: DENY
- X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff

- X-XSS-Protection enabled
- Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin

6. Secure Password Generation

- Cryptographically secure random values
- 16+ character temporary passwords
- Auto-generated for invited users
-

3.3.3 API Architecture

3.3.3.1 REST Endpoint

The API architecture defines how the system's frontend communicates with backend services through REST endpoints. Each endpoint is assigned a specific HTTP method, function, and access level to ensure that users can only perform authorized operations.

Endpoint	Method	Description	Access
/auth/signup	POST	Register new user	Public
/auth/login	POST	User authentication	Public
/auth/logout	POST	End user session	Authenticated
/profiles	GET	Get user profile	Authenticated
/profiles	PATCH	Update profile	Authenticated
/applicants	GET	List applications	HR/Admin

/applicants	POST	Submit application	Applicant
/applicants/:id	PATCH	Update status	Admin
/user_roles	GET	Get user roles	Authenticated

3.3.3.2 Admin Operations

Admin operations provided secure tools for managing users, roles, notifications, and system records. The system allowed administrators to invite and delete users, send approval emails through Edge Functions, and automatically remove records older than 45 days through scheduled tasks.

Operation	Method	Purpose
Invite User	Supabase Admin API	Create user with temp password, assign role
Delete User	Supabase Admin API	Remove user from auth, profiles, roles, applicants
send-approval-email	Edge Function	Send professional onboarding email
delete-old-records	Edge Function (Cron)	Auto-delete after 45 days

3.5 Data Gathering Techniques

- Interview

Conducted with the client to understand the process of manual onboarding and identify its concerns and requirements for improving.

Research questions:

1. Can you describe your current workflow from receiving applications to making the final hiring decision?
2. What tools or systems do you use to collect and manage applicant information?
3. What challenges do you commonly encounter during the recruitment and screening process?
4. Which part of reviewing and evaluating applicants takes the most time?
5. What tasks in your hiring process are still done manually?
6. Have you experienced issues with missing, incomplete, or duplicated applicant records? If yes, how does it affect your work?
7. How do you organize and track applicant documents such as resumes and interview notes?
8. What types of applicant information are most difficult to verify or manage?
9. What improvements would you like to see in your current recruitment and applicant tracking process?
10. What features would help you make faster and more accurate hiring decisions?

Based on the client of their current process, applicants submitted their materials through online job platforms or email which were then routed to a single shared inbox (*iloilopreboarding@...*) serving all sites. HR personnel manually reviewed each incoming email, extract candidate details, and log the information into shared spreadsheets. Throughout the hiring lifecycle, testing results and interview notes arrived in

separate, unlinked email threads for the same candidate, leaving the team without a unified view of an applicant's progress.

The entire preboarding operation relied on this single email inbox paired with manual spreadsheets, using basic tags and folder structures to organize records. Document management remained bound to these individual email threads, forcing HR staff to rely on exact names or application dates to locate attachments or else, resulting in slow manual scrolling.

Because almost the entire pipeline is handled manually from initial resume screening and test link distribution to document collection and spreadsheet updates, the workflow faces severe operational delays. The most time consuming task is constantly searching the inbox to piece together basic details, such as whether a candidate applied, received a test link, or passed an evaluation. As a result, HR team members spend significantly more time searching for buried emails than evaluating talent.

Relying on manual email management introduced frequent errors and missing, incomplete, or duplicate records. Candidates often reached out from multiple email addresses, creating split threads for a single person. When an HR representative was absent, unmatched test results piled up because colleagues lacked context on the initial screening. Crucially, tracking candidate status is the most difficult information to manage; without a single dashboard displaying the pipeline, the team frequently loses track of candidates, faces delay inducing update requests from applicants, and risks duplicated efforts such as interviewing the same applicant twice.

The client's desired improvement is that it must be one place where everything connects. Applicant emails in → status updates as they move through testing → interview → decision. No more inbox hunting, no more wondering which stage someone is in. The feature that would help him was a dashboard that shows the full pipeline: who just applied, who's waiting for the test, who passed, who needs documents. Automated status emails so applicants don't have to call for updates. Documents attached to the applicant's profile not buried in an email attachment.

3.6 Testing Procedures

To ensure that **SecureFlow** operates reliably and securely, testing was integrated continuously throughout the development process rather than left until the final stage. The system underwent three primary levels of testing to validate individual features, end-to-end data flows, and overall alignment with user expectations.

1. Unit Testing

Unit testing focused on evaluating core system components independently to verify that their underlying logic and state management functioned correctly in isolation before integration.

- **Authentication and Identity System:** Tested user registration, email/password validation, password strength indicators (enforcing special characters and character length), password visibility toggling, and automatic form resets on tab switches.
- **Document Handling Module:** Tested the dropzone upload components, file format restrictions (PDF validation), and file size limits to ensure documents are overwritten correctly in Supabase Storage without creating duplicate entries.
- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):** Verified that route guards within the React Single Page Application (SPA) correctly restricted page navigation based on authenticated session roles (Applicant, HR, Admin).

2. System Testing

System testing evaluated the complete, integrated application to verify that all frontend interfaces, database operations, and serverless Edge Functions worked together automatically.

- **Database and Security Policy Enforcement:** Verified that PostgreSQL Row Level Security (RLS) policies successfully restricted data access ensuring applicants could only view their own uploaded files while HR and Admin users could access evaluation queues.
- **End-to-End Application Workflow:** Tested the full status lifecycle, tracking an applicant's profile creation from initial document submission(pending) through HR evaluation and final decision (approved or rejected).
- **Automated Notification Delivery:** Tested serverless Supabase Edge Functions (send approval email) connected to Gmail

SMTP to ensure approval updates triggered real-time email notifications.

- **UI/UX and Responsiveness:** Validated dark-mode theme rendering, real-time loading states, error toast displays, and layout adaptation across mobile and desktop devices.

3. User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

User Acceptance Testing was conducted directly with stakeholders and the client to evaluate the live application deployed on the Vercel staging environment.

- **Client Evaluation:** Stakeholders reviewed the live administrative dashboard and applicant interfaces to confirm that document upload, verification, and automated email workflows accurately meet their actual preboarding operational needs.
- **Process Alignment:** The client verified that role permissions (such as spectator view only access for HR employees versus full action rights for Admins) met operational security requirements.
- **Sign Off:** Upon passing all evaluation scenarios, the client confirmed that the platform successfully automates manual onboarding tasks, meeting the project's core functional scope.

3.7 Evaluation Criteria

To systematically measure the quality, performance, and overall effectiveness of SecureFlow, the platform was evaluated based on five key software quality criteria adapted from standard ISO software quality models:

1. Functionality

Evaluated the degree to which the system delivers all intended features and satisfies stated operational requirements.

- Authentication and Role Management: Verified that user registration, login, password recovery, and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) function without logical gaps.
- Document Processing Lifecycle: Assessed the end-to-end flow of applicant credential submissions, file status tracking (Pending, Approved, Rejected), and inline feedback tools.
- Automated Workflow Execution: Measured the execution accuracy of serverless Supabase Edge Functions for sending real-time approval emails and executing scheduled data cleanup policies.

2. Usability

Assessed the clarity, accessibility, and ease of interaction across all user roles (Applicants, HR Personnel, and Administrators).

- Interface Design and Navigation: Evaluates the intuitiveness of the dark-mode Single Page Application (SPA) layout, dashboard component organization, and clear status indicators.
- User Experience (UX) Feedback: Measured how effectively the system communicates actions to users through loading spinners, interactive error displays, and clear confirmation prompts.
- Cross-Device Responsiveness: Evaluated interface adaptability and element alignment across both desktop monitors and mobile viewports.

3. Reliability

Measured system stability, uptime, and error consistency during active operational use.

- **System Uptime and Availability:** Assessed the continuous live availability of the frontend hosted on Vercel and backend services on Supabase.
- **Error Handling and State Recovery:** Evaluated the system's capacity to handle network disruptions, invalid form inputs, or failed upload attempts gracefully without crashing or corrupting state.
- **Database Consistency:** Verified that database triggers (such as `handle_new_user`) executed reliably to prevent missing profile records or broken primary/foreign key relationships.

4. Security

Evaluated the protection of sensitive candidate documents, personal information, and administrative capabilities against unauthorized access.

- **Data Isolation via Row Level Security (RLS):** Assessed the enforcement of PostgreSQL RLS policies to guarantee applicants can access only their own files, preventing unauthorized cross-user data exposure.
- **Storage and Access Controls:** Verified secure bucket permissions, zero-egress Edge Function security (utilizing Service Role Keys for administrative tasks), and safe file-handling mechanics.
- **Credential Protection:** Evaluated password complexity enforcement, secure session token handling via Supabase Auth, and protected route guards in the frontend.

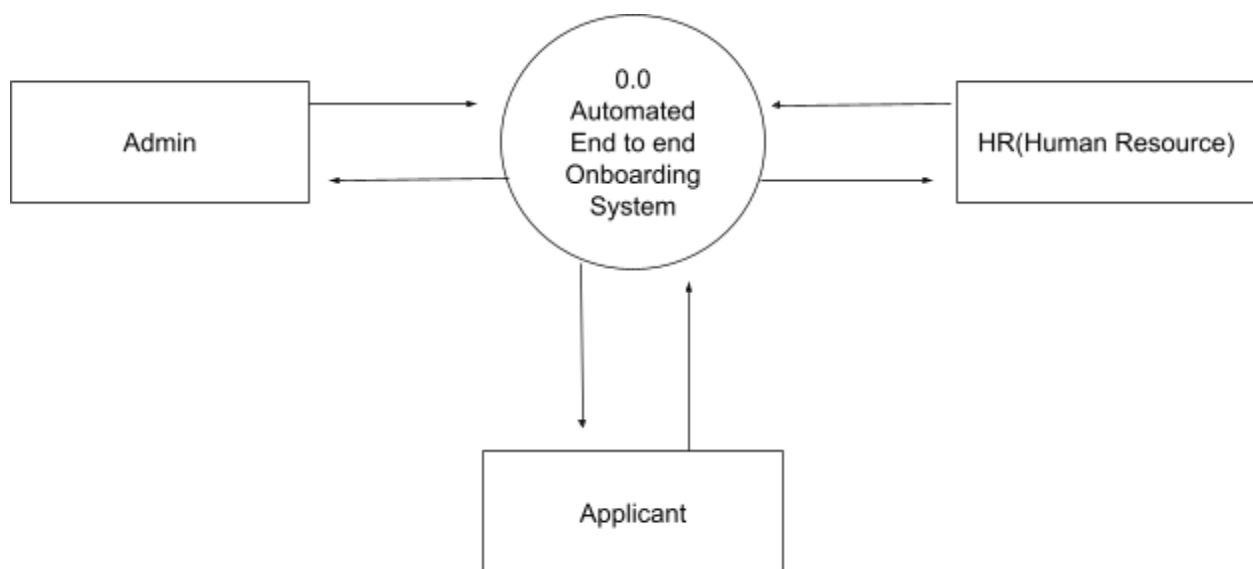
5. Efficiency

Measured system response times, resource consumption, and processing speed during typical user workflows.

- **Page Load and Navigation Speed:** Evaluated the rendering speed of the React Single Page Application (SPA) without unnecessary full-page refreshes.
- **Upload and Storage Optimization:** Assessed file handling speeds and storage optimization via `upsert` (overwrite) logic to minimize storage footprint and network overhead.
- **Edge Function Execution:** Measured the execution latency of serverless backend functions when triggering approval emails or background processes.

SUPPORTING DIAGRAMS (Included within Chapter 3)

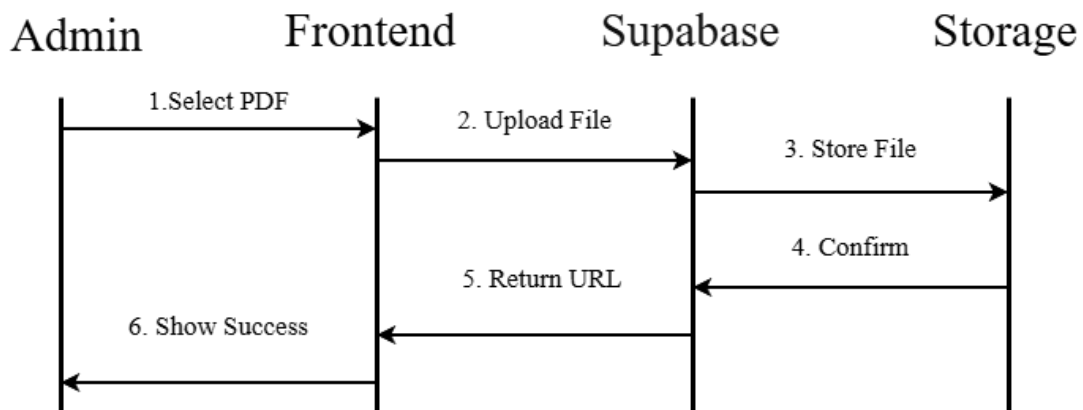
Data Flow Diagram (DFD - Level 0)



The operational workflow of SecureFlow began in the Applicant Interface where users initiate the onboarding process by submitting their comprehensive personal information and required digital credentials through a secure portal. Upon submission, the system utilized its backend integration to ensure that all data is stored securely while simultaneously triggering real-time updates across the administrative dashboard. This immediate data synchronization eliminated the loss typically associated with manual file handling. Once the data is live, Human Resource (HR) personnel are tasked with the critical phase of reviewing and verifying the submitted documentation for authenticity and compliance.

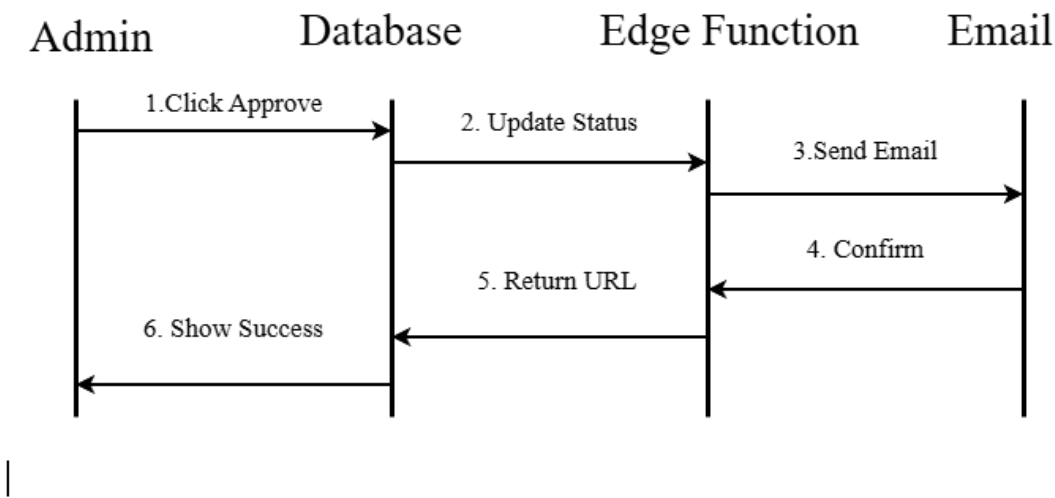
As HR interacts with the records, the system's automated logic dynamically updates the application status, providing instantaneous transparency; the system then executes an automated notification protocol to inform the user of their progress, ensuring a seamless feedback loop. Overseeing the entire ecosystem is the Administrator, who possesses the high-level authority to manage and audit all organizational records, ensuring system integrity. Throughout this entire lifecycle, the architecture ensured that all data points are systematically stored in and retrieved from the centralized database, leveraging Row-Level Security to maintain strict confidentiality and data persistence.

Document Upload Flow



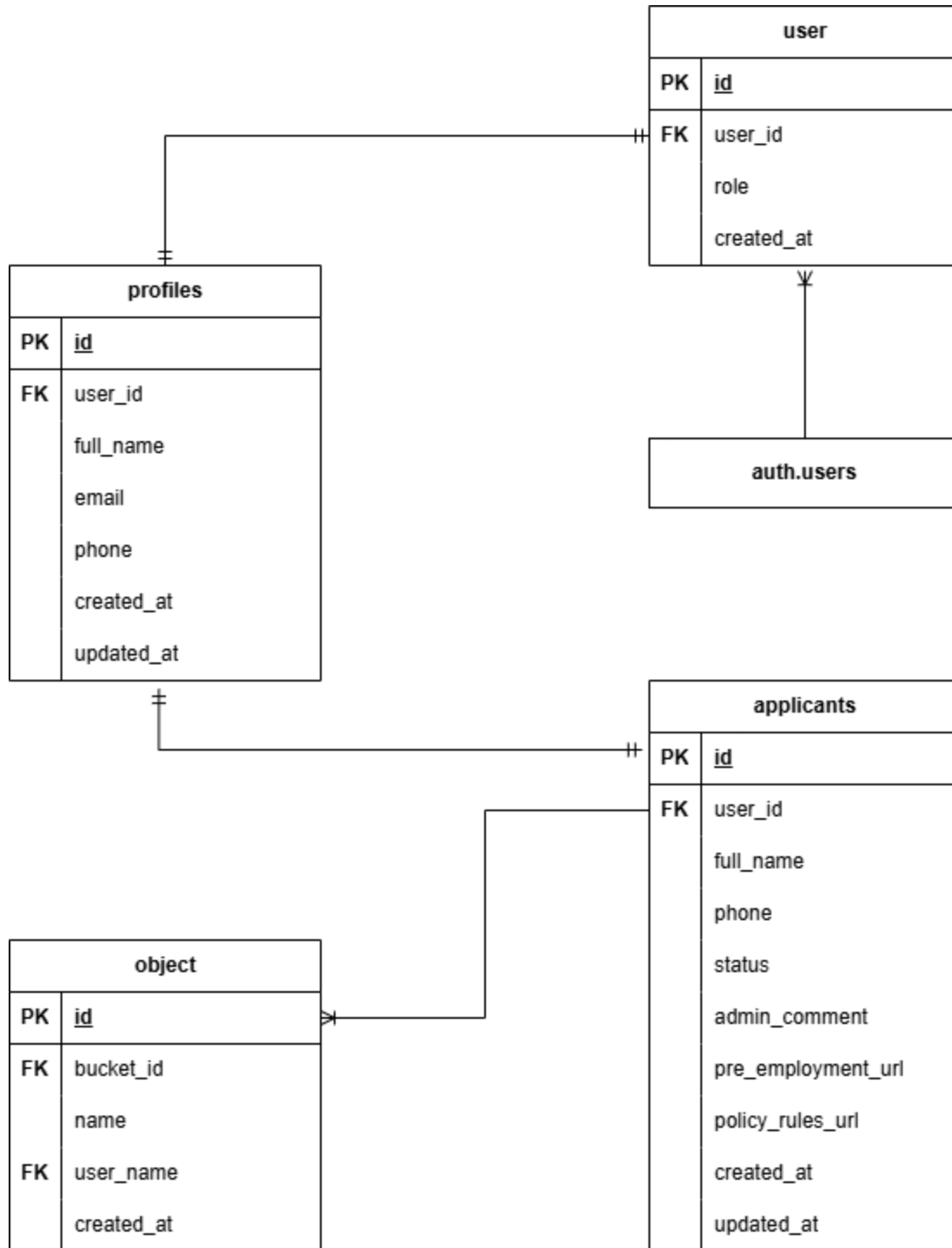
The flow illustrated the sequential execution of the pre-employment document submission feature. The process was initiated when the Applicant selects a PDF file via the React frontend. The application issued an authenticated upload request to Supabase Storage, enforcing Row Level Security (RLS) rules before writing the file to storage. Upon confirmation, the backend recorded the document file path in the applicants table, returning a success response to the client interface to confirm completion.

Approval WorkFlow



The flow illustrated the sequence of events executed when an Admin or HR Personnel approved an applicant's preboarding status. The process was initiated when the evaluator updates the status to "Approved" on the React frontend, sending an update query to the Supabase database. Upon updating the row, a database trigger or webhook invoked a Supabase Edge Function, which securely dispatches an automated notification email to the candidate via an integrated email service. Once delivery is confirmed, the system returns a success response to update the frontend status in real time.

Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD)



The operational lifecycle of **SecureFlow** is governed by a series of hierarchical and collaborative relationships designed to maintain strict data integrity and workflow efficiency. The process initiates at the user level, where a newly registered

Applicant triggers the creation of a record in `auth.user` which automatically populates a corresponding entry in **`public.profiles`** via a system trigger. Through an automated backend procedure, the user is assigned the default "Applicant" role in **`public.user_roles`**. Conversely, administrative control is managed top down by the **Admin**, who provisions accounts and manages elevated permissions for internal HR staff, enforcing Row Level Security (RLS) boundaries across all system modules.

Once an applicant account is active, an applicant's record was established to track the candidate's hiring status. The core preboarding workflow centers on direct document submission: the **Applicant** uploads digital credentials and required pre-employment forms directly to Supabase `storage.objects`. This action updated the applicant's record, enabled **HR personnel** to inspect and verify submitted files through the central onboarding dashboard. During this evaluation phase, HR staff reviewed the uploaded documents and executed real-time document verification. Following evaluation, **HR or Administrator** accounts update the applicant's status (e.g., from "Pending" to "Approved" or "Rejected"), which updates the database in real time. Finally, HR and Admins maintained collaborative oversight across all applicant records and stored files, ensuring pre-employment compliance and record accuracy without manual inbox searching.

Database Scheme

Table:`public.profiles`

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
<code>id</code>	UUID	PRIMARY KEY	Auto-generated
<code>user_id</code>	UUID	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	FK to <code>auth.users</code>
<code>full_name</code>	TEXT	NOT NULL	User's full name

email	TEXT	NULLABLE	Identification fallback
phone	TEXT	NULLABLE	Contact number
created_at	TIMESTAMPTZ	DEFAULT NOW()	Record creation
updated_at	TIMESTAMPTZ	DEFAULT NOW()	Last update

The public.profile table stored extended user profile information synchronized with Supabase Authentication(auth.users). The table detailed its schema structure, maintaining non-sensitive identity metadata while linking relational references across the system's database ecosystem.

Table:public.user

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	UUID	PRIMARY KEY	Auto-generated
user_id	UUID	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	FK to auth.users
role	TEXT	NOT NULL	'admin', 'employee', 'applicant'
created_at	TIMESTAMPTZ	DEFAULT NOW()	Role assignment

			date
--	--	--	------

To implement Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) securely across the application, system access levels are governed by the public.user_role table. The table detailed the schema structure that maps authenticated users to specific system roles(Applicant,HR, Admin), enforcing permission boundaries throughout the cloud-native environment.

Table:public.applicants

The core entity driving the onboarding submission workflow is the public.applicant table hosted within the Supabase PostgreSQL database.details its data dictionary, outlining attribute definitions, data types, relational constraints, and cloud storage pointers utilized for document management.

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	UUID	PRIMARY KEY	Auto-generated
user_id	UUID	NOT NULL, FK	FK to auth.users
full_name	TEXT	NOT NULL	Applicant name
phone	TEXT	NULLABLE	Contact number
status	TEXT	DEFAULT 'pending'	pending/approved/rejected

admin_comment	TEXT	NULLABLE	Admin review notes
pre_employment_url	TEXT	NULLABLE	PDF storage path
policy_rules_url	TEXT	NULLABLE	PDF storage path
created_at	TIMESTAMPTZ	DEFAULT NOW()	Application date
updated_at	TIMESTAMPTZ	DEFAULT NOW()	Last update

Table:Storage.objects(PDF Files)

In addition to structured relational tables, binary asset management is handled by the storage.objects table inside Supabase Cloud Storage. It detailed the metadata schema utilized to reference uploaded PDF documents, linking storage objects back to individual authenticated user accounts while enforcing access control.

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	UUID	PRIMARY KEY, Auto-generated	Unique identifier for the stored file object entity.
bucket_id	TEXT	FOREIGN KEY	Key identifying the target storage bucket (e.g., 'pre-employment-docs')

			.
name	TEXT	NOT NULL	File system path and original filename of the uploaded PDF asset.
user_id	UUID	FOREIGN KEY	Relational key linking object ownership directly to auth.users(id).
created_at	TIMESTAMPTZ	DEFAULT NOW()	Timestamp recording the exact time of document upload.

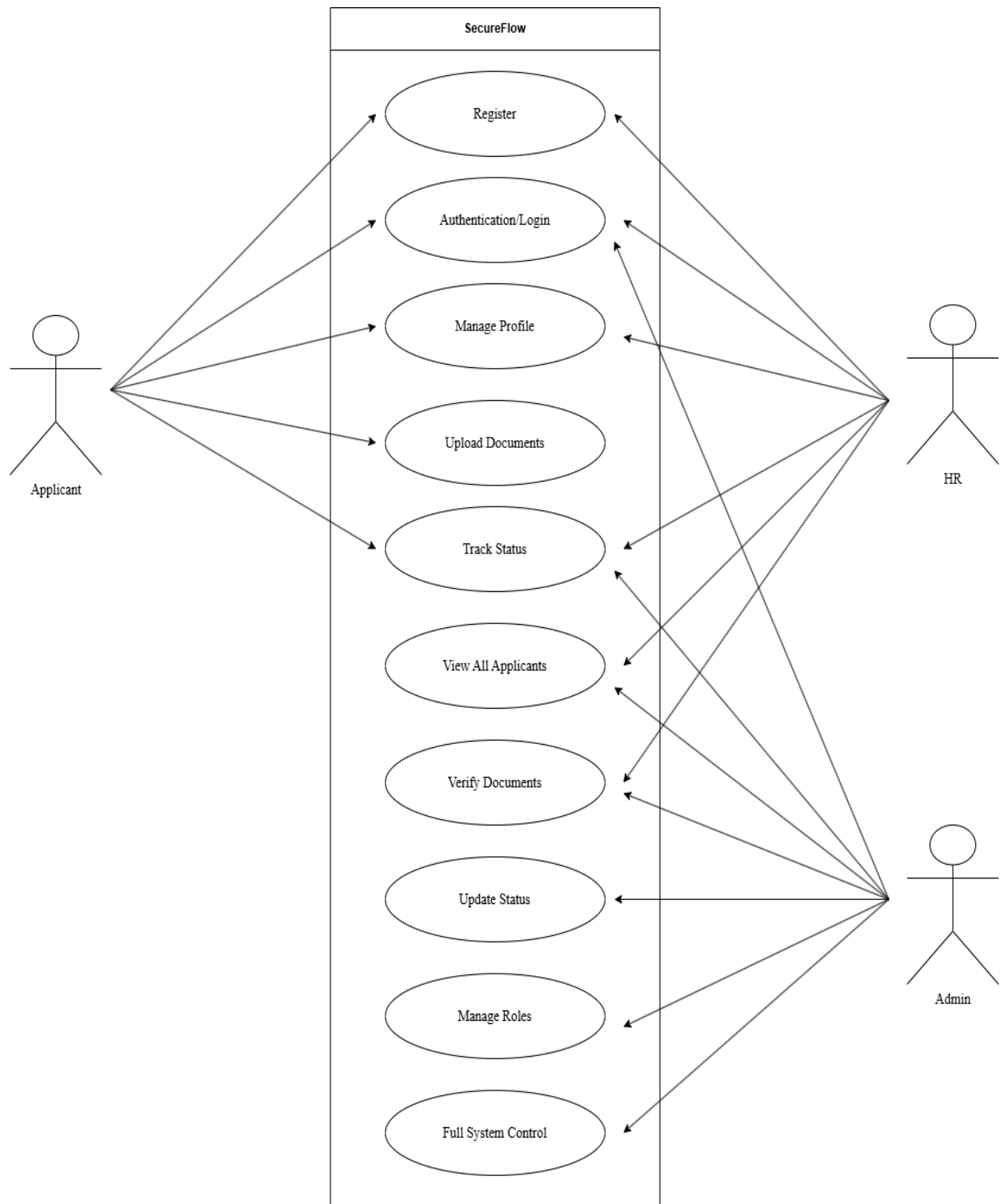
Row Level Security(RLS) Policies

To enforce strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) at the database layer and prevent cross-role data leakage, Row Level Security (RLS) policies were configured directly on PostgreSQL tables in Supabase Cloud. It outlines the specific security rules applied to the core system entities.

Table	Policy Name	Description
profiles	Users view own	Users can read

	profile	their own profile
profiles	Users update own profile	Users can update their own data
profiles	Admins view all	Admins can view all profiles
user_roles	Role assignment	Automatic role assignment on signup
applicants	Applicants view own	Applicants see only their application
applicants	HR view all	HR can view all applications
applicants	Admins full access	Admins can perform all operations

Use Case Diagram



The functional capabilities of SecureFlow are defined through the interactions of three primary actors : the Applicant, the HR

Personnel, and the Administrator operating across ten core use cases within the system boundary. The onboarding process initiated with the Register Account use case, which served as the intake point for candidates, automatically requiring the Authenticate / Login use case through an included relationship to establish a secure session. Once logged in, candidates engaged with the Manage Profile use case to input their personal contact information, establishing their digital identity within the platform.

The core operational value for candidates is realized through the Upload Pre-Employment Documents use case, which is exclusive to the Applicant actor. Uploading requirements automatically connects to the Track Application Status use case, providing candidates with real-time visibility into their pipeline progress (*Pending, Approved, or Rejected*) and directly resolving the lack of status transparency in the current manual process.

As submissions enter the system, the View All Applicants, and Verify Submitted Documents use cases became the primary responsibilities of HR Personnel and Administrators. Evaluators access a centralized dashboard to review incoming applications, inspect uploaded pre-employment files, and log evaluation decisions without searching through scattered email threads. Finally, system governance is maintained through the Manage User Roles and Delete / Archive Record use cases, and Update Application Status reserved exclusively for the Administrator actor. These high-level use cases granted admins exclusive control to provision internal accounts, adjust user access levels, and purge outdated records to maintain data privacy compliance.

CHAPTER 4

SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT, IMPLEMENTATION, TESTING, EVALUATION, RESULTS, AND DISCUSSION

4.2 Overview of the Developed System

The **SecureFlow** application is an automated web-based onboarding system developed to streamline pre-employment document submission and evaluation while ensuring robust data security, role-based access control, and real-time status tracking. The system addressed the operational bottlenecks and security vulnerabilities inherent in traditional paper-heavy and unencrypted digital onboarding workflows. By replacing fragmented communication channels (such as physical paper submissions and standard email attachments) with a centralized Single Page Application (SPA), SecureFlow provided dedicated, role-tailored portals for Applicants, HR Personnel, and System Administrators.

Unlike conventional Human Resource Information Systems (HRIS) that combined broad employee management features, SecureFlow focused specifically on the automated preboarding lifecycle. The platform enabled job applicants to securely register, upload required pre-employment PDF credentials, and monitor their verification status in real time. For HR Personnel and Administrators, the application provided an intuitive verification dashboard equipped with embedded document viewing, per-document feedback logging, status workflow updating (Pending Approved, Rejected, and automated email notifications triggered via serverless Edge Functions).

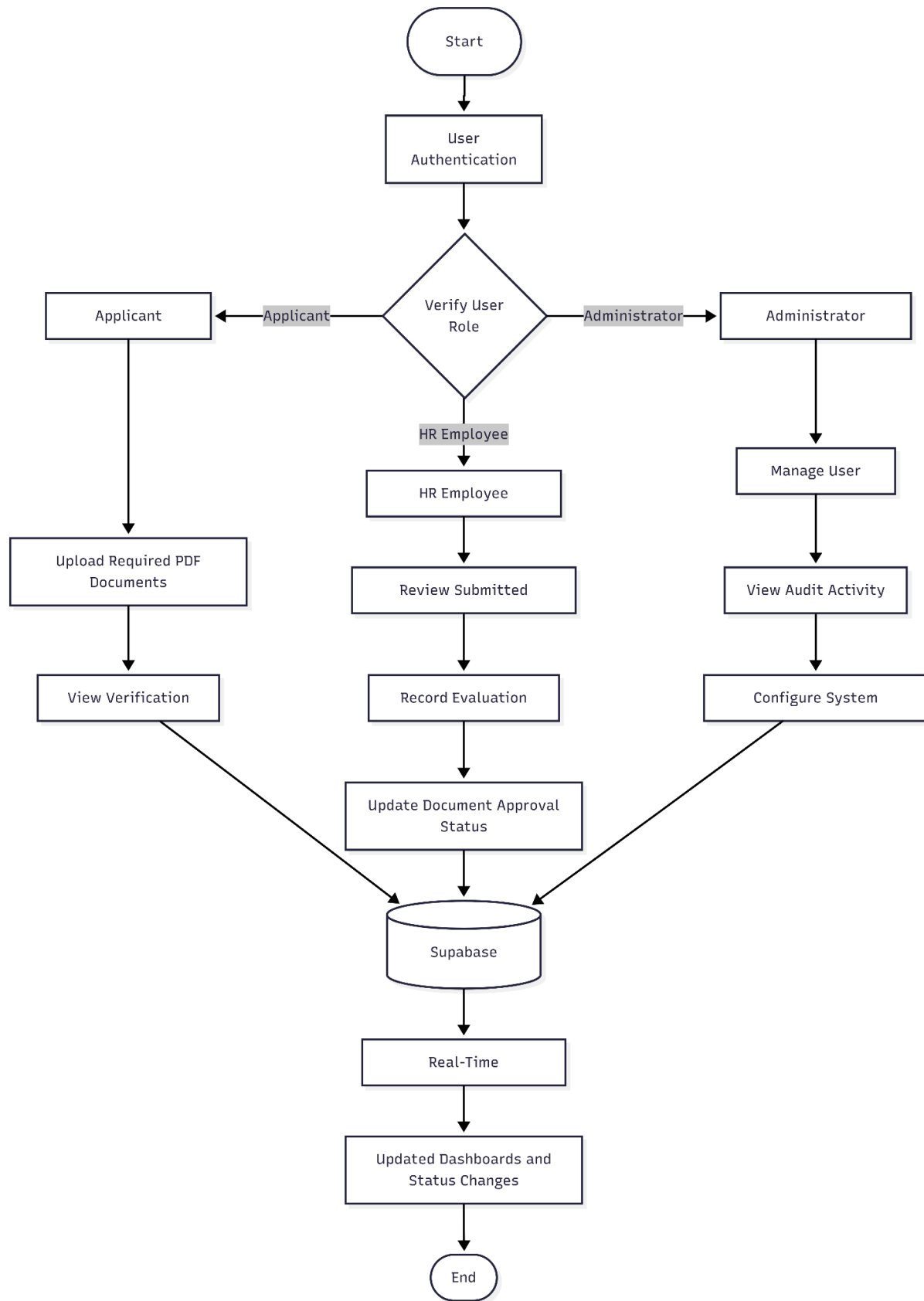
The platform provided small and medium enterprises (SMEs) and corporate HR departments with an efficient, auditable, and secure onboarding solution that accelerates time-to-hire, enforces data privacy compliance, and minimizes administrative overhead.

The major objectives of the developed system are as follows:

- Automated the registration, document upload, and tracking of pre-employment onboarding workflows.
- Secured candidate credentials during transmission and storage using cloud-native encryption and Row Level Security (RLS).
- Provided dedicated, role user interfaces for Applicants, HR Personnel, and Administrators.
- Enabled real-time document inspection, per-document feedback logging, and approval status updates.
- Eliminated unencrypted file distribution by centralizing credential management within secure object storage buckets.
- Supported administrative oversight through automated audit logging and automated email notifications via SMTP integration.

The developed SecureFlow follows modern software engineering and cybersecurity principles by incorporating responsive frontend design, serverless backend architecture, granular access control policies, and automated event triggers. The completed system consists of several interconnected modules that work together to capture, store, verify, and notify users throughout the preboarding lifecycle.

Figure 4.1: Overall System Workflow Diagram of SecureFlow

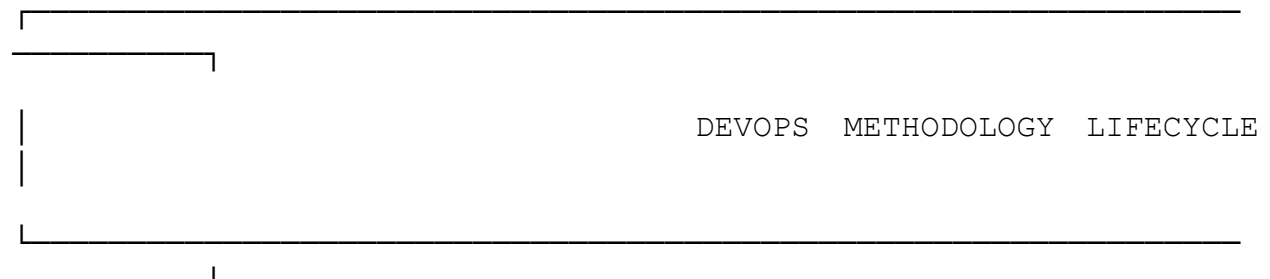


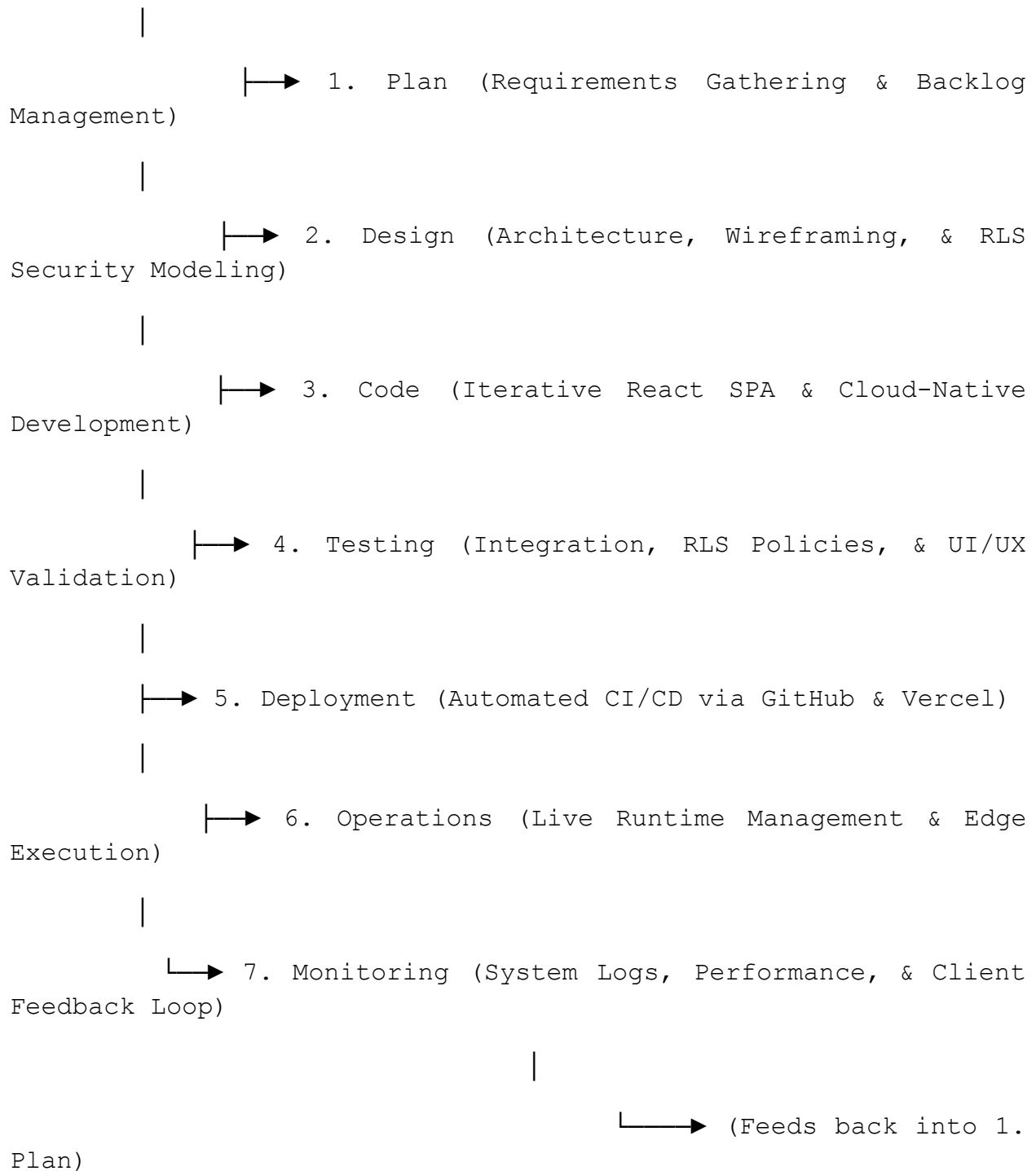
The overall workflow began with user authentication. Once authenticated through Supabase Auth, the user's assigned role (Applicants, HR employee, Administration) determines their access path. Applicants were directed to their personal onboarding dashboard to upload required PDF documents and view verification updates. HR Personnel accessed the evaluation workspace to inspect candidate files, record granular notes. System Administrators utilized the administrative panel to manage user roles, audit activity logs, update document approval statuses and configure system parameters. Real-time updates and status changes were dynamically synchronized across all active user sessions without requiring page reloads.

4.3 System Development Methodology

The developed SecureFlow adopted **DevOps with Agile Methodology**, an integrated approach that combines the iterative feature delivery of Agile with the Continuous Integration and Continuous Deployment (CI/CD) principles of DevOps. This combined methodology was selected to ensure that SecureFlow remains highly adaptable to evolving user requirements while maintaining a secure, highly reliable, and continuously updated live cloud environment throughout the software development life cycle (SDLC).

By leveraging this hybrid framework, project planned were structured into iterative sprints, while technical execution relied on an automated delivery pipeline using GitHub, Vercel, and Supabase. In this cloud-native pipeline, traditional intermediate software releases are fully automated and merged directly into the Deployment phase, allowing approved feature updates to be tested and shipped to production seamlessly.





1. Plan

The foundational phase involved collecting functional and non-functional requirements through direct interviews, advisory

consultations, and workflow analysis of manual preboarding practices. The gathered requirements were translated into a structured Product Backlog composed of role-based user stories (Applicant, HR Employee, and Administrator). To mitigate technical risk, this backlog were divided into structured two-week Agile sprints, prioritized core infrastructure—such as user authentication and database schemas in early iterations. Simultaneously, the DevOps foundation was established by initializing a GitHub version-control repository and configuring automated pipeline triggers for continuous delivery.

2. Design

The design phase transformed functional requirements into detailed technical and security specifications prior to frontend construction. Database structures were mapped using Entity-Relationship Diagrams (ERD) to define primary keys, foreign key constraints, and database triggers. To safeguard sensitive applicant documentation, Row Level Security (RLS) policies were explicitly modeled at the database level to enforce strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC). System interactions were further defined using Use Case and Sequence Diagrams to model data flows between the React client, Supabase Storage, and serverless Edge Functions, accompanied by high-fidelity wireframes drafted for mobile and desktop viewports.

3. Code

Once architecture designs were finalized, the platform was developed as a Single Page Application (SPA) using React.js and Tailwind CSS to ensure smooth dashboard transitions without full-page reloads. The frontend was broken down into modular, reusable components, including file dropzones, real-time status badges, and administrative evaluation tables. The backend utilized Supabase Cloud to manage user authentication, PostgreSQL database tables, and secure PDF storage buckets. Serverless Edge Functions were developed in TypeScript to handle automated email notifications via SMTP and background maintenance tasks. All codebase changes were managed using Git feature-branching workflows to build separate system capabilities concurrently without version conflicts.

4. Testing

Testing was embedded continuously into the development pipeline rather than deferred to the end of the SDLC. Every time a feature branch was merged into the main repository, automated build checks and manual regression tests were executed across three key domains:

- **Authentication Testing:** Validated user registration, role mapping, password strength enforcement, visibility toggles, and secure redirection.
- **Database & Security Testing:** Verified automatic role assignments, tested Row Level Security (RLS) policies to prevent cross-role data leakage, and validated end-to-end applicant submission workflows.
- **UI/UX & Responsiveness Testing:** Verified layout responsiveness, loading indicators, error feedback displays, and dark-mode styling across desktop and mobile devices.

5. Deployment

Once a feature branch successfully passed all testing gates, it was merged into the main GitHub branch, immediately triggering an automated Continuous Deployment (CD) build on Vercel. In this continuous pipeline, software releasing and hosting are unified into a single automated step. Linking the GitHub repository directly to Vercel and Supabase Cloud eliminated manual file transfers and scheduled downtime, ensuring that stakeholders, HR personnel, and administrators always had immediate access to the latest live version of the application.

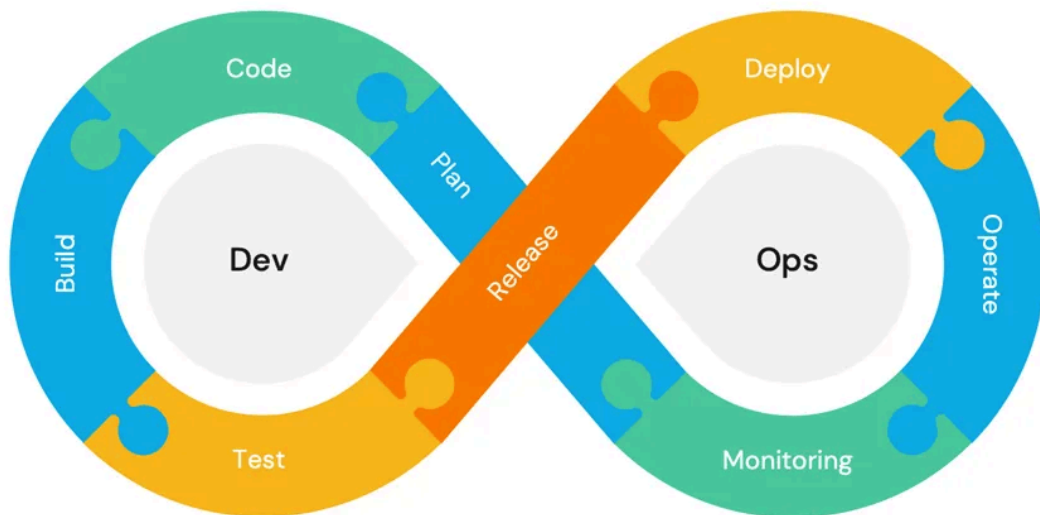
6. Operations

Once live, operational focus shifted to platform reliability, runtime performance, and backend security. This phase involves managing cloud serverless execution, ensuring uninterrupted Supabase Edge Function processing for automated HR notifications, and maintaining active Row Level Security (RLS) database policies. Ongoing database configuration adjustments and security patch deployments are applied directly to the live environment to ensure continuous stability.

7. Monitoring

The final phase focused on proactive system observation and continuous feedback. Backend logs, runtime error reports, and database performance metrics were regularly reviewed in Supabase to identify latency or security anomalies. Qualitative feedback gathered from live administrative and client interactions during this phase is analyzed and fed directly back into **Phase 1 (Plan)**, initiating the next iterative development loop for continuous system optimization.

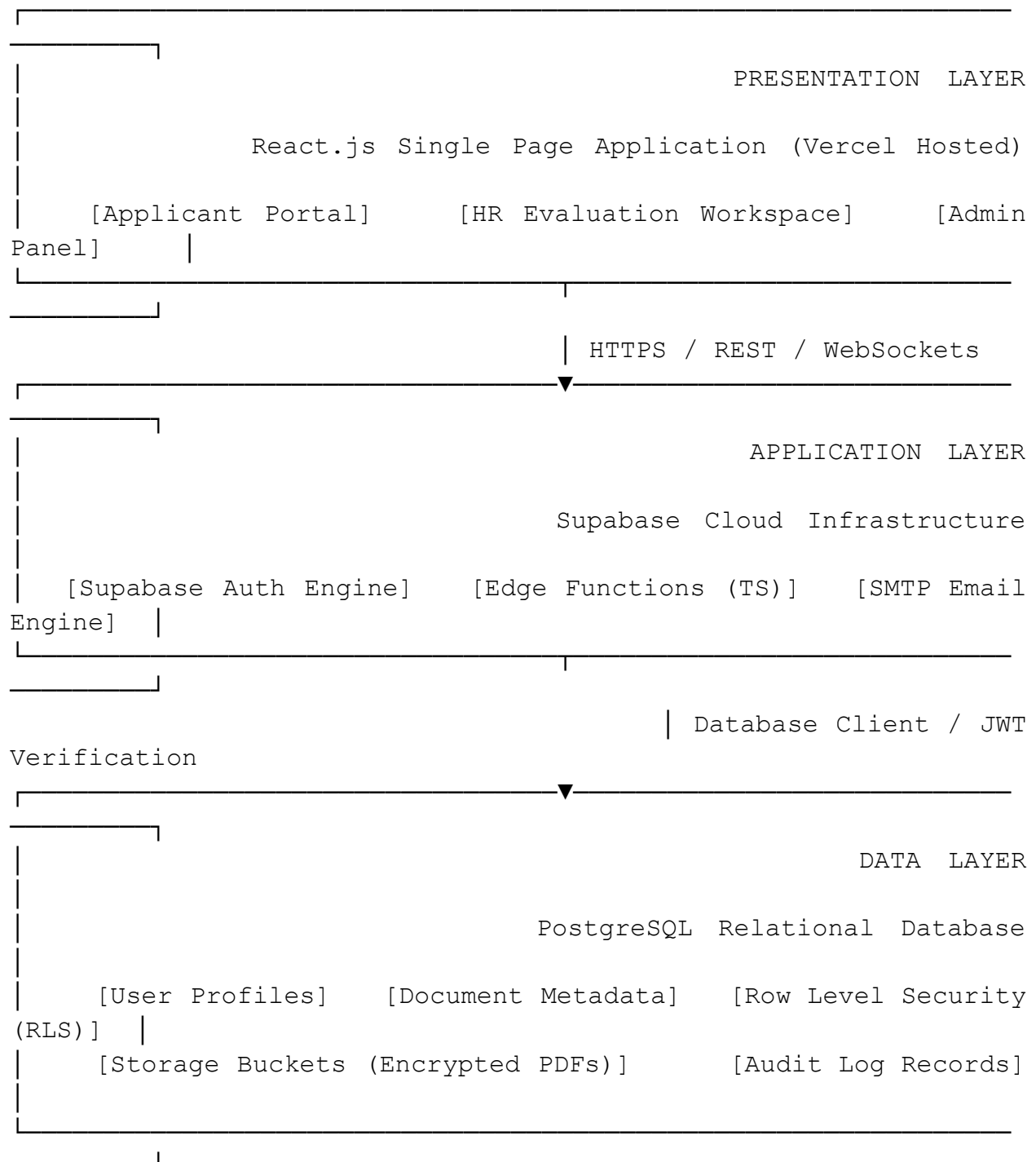
Figure 4.2: DevOps Software Development Life Cycle Model



4.4 System Architecture

SecureFlow utilized a modern **Three-Tier Cloud-Native Architecture**, strictly separating the presentation layer, application layer, and data layer. This architectural pattern ensured modularity, high performance, maintainability, and enterprise-grade data isolation.

Figure 4.3: Three-Tier System Architecture of SecureFlow



1. Presentation Layer (Frontend Client)

The presentation layer consists of a responsive Single Page Application (SPA) built with React.js and styled using Tailwind

CSS. It handles user interactions, renders dynamic dashboards, provides drag-and-drop file upload interfaces, and displays real-time status updates.

- **Key Modules:** Login/Register Pages, Applicant Document Upload Dropzone, HR Verification Table & PDF Viewer, Admin User Management Panel, System Settings.

2. Application Layer (Backend Business Logic)

The application layer runs on Supabase serverless infrastructure. It manages user authentication sessions via JSON Web Tokens (JWT), processes business logic, executes database functions, and orchestrates serverless background workers.

- **Key Components:**
 - **Supabase Auth Engine:** Handled encrypted user registration, password hashing, JWT session signing, and role assignment.
 - **Supabase Edge Functions:** Serverless TypeScript functions that execute backend logic (such as sending automated verification emails via Gmail SMTP) without exposing API keys.
 - **Realtime Subscription Engine:** Listens to database mutation events and pushes status updates instantaneously to connected clients via WebSockets.

3. Data Layer (Persistence & Object Storage)

The data layer relied on a managed PostgreSQL relational database and cloud object storage. It stored structured application metadata and unencrypted/encrypted document objects while strictly enforcing data isolation rules.

- **Key Components:**
 - **PostgreSQL Relational Database:** Stored user profiles, application tracking records, document metadata, and system audit logs.
 - **Row Level Security (RLS):** Database-level security policies that restrict row visibility based on the requesting user's JWT identity (e.g., Applicants can only view their own uploaded records, whereas HR can access assigned candidate files).

- **Supabase Storage Buckets:** Secure object storage configured with private access controls and file-type restrictions (PDF only) to host uploaded candidate files securely.

4.5 Hardware and Software Specifications

4.5.1 Hardware Requirements

Table 4.1 outlined the hardware specifications required for developing, hosting, and interacting with the SecureFlow platform efficiently.

Table 4.1: Hardware Specifications

Component	Minimum Specification	Recommended Specification
Processor	Dual-Core 2.0 GHz Processor	Quad-Core Intel i5 / AMD Ryzen 5 or higher
Memory (RAM)	4 GB	8 GB or higher
Storage	128 GB SSD	256 GB SSD or higher
Display Resolution	1366 × 768 pixels	1920 × 1080 Full HD Display
Network Connection	5 Mbps Broadband	25 Mbps Stable Internet Connection
Client Devices	Desktop / Laptop / Tablet	Workstation / Desktop Computer

4.5.2 Software Requirements

Table 4.2 details the software tools, frameworks, and environments utilized to construct, test, and deploy the application.

Table 4.2: Software Environment Specifications

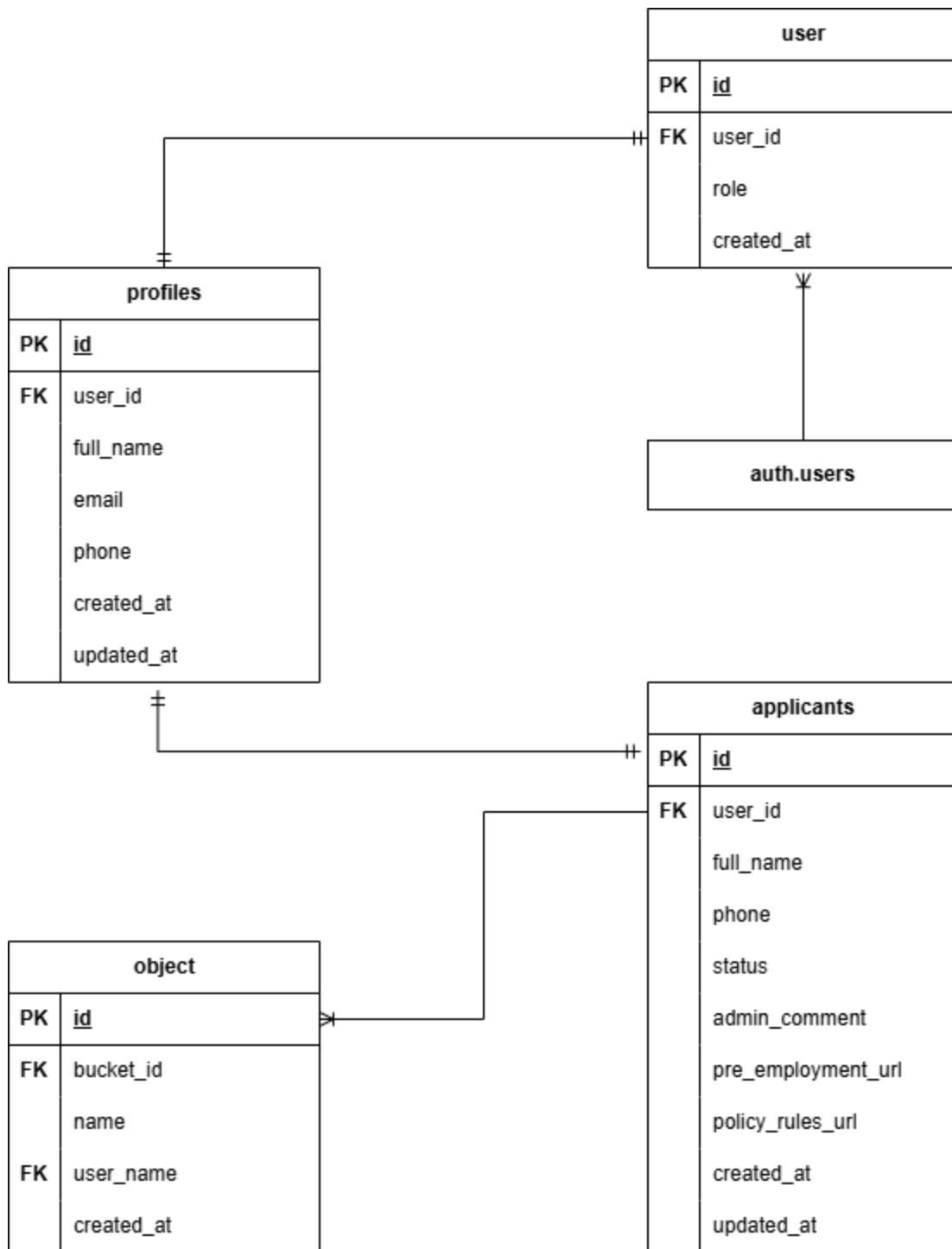
Software Tool / Technology	Category / Purpose
Windows 11 / macOS	Development Operating System
Visual Studio Code (VSCode)	Source Code Editor & IDE
React.js (v18+)	Frontend SPA Web Framework
Tailwind CSS	Utility-First Styling Framework
Node.js & npm	JavaScript Runtime & Package Manager
Supabase Cloud	Backend-as-a-Service (BaaS) Infrastructure
PostgreSQL	Relational Database Management System

Supabase Auth & RLS	Session Handling & Row-Level Security Policies
Supabase Edge Functions	Serverless TypeScript Logic & Email Integration
Git & GitHub	Version Control System & Source Code Repository
Vercel	Production Cloud Hosting & CI/CD Deployment
Google Chrome / Edge	Target Web Browsers for Execution & Testing

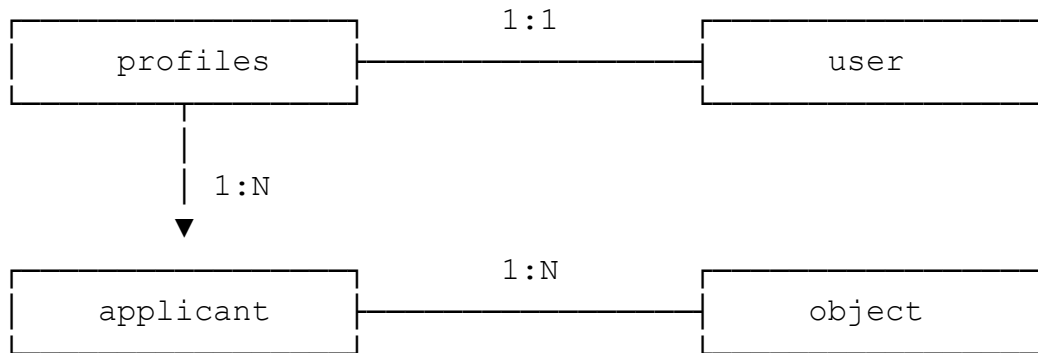
4.6 Database Design

The database architecture served as the foundation of SecureFlow, storing user identities, profile attributes, document upload metadata, approval statuses, and system audit records. A relational PostgreSQL model were engineered to maintain data integrity, eliminate redundancy through normalization, and enforce access control directly at the database level.

Figure 4.4: Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD) of SecureFlow



The relational schema comprised the following primary entities:



1. User Table

Stores systemic user permissions and access designations.

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	UUID	PRIMARY KEY	Auto-generated
user_id	UUID	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	FK to auth.users
role	TEXT	NOT NULL	'admin', 'employee', 'applicant'

2. User Profiles Table (**profiles**)

Extends Supabase Auth users with custom application metadata.

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	UUID	PRIMARY KEY	Auto-generated
user_id	UUID	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	FK to auth.users

full_name	TEXT	NOT NULL	User's full name
email	TEXT	NULLABLE	Identification fallback
phone	TEXT	NULLABLE	Contact number
created_at	TIMESTAMPTZ	DEFAULT NOW()	Record creation

3. Applicant Table (documents)

Tracks candidate file submissions, storage paths, and approval statuses.

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	UUID	PRIMARY KEY	Auto-generated
user_id	UUID	NOT NULL, FK	FK to auth.users
full_name	TEXT	NOT NULL	Applicant name
phone	TEXT	NULLABLE	Contact number

status	TEXT	DEFAULT 'pending'	pending/app roved/rejec ted
admin_comme nt	TEXT	NULLABLE	Admin review notes
pre_employ ment_url	TEXT	NULLABLE	PDF storage path
policy_rule s_url	TEXT	NULLABLE	PDF storage path

4. Document Audit Logs Table (object)

Maintained an immutable historical record of administrative status changes for auditability.

Column	Type	Constraints	Descripti on
id	UUID	PRIMARY KEY, Auto-generated	Unique identifie r for the stored file object entity.
bucket_id	TEXT	FOREIGN KEY	Key identifiy ing the target storage

			bucket (e.g., 'pre-employment-docs').
name	TEXT	NOT NULL	File system path and original filename of the uploaded PDF asset.
user_id	UUID	FOREIGN KEY	Relationa l key linking object ownership directly to auth.user s(id).
created_at	TIMESTAMPTZ	DEFAULT NOW()	Timestamp recording the exact time of document upload.

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
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CHAPTER 5

(5 to 10 pages..)

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 Introduction

This chapter provided a comprehensive conclusion to the development of the SecureFlow system. It synthesized the findings of the study, evaluated the extent to which the research objectives were achieved, and presented recommendations for future system enhancements and implementation strategies to further improve the system's effectiveness and usability for HR departments and organizations. Additionally, this chapter highlighted the overall contributions of the study to the field of Information Technology by demonstrating the successful implementation of a secure, cloud-based onboarding platform that streamlined document management, strengthened data security, and enhanced the efficiency of the employee onboarding process. It also discussed the limitations encountered during the development of the system and identified opportunities for future research and continuous system improvement.

5.2 Summary of Findings

The development and evaluation of the Sagility HR Portal yielded significant results aligned with the research objectives:

- The system successfully automated the digital submission, storage, and management of pre-employment documents, eliminating the need for manual paperwork and reducing the risks associated with physical document handling.
- The role-based approval workflow effectively streamlined the review process by enabling HR personnel and administrators to review applications, provide structured feedback, and approve or reject submissions efficiently, resulting in reduced processing delays.
- Real-time status tracking through Supabase Realtime and automated email notifications ensured that applicants remained informed throughout the onboarding process, minimizing follow-up inquiries and improving communication transparency.
- The implementation of Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) and Row-Level Security (RLS) strengthened data security by ensuring that users could only access information according to their assigned roles, helping protect sensitive applicant and employment records.
- The cloud-based architecture, utilizing React, Supabase, and Vercel, provided a scalable, reliable, and centralized platform that supported secure document storage, real-time synchronization, and efficient system accessibility.
- The adoption of the DevOps development approach enabled continuous development, testing, deployment, and monitoring throughout the project lifecycle, contributing to improved software quality, faster issue resolution, and a more stable application.
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT) confirmed that the system is intuitive and easy to use, reducing the learning curve for both HR personnel and applicants while improving the overall user experience.
-

5.3 Conclusion

The Sagility HR Portal has proven to be a viable and effective solution for organizations seeking to modernize their employee

onboarding process. By transforming manual paperwork into a structured digital workflow, the system empowers HR teams to manage document submissions, approvals, and applicant status with greater efficiency. The project successfully addressed the need for an affordable, responsive, and secure tool, demonstrating that structured document management can be made accessible to organizations of all sizes. The research questions were answered affirmatively, confirming that the system enhances operational efficiency and improves the overall onboarding experience.

5.4 Recommendations

To ensure the continued relevance and efficacy of the TOPBuy App, the following recommendations are proposed:

System Improvements

- Integrate automated notification alerts for pending application reviews and documents requiring re-submission, to further improve the processing workflow.
- Enhance security protocols by completing and enforcing two-factor authentication, which the portal already supports through email-based OTP verification, to better protect sensitive applicant and employment data.
- Develop advanced export features allowing approval and applicant reports to be generated in multiple formats (e.g., PDF, CSV, Excel) for easier sharing and integration with external HR and payroll systems.
- Implement a comprehensive audit trail that records all user activities, including document uploads, status updates, approvals, and administrative actions, to improve accountability and support compliance with organizational policies.
- Provide customizable dashboard analytics that display key performance indicators (KPIs), such as application processing time, approval rates, and pending document statistics, to assist HR personnel in monitoring onboarding performance.

- Introduce automated document expiration and archival management to securely archive completed onboarding records while maintaining efficient storage utilization.

Future Research Directions

- Explore the integration of machine learning algorithms to enable predictive analytics, such as forecasting application volume and identifying documents likely to be returned for revision based on historical patterns.
- Conduct a longitudinal study to analyze the long-term impact of the system on onboarding efficiency and employee retention.
- Investigate the feasibility of a mobile-native application to provide offline functionality for applicants with intermittent internet connectivity.
- Evaluate the integration of electronic signature (e-signature) functionality to enable legally compliant digital signing of employment contracts and onboarding documents.
- Investigate the application of artificial intelligence for automated document verification, including detecting incomplete or inconsistent submissions before HR evaluation.
- Assess the scalability of the system when deployed in larger organizations with multiple departments, branches, or geographically distributed offices.

Implementation Strategies

- HR and admin staff should conduct training sessions to ensure consistent document upload and review habits, which are critical for accurate records.
- Organizations are encouraged to perform regular data backups and system
- Organizations should establish a regular security review schedule, including periodic vulnerability assessments, user access audits, and updates to Role-Based Access

Control (RBAC) policies to maintain compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

- The system should follow a continuous maintenance and update process using DevOps practices, including version control, continuous testing, and automated deployment, to ensure that future enhancements can be delivered efficiently without disrupting system availability.
- System administrators should continuously monitor application logs, database performance, and real-time synchronization services to promptly detect and resolve operational issues.

5.5 Impact of the Study

SecureFlow contributed to the field of Information Technology by demonstrating the practical implementation of a cloud-based human resource onboarding system that integrated digital document management, real-time synchronization, and role-based access control within a secure and scalable environment. By leveraging modern web technologies such as React, Supabase, and DevOps practices, the study illustrated how contemporary software development approaches improved organizational efficiency, streamlined recruitment workflows, and strengthened the protection of sensitive applicant information. The platform provided HR personnel with an accessible and centralized onboarding solution that bridged the gap between traditional paper-based processes and secure digital automation. Although the project had limitations, including its reliance on a stable internet connection and email-based verification, the findings demonstrated the significant potential of cloud-based technologies to enhance operational efficiency, support regulatory compliance, and promote digital transformation in modern organizations.

5.6 Summary

In summary, SecureFlow represented a successful integration of software engineering principles and human resource management.

It served as a testament to the effectiveness of tailored technology solutions in addressing real-world business challenges. This research provided a solid foundation for future developers to build upon, contributing to the broader goal of digital transformation in organizational human resource processes. Furthermore, the study demonstrated that integrating cloud computing, real-time synchronization, and role-based security mechanisms into a centralized onboarding platform significantly improved the efficiency, transparency, and security of the recruitment process. The successful implementation and evaluation of the system confirmed that modern web technologies can effectively address the limitations of traditional onboarding methods while supporting organizations in their transition toward secure, reliable, and technology-driven human resource management.